Linear (Gaussian) Models

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Configuring R

Functions from these packages will be used throughout this document:

```
library(conflicted) # check for conflicting function definitions
# library(printr) # inserts help-file output into markdown output
library(rmarkdown) # Convert R Markdown documents into a variety of formats.
library(pander) # format tables for markdown
library(ggplot2) # graphics
library(ggfortify) # help with graphics
library(dplyr) # manipulate data
library(tibble) # `tibble`s extend `data.frame`s
library(magrittr) # `%>%` and other additional piping tools
library(haven) # import Stata files
library(knitr) # format R output for markdown
library(tidyr) # Tools to help to create tidy data
library(plotly) # interactive graphics
library(dobson) # datasets from Dobson and Barnett 2018
library(parameters) # format model output tables for markdown
library(haven) # import Stata files
library(latex2exp) # use LaTeX in R code (for figures and tables)
library(fs) # filesystem path manipulations
library(survival) # survival analysis
library(survminer) # survival analysis graphics
library(KMsurv) # datasets from Klein and Moeschberger
library(parameters) # format model output tables for
library(webshot2) # convert interactive content to static for pdf
library(forcats) # functions for categorical variables ("factors")
library(stringr) # functions for dealing with strings
library(lubridate) # functions for dealing with dates and times
library(broom) # Summarizes key information about statistical objects in tidy tibbles
library(broom.helpers) # Provides suite of functions to work with regression model 'broom::tidy()' t
```

Here are some R settings I use in this document:

```r
rm(list = ls()) # delete any data that's already loaded into R

conflicts_prefer(dplyr::filter)
ggplot2::theme_set(
  ggplot2::theme_bw() +
        # ggplot2::labs(col = "") +
    ggplot2::theme(
      legend.position = "bottom",
      text = ggplot2::element_text(size = 12, family = "serif")))

knitr::opts_chunk$set(message = FALSE)
options('digits' = 6)

panderOptions("big.mark", ",")
pander::panderOptions("table.emphasize.rownames", FALSE)
pander::panderOptions("table.split.table", Inf)
conflicts_prefer(dplyr::filter) # use the `filter()` function from dplyr() by default
legend_text_size = 9
run_graphs = TRUE
```

```r
include_reference_lines <- FALSE
```

Note

This content is adapted from:

- Dobson and Barnett (2018), Chapters 2-6
- Dunn and Smyth (2018), Chapters 2-3
- Vittinghoff et al. (2012), Chapter 4

There are numerous textbooks specifically for linear regression, including:

- Kutner et al. (2005): used for UCLA Biostatistics MS level linear models class
- Chatterjee and Hadi (2015): used for Stanford MS-level linear models class
- Seber and Lee (2012): used for UCLA Biostatistics PhD level linear models class and UC Davis STA 108.
- Kleinbaum et al. (2014): same first author as Kleinbaum and Klein (2010) and Kleinbaum and Klein (2012)
- *Linear Models with R* (Faraway 2025)
- *Applied Linear Regression* by Sanford Weisberg (Weisberg 2005)

For more recommendations, see the discussion on Reddit[a].

- see also https://web.stanford.edu/class/stats191 [1]

[a] https://www.reddit.com/r/statistics/comments/qwgctl/q_books_on_applied_linear_modelsregression_for/

1 Overview

1.1 Why this course includes linear regression

- This course is about *generalized linear models* (for non-Gaussian outcomes)
- UC Davis STA 108 ("Applied Statistical Methods: Regression Analysis") is a prerequisite for this course, so everyone here should have some understanding of linear regression already.
- We will review linear regression to:
- make sure everyone is caught up
- provide an epidemiological perspective on model interpretation.

[1] the current version of the first regression course I ever took

1.2 Chapter overview

- Section 2: how to interpret linear regression models
- Section 3: how to estimate linear regression models
- Section 4: how to tell if your model is insufficiently complex
- Section 5: how to quantify uncertainty about our estimates and generate predictions

2 Understanding Gaussian Linear Regression Models

2.1 General form of a Gaussian linear regression model

Definition 2.1 (General form of a Gaussian linear regression model)**.** A Gaussian linear regression model has two components:

1. The **random part**
   (the **outcome distribution model**):

$$Y_i|\tilde{x}_i \ \sim_{\perp\!\!\!\perp} \ \mathrm{N}(\mu_i, \sigma^2)$$

   Here $\tilde{x}_i$ is the observed covariate vector for unit i. Here $\sim_{\perp\!\!\!\perp}$ means independently distributed. Conditional on $\tilde{x}_1, \ldots, \tilde{x}_n$, the responses are independent across units, and each $Y_i|\tilde{x}_i$ follows the same conditional distributional form with common variance σ^2 while allowing μ_i to vary by observation.
2. The **systematic part**
   (the **linear predictor component**):

$$\begin{aligned}\mu_i &= \tilde{\beta} \cdot \tilde{x}_i \\ &= \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{i1} + \cdots + \beta_p x_{ip}\end{aligned}$$

For the systematic part of the model, here $\tilde{\beta} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} (\beta_0, \beta_1, \ldots, \beta_p)$ is the coefficient vector.

Here p is the number of covariates excluding the intercept. The vector $\tilde{x}_i$ includes an intercept entry equal to 1, so $\tilde{x}_i$ has length $p + 1$.

Terminology varies across texts. (Dobson and Barnett 2018, 36) uses this two-part formulation explicitly (probability distribution + mean/link equation/linear component). (Vittinghoff et al. 2012, 72–73) uses the labels **systematic part** and **random part**. (Dunn and Smyth 2018, 11) uses the labels **random component** and **systematic component**.

2.2 Motivating example: birthweights and gestational age

Suppose we want to learn about the distributions of birthweights (*outcome* Y) for (human) babies born at different gestational ages (*covariate* A) and with different chromosomal sexes (*covariate* S) (Dobson and Barnett (2018) Example 2.2.2).

2.3 Dobson `birthweight` data

2.3.1 Data as table

2.3.2 Reshape data for graphing

2.3.3 Data as graph

```
plot1 <- bw |>
  ggplot(aes(
    x = age,
```

Table 1: `birthweight` data (Dobson and Barnett (2018) Example 2.2.2)

```
library(dobson)
data("birthweight", package = "dobson")
birthweight
#> # A tibble: 12 x 4
#>    `boys gestational age` `boys weight` `girls gestational age` `girls weight`
#>                    <dbl>         <dbl>                   <dbl>          <dbl>
#>  1                     40          2968                      40           3317
#>  2                     38          2795                      36           2729
#>  3                     40          3163                      40           2935
#>  4                     35          2925                      38           2754
#>  5                     36          2625                      42           3210
#>  6                     37          2847                      39           2817
#>  7                     41          3292                      40           3126
#>  8                     40          3473                      37           2539
#>  9                     37          2628                      36           2412
#> 10                     38          3176                      38           2991
#> 11                     40          3421                      39           2875
#> 12                     38          2975                      40           3231
```

```
    y = weight,
    shape = sex,
    col = sex
  )) +
  theme_bw() +
  xlab("Gestational age (weeks)") +
  ylab("Birthweight (grams)") +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom") +
  # expand_limits(y = 0, x = 0) +
  geom_point(alpha = .7)
print(plot1 + facet_wrap(~sex))
```

Table 2: `birthweight` data reshaped

```
library(tidyverse)
bw <-
  birthweight |>
  pivot_longer(
    cols = everything(),
    names_to = c("sex", ".value"),
    names_sep = "s "
  ) |>
  rename(age = `gestational age`) |>
  mutate(
    id = row_number(),
    sex = sex |>
      case_match(
        "boy" ~ "male",
        "girl" ~ "female"
      ) |>
      factor(levels = c("female", "male")),
    male = sex == "male",
    female = sex == "female"
  )

bw
#> # A tibble: 24 x 6
#>    sex      age weight    id male  female
#>    <fct>  <dbl>  <dbl> <int> <lgl> <lgl>
#>  1 male      40   2968     1 TRUE  FALSE
#>  2 female    40   3317     2 FALSE TRUE
#>  3 male      38   2795     3 TRUE  FALSE
#>  4 female    36   2729     4 FALSE TRUE
#>  5 male      40   3163     5 TRUE  FALSE
#>  6 female    40   2935     6 FALSE TRUE
#>  7 male      35   2925     7 TRUE  FALSE
#>  8 female    38   2754     8 FALSE TRUE
#>  9 male      36   2625     9 TRUE  FALSE
#> 10 female    42   3210    10 FALSE TRUE
#> # i 14 more rows
```

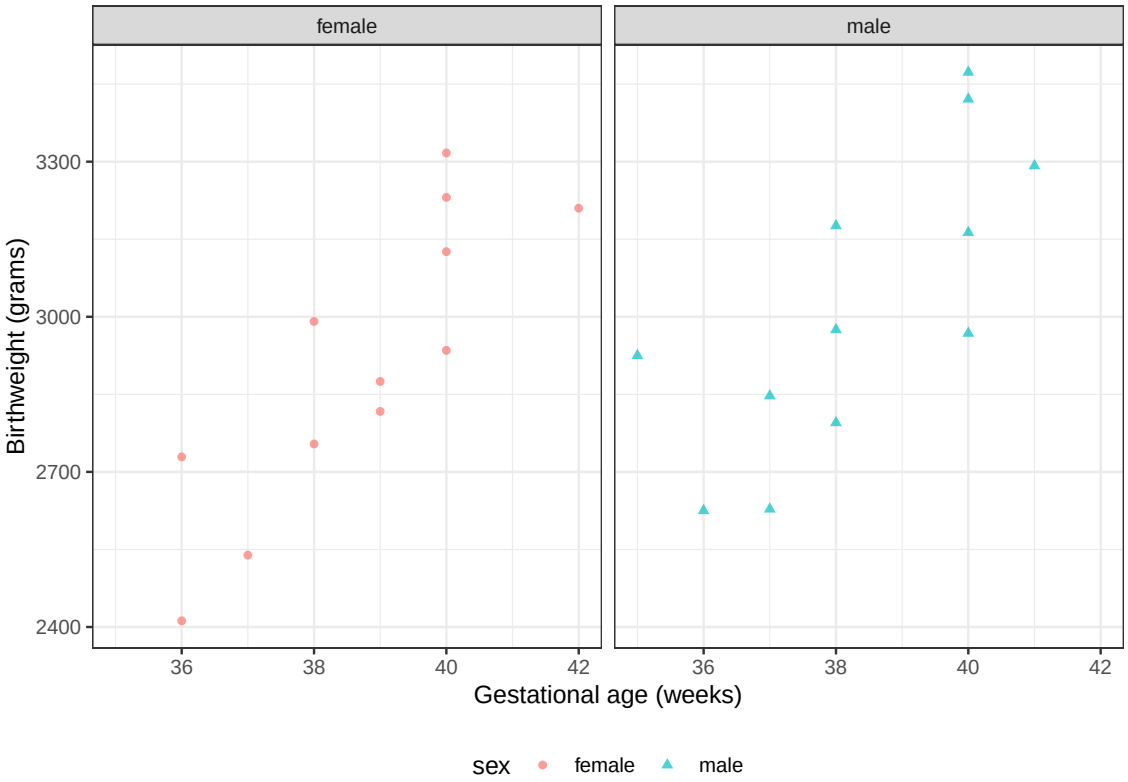


Figure 1: `birthweight` data (Dobson and Barnett (2018) Example 2.2.2)

2.3.4 Data notation

Let's define some notation to represent this data:

- Y: birthweight (measured in grams)
- S: chromosomal sex: "male" (XY) or "female" (XX)
- M: indicator variable for $S =$ "male"[2]
  - $M = 0$ if $S =$ "female"
  - $M = 1$ if $S =$ "male"
- F: indicator variable for $S =$ "female"[3]
  - $F = 1$ if $S =$ "female"
  - $F = 0$ if $S =$ "male"
- A: estimated gestational age at birth (measured in weeks).

Female is the **reference level** for the categorical variable S (chromosomal sex) and corresponding indicator variable M . The choice of a reference level is arbitrary and does not limit what we can do with the resulting model; it only makes it more computationally convenient to make inferences about comparisons involving that reference group.

M and F are called **dummy variables**; together, they are a numeric representation of the categorical variable S. Dummy variables with values 0 and 1 are also called **indicator variables**. There are other ways to construct dummy variables, such as using the values -1 and 1 (see Dobson and Barnett (2018) §2.4 for details).

[2] M is implicitly a deterministic function of S
[3] F is implicitly a deterministic function of S

2.4 Parallel lines regression

c.f. Dunn and Smyth (2018) §2.10.3[4].

We don't have enough data to model the distribution of birth weight separately for each combination of gestational age and sex, so let's instead consider a (relatively) simple model for how that distribution varies with gestational age and sex:

$$\begin{aligned} Y|M,A &\sim_{\text{ciid}} N(\mu(M,A),\sigma^2) \\ \mu(m,a) &= \beta_0 + \beta_M m + \beta_A a \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

Table 3 shows the parameter estimates from R. Figure 2 shows the estimated model, superimposed on the data.

```
bw_lm1 <- lm(
  formula = weight ~ sex + age,
  data = bw
)

library(parameters)
bw_lm1 |>
  parameters::parameters() |>
  parameters::print_md(
    include_reference = include_reference_lines,
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 3: Regression parameter estimates for Model 1 of `birthweight` data

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-1773.32
sex (male)	163.04
age	120.89

[4] https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-1-4419-0118-7_2#Sec31

```r
bw <-
  bw |>
  mutate(`E[Y|X=x]` = fitted(bw_lm1)) |>
  arrange(sex, age)

plot2 <-
  plot1 %+% bw +
  geom_line(aes(y = `E[Y|X=x]`))

print(plot2)
```

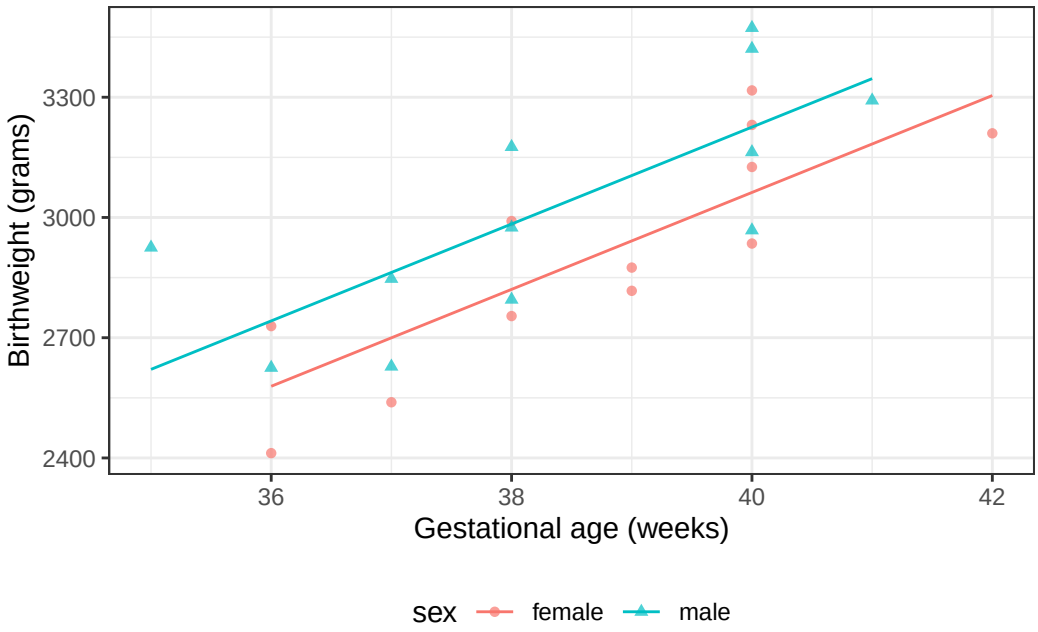


Figure 2: Graph of Model 1 for `birthweight` data

2.4.1 Model assumptions and predictions

To learn what this model is assuming, let's plug in a few values.

Exercise 2.1. What's the mean birthweight for a female born at 36 weeks?

Table 4: Estimated coefficients for model 1

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-1773.32
sex (male)	163.04
age	120.89

Solution

Solution.

Table 5: Estimated coefficients for model 1

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-1773.32
sex (male)	163.04
age	120.89

```
pred_female <- coef(bw_lm1)["(Intercept)"] + coef(bw_lm1)["age"] * 36
## or using built-in prediction:
pred_female_alt <- predict(bw_lm1, newdata = tibble(sex = "female", age = 36))
```

$$\begin{aligned} E[Y|M=0, A=36] &= \beta_0 + (\beta_M \cdot 0) + (\beta_A \cdot 36) \\ &= -1773.321839 + (163.039303 \cdot 0) + (120.894327 \cdot 36) \\ &= 2578.873934 \end{aligned}$$

Exercise 2.2. What's the mean birthweight for a male born at 36 weeks?

Table 6: Estimated coefficients for model 1

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-1773.32
sex (male)	163.04
age	120.89

Solution

Solution.

Table 7: Estimated coefficients for model 1

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-1773.32
sex (male)	163.04
age	120.89

```
pred_male <-
  coef(bw_lm1)["(Intercept)"] +
  coef(bw_lm1)["sexmale"] +
  coef(bw_lm1)["age"] * 36
```

$$\begin{aligned} E[Y|M=1, A=36] &= \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot 36 \\ &= 2741.913237 \end{aligned}$$

Exercise 2.3. What's the difference in mean birthweights between males born at 36 weeks and females born at 36 weeks?

```
coef(bw_lm1)
#> (Intercept)     sexmale         age
#>   -1773.322     163.039     120.894
```

Solution

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} &E[Y|M=1,A=36] - E[Y|M=0,A=36] \\ &= 2741.913237 - 2578.873934 \\ &= 163.039303 \end{aligned}$$

Shortcut:

$$\begin{aligned} &E[Y|M=1,A=36] - E[Y|M=0,A=36] \\ &= (\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot 36) - (\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot 36) \\ &= \beta_M \\ &= 163.039303 \end{aligned}$$

Age cancels out in this difference. In other words, according to this model, the difference between females and males with the same gestational age is the same for every age.

This characteristic is an assumption of the model specified by Equation 1. It's hardwired into the parametric model structure, even before we estimated values for those parameters.

2.4.2 Coefficient Interpretation

Recall Model 1:

$$E[Y|M=m,A=a] = \mu(m,a) = \beta_0 + \beta_M m + \beta_A a$$

Slope (of the mean with respect to age) for males:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{da}\mu(1,a) &= \frac{d}{da}(\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot a) \\ &= \left(\frac{d}{da}\beta_0 + \frac{d}{da}\beta_M \cdot 1 + \frac{d}{da}(\beta_A \cdot a)\right) \\ &= (0 + 0 + \beta_A) \\ &= \beta_A \end{aligned}$$

Slope for females:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{da}\mu(0,a) &= \frac{d}{da}(\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot a) \\ &= \left(\frac{d}{da}\beta_0 + \frac{d}{da}\beta_M \cdot 0 + \frac{d}{da}(\beta_A \cdot a)\right) \\ &= (0 + 0 + \beta_A) \\ &= \beta_A \end{aligned}$$

Exercise 2.4. What is the interpretation of β_A in Model 1?

Solution

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{d}{da}\mu(m,a) &= \frac{d}{da}(\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot m + \beta_A \cdot a) \\ &= \left(\frac{d}{da}\beta_0 + \frac{d}{da}\beta_M \cdot m + \frac{d}{da}(\beta_A \cdot a)\right) \\ &= (0 + 0 + \beta_A) \\ &= \beta_A\end{aligned}$$

Conclusion:

$$\beta_A = \frac{d}{da}\mu(m,a)$$

β_A is the slope of mean birthweight with respect to gestational age, adjusting for sex.

Or we can plug in the definition of slope:

$$\beta_A = E[Y|M = m, A = a + 1] - E[Y|M = m, A = a]$$

Exchangeability and consistency have not been assessed; so we are not discussing potential outcomes (causality), only observed outcomes.

Exercise 2.5. What is the interpretation of β_M in Model 1?

Solution

Solution.
More precisely written:

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|M = m, A = a] = \mu(m,a) = \begin{cases}\beta_0 + \beta_M m + \beta_A a, & \text{for } m \in \{0,1\} \\ \text{undefined}, & \text{for } m \notin \{0,1\}\end{cases}$$

The model is undefined for $m \notin \{0,1\}$, so the derivative with respect to m doesn't exist.

$$\begin{aligned}E[Y|M = 1, A = a] &= \beta_0 + \beta_M 1 + \beta_A a \\ &= \beta_0 + \beta_M + \beta_A a \\ E[Y|M = 0, A = a] &= \beta_0 + \beta_M 0 + \beta_A a \\ &= \beta_0 + \beta_A a\end{aligned}$$

So:

$$\begin{aligned}E[Y|M = 1, A = a] - E[Y|M = 0, A = a] &= (\beta_0 + \beta_M + \beta_A a) - (\beta_0 + \beta_A a) \\ &= \beta_M\end{aligned}$$

Therefore:

$$\begin{aligned}\beta_M &= E[Y|M = 1, A = a] - E[Y|M = 0, A = a] \\ &= \mu(1,a) - \mu(0,a)\end{aligned}$$

In words: β_M is the difference in mean birthweight between males and females adjusting for age.

Exercise 2.6. $\beta_0 = ?$

Solution

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{E}[Y|M=0, A=0] &= \mu(0,0) \\ &= \beta_0 + \beta_M 0 + \beta_A 0 \\ &= \beta_0 \\ \beta_0 &= \mathrm{E}[Y|M=0, A=0] = \mu(0,0) \end{aligned}$$

β_0 is the mean birthweight for a female with gestational age 0 weeks.

2.5 Interactions

What if we don't like that parallel lines assumption?

Then we need to allow an "interaction" between age A and sex S:

$$E[Y|S=s, A=a] = \beta_0 + \beta_A a + \beta_M m + \beta_{AM}(a \cdot m) \tag{2}$$

Now, the slope of mean birthweight $E[Y|A, S]$ with respect to gestational age A depends on the value of sex S.

```
bw_lm2 <- lm(weight ~ sex + age + sex:age, data = bw)
bw_lm2 |>
  parameters() |>
  parameters::print_md(
    include_reference = include_reference_lines,
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 8: Birthweight model with interaction term

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-2141.67
sex (male)	872.99
age	130.40
sex (male) × age	-18.42

```
bw <-
  bw |>
  mutate(
    predlm2 = predict(bw_lm2)
  ) |>
  arrange(sex, age)

plot1_interact <-
  plot1 %+% bw +
  geom_line(aes(y = predlm2))

print(plot1_interact)
```

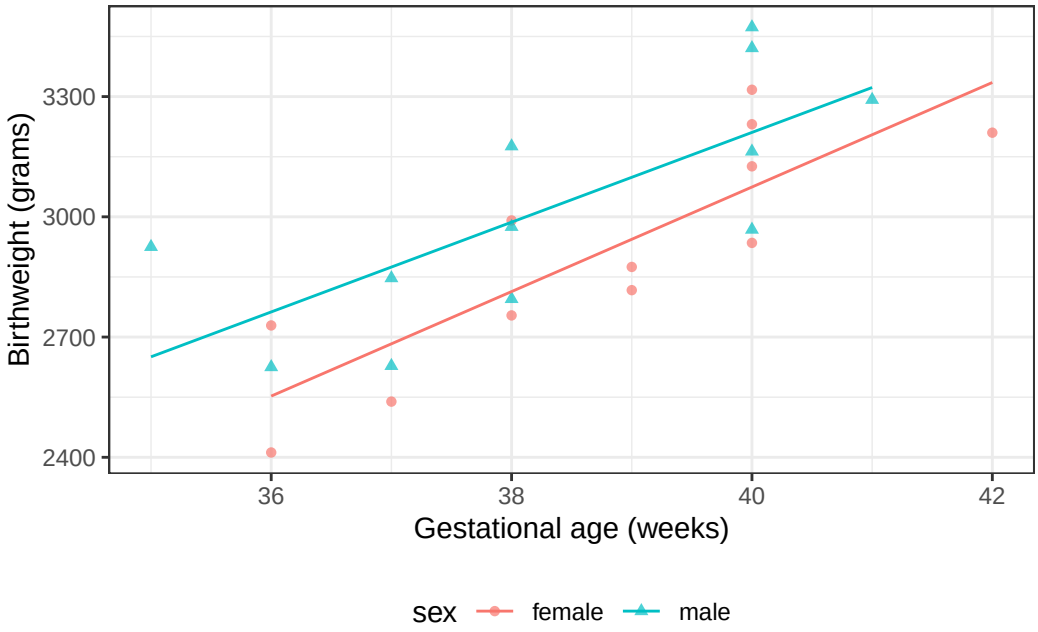


Figure 3: Birthweight model with interaction term

Now we can see that the lines aren't parallel.

Here's another way we could rewrite this model (by collecting terms involving S):

$$E[Y|M, A] = \beta_0 + \beta_M M + (\beta_A + \beta_{AM} M)A$$

If you want to understand a coefficient in a model with interactions, collect terms for the corresponding variable, and you will see which other covariates interact with the variable whose coefficient you are interested in. In this case, the association between A (age) varies between males and females (that is, by sex S). [5] So the slope of Y with respect to A depends on the value of M. According to this model, there is no such thing as "*the* slope of birthweight with respect to age". There are two slopes, one for each sex. We can only talk about "the slope of birthweight with respect to age among males" and "the slope of birthweight with respect to age among females". Then: each non-interaction slope coefficient is the difference in means per unit difference in its corresponding variable, when all interacting variables are set to 0.

Remark 2.1 (Interactions and the number of subgroups). Every subgroup that we let have its own line costs data: the more subgroups we compare, the fewer observations each one has. When there are too many subgroups, we restrict how they may differ. The parallel-lines model without an interaction (Equation 2 with $\beta_{AM} = 0$) is one such restriction: the subgroups share one slope, and only their intercepts differ. Adding the interaction term relaxes the restriction, so that the slopes can also differ.

This relaxation is symmetric. If the slope of birthweight with respect to age differs by sex, then the difference in mean birthweight between the sexes differs by age, which is visible in Figure 3 as vertical gaps that are narrower at some ages than at others.

The same idea applies to two numeric covariates. The slope of the outcome with respect to one numeric covariate A may depend on the value of another numeric covariate Z. Then each value of Z defines its own subgroup and its own slope, so there are as many subgroups

[5] some call this kind of variation "interaction" or "effect modification", but "act", "effect", "modify", and "by" all suggest causality, which we are not prepared to assess here; let's try to avoid using causal terms, unless we are constructing a causal model.

as there are distinct values of Z, and most of them contain no observations at all. To make progress, we have to assume a restrictive shape for how the slope changes with Z; a product term $\beta_{AZ}\, a \cdot z$ assumes that the slope changes linearly with Z.

To learn what this model is assuming, let's plug in a few values.

Exercise 2.7. According to this model, what's the mean birthweight for a female born at 36 weeks?

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-2141.67
sex (male)	872.99
age	130.40
sex (male) × age	-18.42

Solution

Solution.

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-2141.67
sex (male)	872.99
age	130.40
sex (male) × age	-18.42

```
pred_female <- coef(bw_lm2)["(Intercept)"] + coef(bw_lm2)["age"] * 36
```

$$E[Y|M = 0, A = 36] = \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot 36 + \beta_{AM} \cdot (0 * 36) = 2552.733333$$

Exercise 2.8. What's the mean birthweight for a male born at 36 weeks?

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-2141.67
sex (male)	872.99
age	130.40
sex (male) × age	-18.42

Solution

Solution.

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-2141.67
sex (male)	872.99
age	130.40
sex (male) × age	-18.42

```r
pred_male <-
  coef(bw_lm2)["(Intercept)"] +
  coef(bw_lm2)["sexmale"] +
  coef(bw_lm2)["age"] * 36 +
  coef(bw_lm2)["sexmale:age"] * 36
```

$$\begin{aligned} E[Y|M=1,A=36] &= \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot 36 + \beta_{AM} \cdot 1 \cdot 36 \\ &= 2762.706897 \end{aligned}$$

Exercise 2.9. What's the difference in mean birthweights between males born at 36 weeks and females born at 36 weeks?

Solution

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} &E[Y|M=1,A=36] - E[Y|M=0,A=36] \\ &= (\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot 36 + \beta_{AM} \cdot 1 \cdot 36) \\ &\quad - (\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot 36 + \beta_{AM} \cdot 0 \cdot 36) \\ &= \beta_M + \beta_{AM} \cdot 36 \\ &= 209.973563 \end{aligned}$$

Note that age now does show up in the difference: in other words, according to this model, the difference in mean birthweights between females and males with the same gestational age can vary by gestational age.

That's how the lines in the graph ended up non-parallel.

2.5.1 Coefficient Interpretation

Exercise 2.10. What is the interpretation of β_M in Model 2?

Solution

Solution.
Mean birthweight among males with gestational age 0 weeks:

$$\begin{aligned} \mu(1,0) &= \mathrm{E}[Y|M=1,A=0] \\ &= \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot 0 + \beta_{AM} \cdot 1 \cdot 0 \\ &= \beta_0 + \beta_M \end{aligned}$$

Mean birthweight among females with gestational age 0 weeks:

$$\begin{aligned} \mu(0,0) &= \mathrm{E}[Y|M=0,A=0] \\ &= \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot 0 + \beta_{AM} \cdot 0 \cdot 0 \\ &= \beta_0 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \beta_M &= \mu(1,0) - \mu(0,0) \\ &= \mathrm{E}[Y|M=1,A=0] - \mathrm{E}[Y|M=0,A=0] \end{aligned}$$

β_M is the difference in mean birthweight between males with gestational age 0 weeks and females with gestational age 0 weeks.

Exercise 2.11. What is the interpretation of β_{AM} in Model 2?

Solution

Solution.
Slope among males:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(1,a) &= \frac{\partial}{\partial a}(\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot a + \beta_{AM} \cdot 1 \cdot a)\\ &= \frac{\partial}{\partial a}(\beta_0 + \beta_M + \beta_A \cdot a + \beta_{AM} \cdot a)\\ &= \beta_A + \beta_{AM}\end{aligned}$$

or

$$\begin{aligned}E[Y|1,a+1] - E[Y|1,a] =& \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot (a+1) + \beta_{AM} \cdot 1 \cdot (a+1)\\ &- (\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 1 + \beta_A \cdot a + \beta_{AM} \cdot 1 \cdot a)\\ =& \beta_A + \beta_{AM}\end{aligned}$$

Slope among females:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(0,a) &= \frac{\partial}{\partial a}(\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot a + \beta_{AM} \cdot 0 \cdot a)\\ &= \frac{\partial}{\partial a}(\beta_0 + \beta_A \cdot a)\\ &= \beta_A\end{aligned}$$

or

$$\begin{aligned}E[Y|0,a+1] - E[Y|0,a] =& \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot (a+1) + \beta_{AM} \cdot 0 \cdot (a+1)\\ &- (\beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot a + \beta_{AM} \cdot 0 \cdot a)\\ =& \beta_0 + \beta_A \cdot (a+1) - (\beta_0 + \beta_A \cdot a)\\ =& \beta_A\end{aligned}$$

Difference in slopes:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(1,a) - \frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(0,a) &= \beta_A + \beta_{AM} - \beta_A\\ &= \beta_{AM}\end{aligned}$$

or

$$\begin{aligned}(E[Y|1,a+1] - E[Y|1,a]) - (E[Y|0,a+1] - E[Y|0,a]) &= \beta_A + \beta_{AM} - \beta_A\\ &= \beta_{AM}\end{aligned}$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned}\beta_{AM} =& \frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(1,a) - \frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(0,a)\\ =& (E[Y|M=1, A=a+1] - E[Y|M=1, A=a])\\ &- (E[Y|M=0, A=a+1] - E[Y|M=0, A=a])\end{aligned}$$

β_{AM} is the difference in slope of mean birthweight with respect to gestational age between males and females.

2.5.2 Compare coefficient interpretations

Table 9: Coefficient interpretations, by model structure

$\mu(m,a)$	$\beta_0+\beta_M m+\beta_A a$	$\beta_0+\beta_M m+\beta_A a+\beta_{AM} ma$
β_0	$\mu(0,0)$	$\mu(0,0)$
β_A	$\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(m,a)$	$\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(0,a)$
β_M	$\mu(1,a)-\mu(0,a)$	$\mu(1,0)-\mu(0,0)$
β_{AM}		$\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(1,a)-\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mu(0,a)$

In the model with an interaction term multiplying $A \times M$, the interpretation of β_A involves the reference level of M, and interpretation of β_M involves the reference level of A (Table 9).

2.5.3 General procedure for interpreting coefficients

Definition 2.2 (General procedure for interpreting a regression coefficient)**.** To derive the interpretation of coefficient β_j in a model with linear predictor $\eta(\tilde{x}) = \eta(x_1, \dots, x_p)$:

1. **Write down the linear predictor** $\eta(x_1, \dots, x_p)$.
2. **Differentiate or difference** η with respect to x_j:
   a. If x_j is **continuous**: compute the partial derivative $\frac{\partial}{\partial x_j}\eta(\tilde{x})$.
   b. If x_j is **discrete**: compute the one-unit difference $\eta(\tilde{x})|_{x_j=a+1} - \eta(\tilde{x})|_{x_j=a}$.

   For an **interaction coefficient** β_{jk} (multiplying the product $x_j \cdot x_k$), apply this step twice in sequence: first differentiate or difference η with respect to x_j to obtain the **slope of** x_j as a function of x_k; then differentiate or difference that slope with respect to x_k (choosing continuous/discrete as appropriate for x_k) to obtain the **change in slopes**, which equals β_{jk}.
3. **If any covariates remain, set them to their reference levels**. If covariates other than the one(s) used in step 2 still appear in the resulting expression, substitute each covariate's reference level for it. This substitution eliminates the corresponding interaction terms and isolates β_j alone on the right-hand side.
4. **Identify** β_j: the expression from the previous steps equals β_j; write $\beta_j = \cdots$ to state the interpretation explicitly.

Special case — intercept (β_0): If the coefficient of interest is the intercept β_0, skip step 2. Apply step 3 directly by setting all covariates to their reference levels: $\beta_0 = \eta(\text{reference pattern})$.

This procedure gives the interpretation on the **linear predictor scale**. For Gaussian linear regression (identity link), $\eta(\tilde{x}) = \mathrm{E}[Y|\tilde{x}]$, so the resulting interpretation is directly on the mean outcome scale. For other GLMs and for proportional hazards models, the linear predictor is a transformed version of the mean (e.g., the log-odds for logistic regression, the log-rate for Poisson regression, or the log-hazard for Cox models), so an additional step — applying the inverse link or exponentiating — translates the interpretation to the scale of the outcome.

The reference covariate pattern used in step 3 is not arbitrary: setting remaining covariates to 0 is correct when 0 is their reference level (as coded in the model). If the reference level for some covariate is not 0, substitute the actual reference value instead.

Exm

Example 2.1 (Applying the procedure to Model 1)**.** For the birthweight parallel-lines model

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|M=m, A=a] = \beta_0 + \beta_M m + \beta_A a,$$

where $M \in \{0,1\}$ (sex; 1 = male, 0 = female) and A is gestational age (weeks):
β_A **(gestational age, continuous):** $\frac{\partial}{\partial a}\eta(m,a) = \beta_A$, so $\beta_A = \frac{\partial}{\partial a}\mathrm{E}[Y|M=m, A=a]$. (Step 3 not needed: no remaining covariates appear after differentiating.)

β_M **(sex, discrete):**

$$\begin{aligned}\eta(m,a)|_{m=1} - \eta(m,a)|_{m=0} &= (\beta_0 + \beta_M + \beta_A a) - (\beta_0 + \beta_A a) \\ &= \beta_M,\end{aligned}$$

so $\beta_M = \mathrm{E}[Y|M=1, A=a] - \mathrm{E}[Y|M=0, A=a]$. (Step 3 not needed: a cancels in the differencing, so the result holds for all values of A.)
β_0 **(intercept, special case):** Skip step 2; set $m=0$ and $a=0$ (the reference levels) in step 3: $\beta_0 = \eta(0,0) = \mathrm{E}[Y|M=0, A=0]$.

2.6 Stratified regression

We could re-write the interaction model as a stratified model, with a slope and intercept for each sex:

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|A=a, S=s] = \beta_M m + \beta_{AM}(a \cdot m) + \beta_F f + \beta_{AF}(a \cdot f) \tag{3}$$

Compare this stratified model (Equation 3) with our interaction model, Equation 2:

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|A=a, S=s] = \beta_0 + \beta_A a + \beta_M m + \beta_{AM}(a \cdot m)$$

In the stratified model, the intercept term β_0 has been relabeled as β_F.

```
bw_lm2 <- lm(weight ~ sex + age + sex:age, data = bw)
bw_lm2 |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md(
    include_reference = include_reference_lines,
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 10: Birthweight model with interaction term

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	-2141.67
sex (male)	872.99
age	130.40
sex (male) × age	-18.42

```
bw_lm_strat <-
  bw |>
  lm(
    formula = weight ~ sex + sex:age - 1,
    data = _
  )

bw_lm_strat |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md(
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 11: Birthweight model - stratified betas

Parameter	Coefficient
sex (female)	-2141.67
sex (male)	-1268.67
sex (female) × age	130.40
sex (male) × age	111.98

2.7 Curved-line regression

If we transform some of our covariates (Xs) and plot the resulting model on the original covariate scale, we end up with curved regression lines:

```
bw_lm3 <- lm(weight ~ sex:log(age) - 1, data = bw)

ggbw <-
  bw |>
  ggplot(
    aes(x = age, y = weight)
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  xlab("Gestational Age (weeks)") +
  ylab("Birth Weight (g)")

ggbw2 <- ggbw +
  stat_smooth(
    method = "lm",
    formula = y ~ log(x),
    geom = "smooth"
  ) +
  xlab("Gestational Age (weeks)") +
  ylab("Birth Weight (g)")


ggbw2 |> print()
```

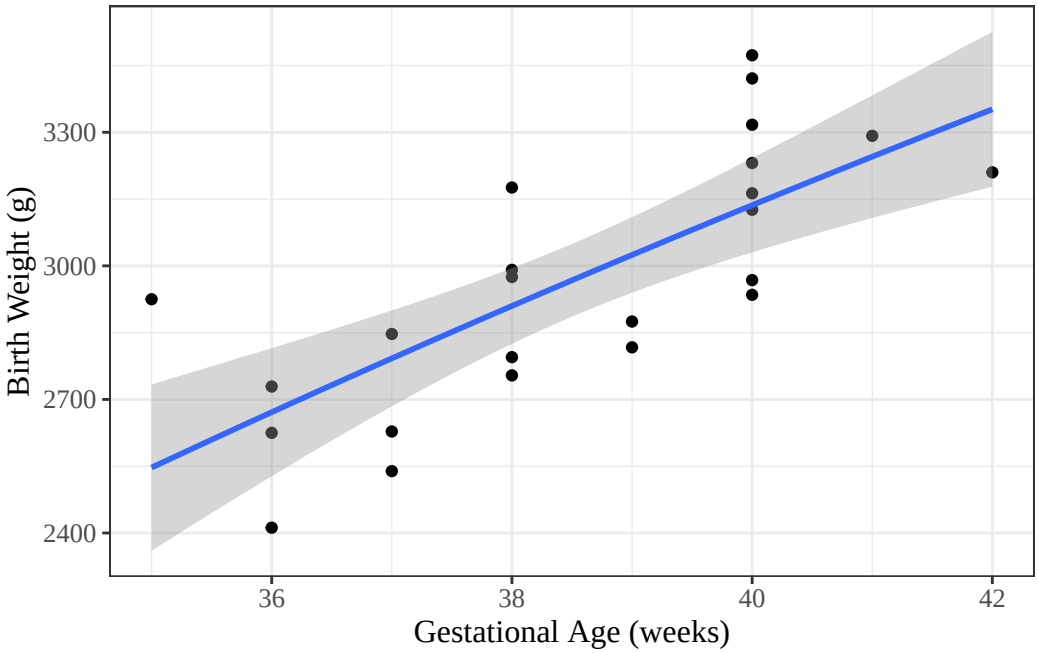


Figure 4: `birthweight` model with `age` entering on log scale

Figure 5 displays an example with a slightly more obvious curve.

```
library(palmerpenguins)

ggpenguins <-
  palmerpenguins::penguins |>
  dplyr::filter(species == "Adelie") |>
  ggplot(
    aes(x = bill_length_mm, y = body_mass_g)
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  xlab("Bill length (mm)") +
  ylab("Body mass (g)")

ggpenguins2 <- ggpenguins +
  stat_smooth(
    method = "lm",
    formula = y ~ log(x),
    geom = "smooth"
  ) +
  xlab("Bill length (mm)") +
  ylab("Body mass (g)")


ggpenguins2 |> print()
```

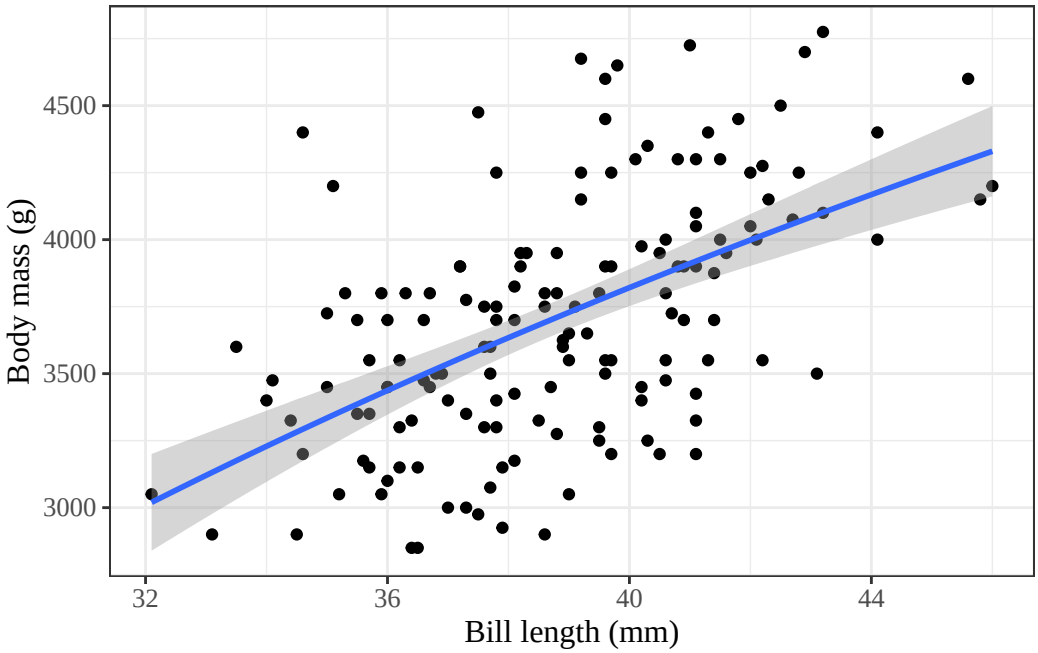


Figure 5: `palmerpenguins` model with `bill_length` entering on log scale

2.8 Rescaling

Centering covariates (subtracting a constant from them) can make coefficient interpretations more meaningful, particularly for the intercept and main effect terms in models with interactions.

2.8.1 Rescale age

For example, the intercept β_0 in our interaction model represents the mean birthweight for females at age = 0 weeks, which is not a biologically plausible scenario. If we center age at 36 weeks instead, β_0 will represent the mean birthweight for females at 36 weeks, which is more interpretable.

Exercise 2.12. Let $A^* = A - 32$ weeks.
Consider a new version of Model 2, with A^* in place of A:

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|M = m, A^* = a^*] = \gamma_0 + \gamma_M m + \gamma_{A^*} a^* + \gamma_{A^*M}(m \cdot a^*) \tag{4}$$

Let the coefficients of this model be γs instead of βs.
What are the interpretations of the γs? How do they relate to the βs in Model 2? Which have the same interpretation? Which are different, and how do they differ? What is the pattern?

Solution

Solution. **Interpretation of γ_0:**
From Model 4, γ_0 is the mean birthweight among females ($M = 0$) with $A^* = 0$ (i.e., $A = 32$ weeks):

$$\gamma_0 = \mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A^* = 0] = \mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A = 32]$$

Substituting into Model 2:

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_0 &= \beta_0 + \beta_M \cdot 0 + \beta_A \cdot 32 + \beta_{AM} \cdot 0 \cdot 32 \\ &= \beta_0 + 32\beta_A\end{aligned}$$

This centered intercept parameter differs from $\beta_0 = \mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A = 0]$, which is the mean birthweight among females at $A = 0$ weeks.

Interpretation of γ_M:

From Model 4, γ_M is the sex difference in mean birthweight at $A^* = 0$ (i.e., $A = 32$ weeks):

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_M &= \mathrm{E}[Y|M = 1, A^* = 0] - \mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A^* = 0] \\ &= \mathrm{E}[Y|M = 1, A = 32] - \mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A = 32]\end{aligned}$$

Substituting into Model 2:

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_M &= (\beta_0 + \beta_M + \beta_A \cdot 32 + \beta_{AM} \cdot 32) - (\beta_0 + \beta_A \cdot 32) \\ &= \beta_M + 32\beta_{AM}\end{aligned}$$

This male main-effect parameter differs from β_M, which is the sex difference at $A = 0$ weeks.

Interpretation of γ_{A^*}:

From Model 4, γ_{A^*} is the slope of mean birthweight with respect to A^* among females ($M = 0$):

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_{A^*} &= \frac{d}{da^*}\mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A^* = a^*] \\ &= \frac{d}{da^*}\mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A = a^* + 32] \\ &= \frac{d}{da}\mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A = a]\end{aligned}$$

Substituting into Model 2:

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_{A^*} &= \frac{d}{da}(\beta_0 + \beta_A \cdot a) \\ &= \beta_A\end{aligned}$$

Since shifting A by a constant does not change the slope, $\gamma_{A^*} = \beta_A$: these two coefficients have the same value and interpretation.

Interpretation of γ_{A^*M}:

From Model 4, γ_{A^*M} is the difference in slope with respect to A^* between males and females:

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_{A^*M} &= \frac{d}{da^*}\mathrm{E}[Y|M = 1, A^* = a^*] - \frac{d}{da^*}\mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A^* = a^*] \\ &= \frac{d}{da}\mathrm{E}[Y|M = 1, A = a] - \frac{d}{da}\mathrm{E}[Y|M = 0, A = a]\end{aligned}$$

Substituting into Model 2:

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_{A^*M} &= (\beta_A + \beta_{AM}) - \beta_A \\ &= \beta_{AM}\end{aligned}$$

Since shifting A by a constant does not change slopes, $\gamma_{A^*M} = \beta_{AM}$: these two coefficients have the same value and interpretation.

The pattern:

Slope coefficients (γ_{A^*} and γ_{A^*M}) are unchanged by rescaling: they have the same values and interpretations as the corresponding βs.

Coefficients change only for variables that have interactions with the rescaled variable A. This set of modified coefficients includes the intercept (which can be viewed as the main effect of a variable that interacts with A via β_A), and the main effect of M (which interacts with A via β_{AM}). Shifting A by 32 weeks changes the reference point from $A = 0$ to $A = 32$, so these coefficients now represent quantities evaluated at $A = 32$ weeks rather than at $A = 0$ weeks.

Exercise 2.13. Using R, fit the rescaled interaction model with $A^* = A - 36$ weeks in place of A in Model 2. Compare the coefficient estimates with those from the original model. Which coefficients change, and which remain the same?

Solution

Solution.

```
bw <-
  bw |>
  mutate(
    `age - mean` = age - mean(age),
    `age - 36wks` = age - 36
  )

lm1_c <- lm(weight ~ sex + `age - 36wks`, data = bw)

lm2_c <- lm(weight ~ sex + `age - 36wks` + sex:`age - 36wks`, data = bw)

parameters(lm2_c, ci_method = "wald") |> print_md()
```

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(20)	p
(Intercept)	2552.73	97.59	(2349.16, 2756.30)	26.16	< .001
sex (male)	209.97	129.75	(-60.68, 480.63)	1.62	0.121
age - 36wks	130.40	30.00	(67.82, 192.98)	4.35	< .001
sex (male) × age - 36wks	-18.42	41.76	(-105.52, 68.68)	-0.44	0.664

Compare with what we got without rescaling:

```
parameters(bw_lm2, ci_method = "wald") |> print_md()
```

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(20)	p
(Intercept)	-2141.67	1163.60	(-4568.90, 285.56)	-1.84	0.081
sex (male)	872.99	1611.33	(-2488.18, 4234.17)	0.54	0.594
age	130.40	30.00	(67.82, 192.98)	4.35	< .001
sex (male) × age	-18.42	41.76	(-105.52, 68.68)	-0.44	0.664

Notice that the slope coefficients (`age - 36wks` and `sexmale:age - 36wks`) remain the same, but the intercept and `sexmale` coefficient have changed to reflect means at age = 36 weeks rather than age = 0 weeks.

2.8.2 Centering gestational age does not change predictions

Centering gestational age changes the coefficient parameterization, but it does not change fitted values, confidence bands, or prediction bands.

The next output reports maximum absolute differences between the uncentered and centered models. All values should be near zero (up to floating-point rounding), which confirms that centering changes parameterization only.

```
bw_centered <-
  bw |>
  dplyr::mutate(
```

```
    age_mean_centered = age - mean(age)
  )

bw_lm2_centered <-
  lm(
    weight ~ sex + age_mean_centered + sex:age_mean_centered,
    data = bw_centered
  )

pred_uncentered_ci <-
  predict(
    bw_lm2,
    newdata = bw_centered,
    interval = "confidence"
  ) |>
  tibble::as_tibble()

pred_centered_ci <-
  predict(
    bw_lm2_centered,
    newdata = bw_centered,
    interval = "confidence"
  ) |>
  tibble::as_tibble()

pred_uncentered_pi <-
  predict(
    bw_lm2,
    newdata = bw_centered,
    interval = "predict"
  ) |>
  tibble::as_tibble()

pred_centered_pi <-
  predict(
    bw_lm2_centered,
    newdata = bw_centered,
    interval = "predict"
  ) |>
  tibble::as_tibble()

tibble::tibble(
  fitted_max_abs_diff = max(abs(pred_uncentered_ci$fit - pred_centered_ci$fit)),
  ci_lwr_max_abs_diff = max(abs(pred_uncentered_ci$lwr - pred_centered_ci$lwr)),
  ci_upr_max_abs_diff = max(abs(pred_uncentered_ci$upr - pred_centered_ci$upr)),
  pi_lwr_max_abs_diff = max(abs(pred_uncentered_pi$lwr - pred_centered_pi$lwr)),
  pi_upr_max_abs_diff = max(abs(pred_uncentered_pi$upr - pred_centered_pi$upr))
)
#> # A tibble: 1 x 5
#>   fitted_max_abs_diff ci_lwr_max_abs_diff ci_upr_max_abs_diff
#>                 <dbl>               <dbl>               <dbl>
#> 1           4.09e-12            5.00e-12            3.18e-12
#> # i 2 more variables: pi_lwr_max_abs_diff <dbl>, pi_upr_max_abs_diff <dbl>
```

```r
comparison_plot_data <-
  dplyr::bind_rows(
    bw_centered |>
      dplyr::bind_cols(
        pred_uncentered_ci |>
          dplyr::transmute(
            fit,
            ci_lwr = lwr,
            ci_upr = upr
          ),
        pred_uncentered_pi |>
          dplyr::transmute(
            pred_lwr = lwr,
            pred_upr = upr
          )
      ) |>
      dplyr::transmute(
        age,
        weight,
        sex,
        model = "Without centering age",
        fit,
        ci_lwr,
        ci_upr,
        pred_lwr,
        pred_upr
      ),
    bw_centered |>
      dplyr::bind_cols(
        pred_centered_ci |>
          dplyr::transmute(
            fit,
            ci_lwr = lwr,
            ci_upr = upr
          ),
        pred_centered_pi |>
          dplyr::transmute(
            pred_lwr = lwr,
            pred_upr = upr
          )
      ) |>
      dplyr::transmute(
        age,
        weight,
        sex,
        model = "With centered age",
        fit,
        ci_lwr,
        ci_upr,
        pred_lwr,
        pred_upr
      )
  ) |>
  dplyr::mutate(
    model = factor(
      model,
      levels = c("Without centering age", "With centered age")
    )
  )

comparison_plot_data |>
  ggplot2::ggplot(
    ggplot2::aes(
```

Table 12: The `iris` data

```
head(iris)
#> # A tibble: 6 x 5
#>   Sepal.Length Sepal.Width Petal.Length Petal.Width Species
#>          <dbl>       <dbl>        <dbl>       <dbl> <fct>
#> 1          5.1         3.5          1.4         0.2 setosa
#> 2          4.9         3            1.4         0.2 setosa
#> 3          4.7         3.2          1.3         0.2 setosa
#> 4          4.6         3.1          1.5         0.2 setosa
#> 5          5           3.6          1.4         0.2 setosa
#> 6          5.4         3.9          1.7         0.4 setosa
```

Table 13: Summary statistics for the `iris` data

	setosa (N=50)	**versicolor (N=50)**	**virginica (N=50)**
Sepal.Length			
Mean (SD)	5.01 (0.352)	5.94 (0.516)	6.59 (0.636)
Median [Min, Max]	5.00 [4.30, 5.80]	5.90 [4.90, 7.00]	6.50 [4.90, 7.90]
Sepal.Width			
Mean (SD)	3.43 (0.379)	2.77 (0.314)	2.97 (0.322)
Median [Min, Max]	3.40 [2.30, 4.40]	2.80 [2.00, 3.40]	3.00 [2.20, 3.80]
Petal.Length			
Mean (SD)	1.46 (0.174)	4.26 (0.470)	5.55 (0.552)
Median [Min, Max]	1.50 [1.00, 1.90]	4.35 [3.00, 5.10]	5.55 [4.50, 6.90]
Petal.Width			
Mean (SD)	0.246 (0.105)	1.33 (0.198)	2.03 (0.275)
Median [Min, Max]	0.200 [0.100, 0.600]	1.30 [1.00, 1.80]	2.00 [1.40, 2.50]

2.9 Categorical covariates with more than two levels

2.9.1 Example: `birthweight`

In the birthweight example, the variable `sex` had only two observed values:

```
unique(bw$sex)
#> [1] female male
#> Levels: female male
```

If there are more than two observed values, we can't just use a single variable with 0s and 1s.

2.9.2 Example: `iris`

For example, Table 12 shows the (in)famous[6] `iris` data (Anderson (1935)), and Table 13 provides summary statistics. The data include three species: "setosa", "versicolor", and "virginica".

```
library(table1)
table1(
  x = ~ . | Species,
  data = iris,
  overall = FALSE
)
```

If we want to model `Sepal.Length` by species, we could create a variable X that represents "setosa" as $X = 1$, "virginica" as $X = 2$, and "versicolor" as $X = 3$.

[6] https://www.meganstodel.com/posts/no-to-iris/

Table 14: `iris` data with numeric coding of species

```
data(iris) # this step is not always necessary, but ensures you're starting
# from the original version of a dataset stored in a loaded package

iris <-
  iris |>
  tibble() |>
  mutate(
    X = case_when(
      Species == "setosa" ~ 1,
      Species == "virginica" ~ 2,
      Species == "versicolor" ~ 3
    )
  )

iris |>
  distinct(Species, X)
#> # A tibble: 3 x 2
#>   Species        X
#>   <fct>      <dbl>
#> 1 setosa         1
#> 2 versicolor     3
#> 3 virginica      2
```

Then we could fit a model like:

```
iris_lm1 <- lm(Sepal.Length ~ X, data = iris)
iris_lm1 |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md()
```

Table 15: Model of `iris` data with numeric coding of `Species`

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(148)	p
(Intercept)	4.91	0.16	(4.60, 5.23)	30.83	< .001
X	0.46	0.07	(0.32, 0.61)	6.30	< .001

Let's see how that model looks:

```
iris_plot1 <- iris |>
  ggplot(
    aes(
      x = X,
      y = Sepal.Length
    )
  ) +
  geom_point(alpha = .1) +
  geom_abline(
    intercept = coef(iris_lm1)[1],
    slope = coef(iris_lm1)[2]
  ) +
  theme_bw(base_size = 18)
print(iris_plot1)
```

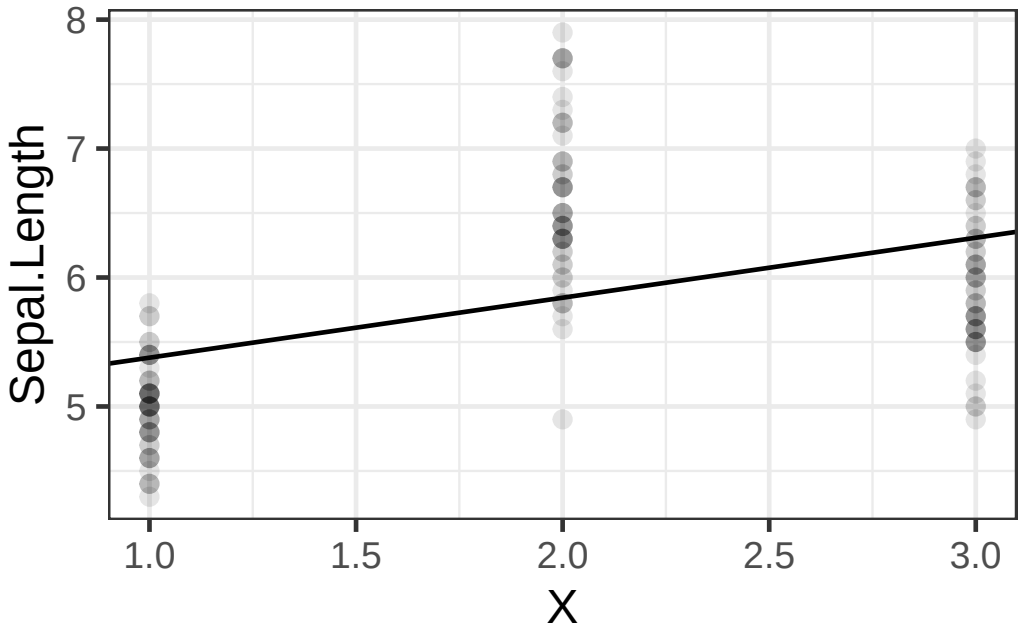


Figure 7: Model of `iris` data with numeric coding of `Species`

We have forced the model to use a straight line for the three estimated means. Maybe not a good idea?

2.9.3 Let's see what R does with categorical variables by default:

```
iris_lm2 <- lm(Sepal.Length ~ Species, data = iris)
iris_lm2 |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md()
```

Table 16: Model of `iris` data with `Species` as a categorical variable

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(147)	p
(Intercept)	5.01	0.07	(4.86, 5.15)	68.76	< .001
Species (versicolor)	0.93	0.10	(0.73, 1.13)	9.03	< .001
Species (virginica)	1.58	0.10	(1.38, 1.79)	15.37	< .001

2.9.4 Re-parametrize with no intercept

If you don't want the default and offset option, you can use "-1" like we've seen previously:

```
iris_lm2_no_int <- lm(Sepal.Length ~ Species - 1, data = iris)
iris_lm2_no_int |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md()
```

Table 17

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(147)	p
Species (setosa)	5.01	0.07	(4.86, 5.15)	68.76	< .001
Species (versicolor)	5.94	0.07	(5.79, 6.08)	81.54	< .001
Species (virginica)	6.59	0.07	(6.44, 6.73)	90.49	< .001

2.9.5 Let's see what these new models look like:

```
iris_plot2 <-
  iris |>
  mutate(
    predlm2 = predict(iris_lm2)
  ) |>
  arrange(X) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = X, y = Sepal.Length)) +
  geom_point(alpha = .1) +
  geom_line(aes(y = predlm2), col = "red") +
  geom_abline(
    intercept = coef(iris_lm1)[1],
    slope = coef(iris_lm1)[2]
  ) +
  theme_bw(base_size = 18)

print(iris_plot2)
```

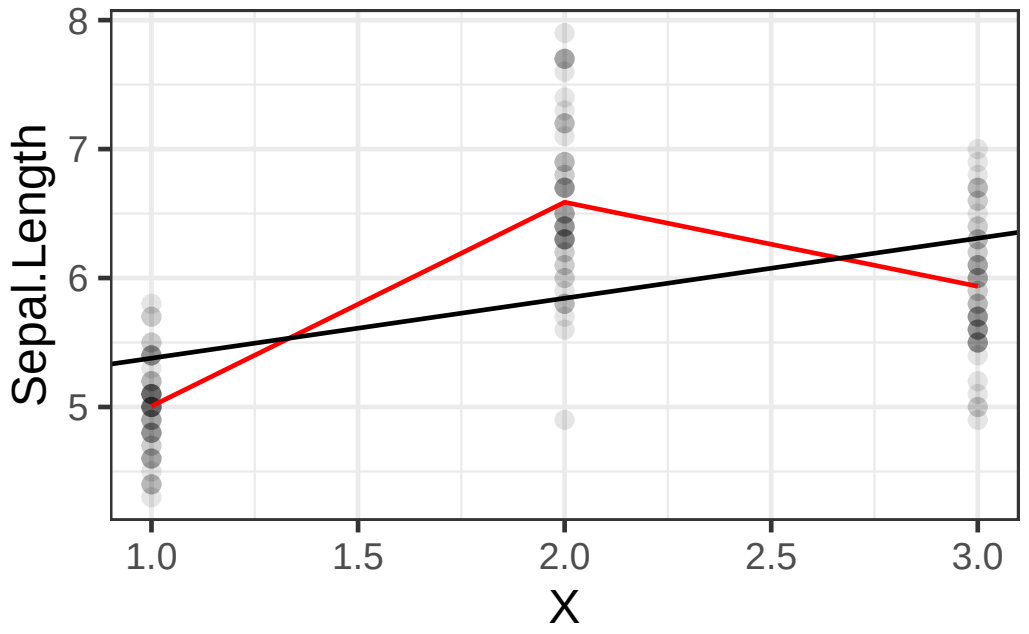


Figure 8

2.9.6 Let's see how R did that:

This format is called a "corner point parametrization" (e.g., in Dobson and Barnett (2018)) or "treatment coding" (e.g., in Dunn and Smyth (2018)).

The default contrasts are controlled by `options("contrasts")`:

Table 18

```
formula(iris_lm2)
#> Sepal.Length ~ Species
model.matrix(iris_lm2) |>
  as_tibble() |>
  unique()
#> # A tibble: 3 x 3
#>   `(Intercept)` Speciesversicolor Speciesvirginica
#>           <dbl>             <dbl>            <dbl>
#> 1             1                 0                0
#> 2             1                 1                0
#> 3             1                 0                1
```

Table 19

```
formula(iris_lm2_no_int)
#> Sepal.Length ~ Species - 1
model.matrix(iris_lm2_no_int) |>
  as_tibble() |>
  unique()
#> # A tibble: 3 x 3
#>   Speciessetosa Speciesversicolor Speciesvirginica
#>           <dbl>             <dbl>            <dbl>
#> 1             1                 0                0
#> 2             0                 1                0
#> 3             0                 0                1
```

```
options("contrasts")
#> $contrasts
#>         unordered           ordered
#> "contr.treatment"      "contr.poly"
```

See `?options` for more details.

This format is called a "group point parametrization" (e.g., in Dobson and Barnett (2018)).

There are more options; see Dobson and Barnett (2018) §6.4.1 and the `codingMatrices` package[7] vignette[8] (Venables (2023)).

2.10 Ordinal covariates

(c.f. Dobson and Barnett (2018) §2.4.4)

We can create ordinal variables in R using the `ordered()` function[9].

Exm

Example 2.2. The `hers` data (Vittinghoff et al. 2012) is available in the `rmb` package:

```
hers <- rmb::hers |> haven::zap_labels()
```

[7] https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=codingMatrices
[8] https://cran.r-project.org/web/packages/codingMatrices/vignettes/codingMatrices.pdf
[9] or equivalently, `factor(ordered = TRUE)`

Table 20: HERS data

```
hers |> head()
#> # A tibble: 6 x 37
#>      HT   age raceth nonwhite smoking drinkany exercise physact globrat poorfair
#>   <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl>
#> 1     0    70      2        1       0        0        0       5       3        0
#> 2     0    62      2        1       0        0        0       1       3        0
#> 3     1    69      1        0       0        0        0       3       3        0
#> 4     0    64      1        0       1        1        0       1       3        0
#> 5     0    65      1        0       0        0        0       2       3        0
#> 6     1    68      2        1       0        1        0       3       3        0
#> # i 27 more variables: medcond <dbl>, htnmeds <dbl>, statins <dbl>,
#> #   diabetes <dbl>, dmpills <dbl>, insulin <dbl>, weight <dbl>, BMI <dbl>,
#> #   waist <dbl>, WHR <dbl>, glucose <dbl>, weight1 <dbl>, BMI1 <dbl>,
#> #   waist1 <dbl>, WHR1 <dbl>, glucose1 <dbl>, tchol <dbl>, LDL <dbl>,
#> #   HDL <dbl>, TG <dbl>, tchol1 <dbl>, LDL1 <dbl>, HDL1 <dbl>, TG1 <dbl>,
#> #   SBP <dbl>, DBP <dbl>, age10 <dbl>
```

The `physact` variable records each participant's self-reported physical activity, relative to other women her age, on an ordered five-level scale (1 = much less active, …, 5 = much more active). We make it an ordered factor so that `lm()` uses polynomial contrasts, which respect the ordering, instead of the default treatment contrasts:

```
hers <- hers |>
  dplyr::mutate(physact_ord = ordered(physact))

lm_physact <- lm(LDL ~ physact_ord, data = hers)
```

```
lm_physact |>
  parameters::model_parameters() |>
  parameters::print_md()
```

Table 21: Mean LDL by physical-activity level, using polynomial contrasts

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(2747)	p
(Intercept)	144.71	0.85	(143.05, 146.38)	170.10	< .001
physact ord (linear)	-0.31	2.29	(-4.80, 4.18)	-0.14	0.892
physact ord (quadratic)	-1.86	2.05	(-5.88, 2.15)	-0.91	0.363
physact ord (cubic)	0.47	1.74	(-2.94, 3.89)	0.27	0.785
physact ord (4th degree)	-0.58	1.42	(-3.36, 2.21)	-0.40	0.686

With polynomial contrasts, each coefficient summarizes a trend component across the ordered levels: the linear term measures the strength and direction of a straight-line (monotone) trend in mean LDL across the levels, and the quadratic and higher terms capture curvature. The contrasts are orthonormal, so the linear coefficient is scaled by the contrast normalization; it is not the raw change in mean LDL per level. Here the linear-trend coefficient is small and not statistically significant, so these data show little evidence of a monotone association between physical-activity level and mean LDL cholesterol.

For ordinal variables, we might want to use contrasts that respect the ordering of the categories. The default treatment contrasts don't account for ordering.

> **Working with ordinal variables**
>
> When working with ordinal covariates in linear models:
> 1. Use `ordered()` or `factor(ordered = TRUE)` to create the variable
> 2. Consider using polynomial contrasts (`contr.poly`) which respect ordering
> 3. Alternatively, treat the ordinal variable as numeric if equal spacing is reasonable
> 4. Check `?codingMatrices::contr.diff` for additional contrast options
>
> See Dobson and Barnett (2018) §2.4.4 for more details on contrasts for ordinal variables.

3 Fitting linear models

In EPI 203 and our review of MLEs[10], we learned how to fit outcome-only models of the form $p(X = x|\theta)$ to iid data $\tilde{x} = (x_1, ..., x_n)$ using maximum likelihood estimation.

Now, we apply the same procedure to linear regression models:

3.1 Likelihood

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{L}_i &\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} p(Y_i = y_i | \tilde{X}_i = \tilde{x}_i) && \text{(conditional likelihood for observation } i\text{)} \\
&= (2\pi\sigma^2)^{-1/2} \exp\left\{-\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\varepsilon_i^2\right\} && \text{(Gaussian density evaluation)} \\
\varepsilon_i &\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} y_i - \mu_i && \text{(definition of residual)} \\
\mu_i &\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \mu(\tilde{x}_i) && \text{(conditional expectation function)} \\
&= \tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta} && \text{(linear predictor structure)}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathcal{L} &\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \mathcal{L}(\tilde{y} \mid \mathbf{x}, \tilde{\beta}, \sigma^2) && \text{(definition of joint likelihood)} \\
&\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \mathrm{p}(\tilde{Y} = \tilde{y} \mid \mathbf{X} = \mathbf{x}) && \text{(definition via joint density)} \\
&= \prod_{i=1}^{n} \mathcal{L}_i && \text{(product over independent observations)}
\end{aligned}
\tag{5}
$$

3.2 Log-likelihood

$$
\begin{aligned}
\ell_i &\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \log\{\mathcal{L}_i\} && \text{(definition of individual log-likelihood)} \\
&= \log\left\{(2\pi\sigma^2)^{-1/2} \exp\left\{-\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\varepsilon_i^2\right\}\right\} && \text{(substitute individual density)} \\
&= -\frac{1}{2}\log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\varepsilon_i^2 && \text{(logarithm product rule)}
\end{aligned}
$$

---

[10] https://morrison-lab.github.io/sds/intro-MLEs.html#sec-intro-MLEs

$$
\begin{aligned}
\ell &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \ell(\tilde{y} \mid \mathbf{x}, \tilde{\beta}, \sigma^2) && \text{(definition of total log-likelihood)} \\
&\overset{\text{def}}{=} \log\Big\{ \mathcal{L}(\tilde{y} \mid \mathbf{x}, \tilde{\beta}, \sigma^2) \Big\} && \text{(logarithm of likelihood function)} \\
&= \log\left\{ \prod_{i=1}^{n} \mathcal{L}_i \right\} && \text{(substitute product likelihood)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \log\{\mathcal{L}_i\} && \text{(logarithm of product is sum of logs)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \ell_i && \text{(substitute individual log-likelihood symbol)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \Big(-\frac{1}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \varepsilon_i^2 \Big) && \text{(substitute explicit log-likelihood form)} \\
&= -\frac{n}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \varepsilon_i^2 && \text{(distribute summation)} \\
&= -\frac{n}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} (\tilde{\varepsilon} \cdot \tilde{\varepsilon}) && \text{(express sum of squared residuals as dot product)} \\
&= -\frac{n}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} ((\tilde{y} - \tilde{\mu}) \cdot (\tilde{y} - \tilde{\mu})) && \text{(substitute residual vector } \tilde{\varepsilon} = \tilde{y} - \tilde{\mu}) \\
&= -\frac{n}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \Big((\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) \cdot (\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) \Big) && \text{(substitute mean vector } \tilde{\mu} = \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) \\
&= -\frac{n}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \Big(y_i - \big(\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta} \big) \Big)^2 && \text{(return to scalar summation form)}
\end{aligned}
\tag{6}
$$

3.3 Score function

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mu_i' &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \mu_i && \text{(gradient of conditional mean w.r.t. } \tilde{\beta}) \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \big(\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta} \big) && \text{(substitute } \mu_i = \tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta}) \\
&= \left(\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \tilde{\beta} \right) \tilde{x}_i && \text{(apply matrix calculus rule)} \\
&= \underset{(p+1)\times(p+1)}{\mathbb{I}} \; \underset{(p+1)\times 1}{\tilde{x}_i} && \text{(derivative of vector w.r.t. itself is identity matrix)} \\
&= \underset{(p+1)\times 1}{\tilde{x}_i} && \text{(identity matrix multiplication)}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\varepsilon_i' &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \varepsilon_i && \text{(gradient of residual w.r.t. } \tilde{\beta}) \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} (y_i - \mu_i) && \text{(substitute definition of residual)} \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} y_i - \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \mu_i && \text{(linearity of differentiation)} \\
&= \mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1} - \tilde{x}_i && \text{(outcome } y_i \text{ does not depend on } \tilde{\beta}) \\
&= -\tilde{x}_i && \text{(subtract zero vector)}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\ell_i' &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \ell_i && \text{(individual score function w.r.t. } \tilde{\beta}) \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \Big(-\frac{1}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \varepsilon_i^2 \Big) && \text{(substitute individual log-likelihood)} \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \Big(-\frac{1}{2} \log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} \Big) - \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \varepsilon_i^2 && \text{(linearity of differentiation)} \\
&= \mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \varepsilon_i^2 && \text{(constant term derivative vanishes)} \\
&= -\frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \cdot 2(\varepsilon_i') \varepsilon_i && \text{(chain rule for scalar squared term)} \\
&= -\frac{1}{\sigma^2} (-\tilde{x}_i \varepsilon_i) && \text{(substitute } \varepsilon_i' = -\tilde{x}_i) \\
&= \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \tilde{x}_i \varepsilon_i && \text{(simplify double negative)}
\end{aligned}
$$

$$
\begin{aligned}
\ell_{\tilde{\beta}}' &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \ell && \text{(total log-likelihood score vector w.r.t. } \tilde{\beta}) \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \ell_i && \text{(substitute total log-likelihood sum)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \ell_i && \text{(exchange summation and derivative)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \ell_i' && \text{(substitute individual score symbol)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \tilde{x}_i \varepsilon_i && \text{(substitute individual score expression)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i \varepsilon_i && \text{(factor out constant scalar } \frac{1}{\sigma^2}) \\
&= \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \underset{(p+1)\times n}{\underbrace{\mathbf{X}^\top}} \underset{n\times 1}{\underbrace{\tilde{\varepsilon}}} && \text{(matrix-vector formulation of the weighted sum)}
\end{aligned}
$$

3.4 Solving the score equation

To find the maximum likelihood estimator (MLE), we set the score vector equal to the zero vector. The score equation for $\tilde{\beta}$ is:

$$\ell_{\tilde{\beta}}' = \mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1}$$

Since $\sigma^2 > 0$, multiplying by σ^2 gives the equivalent condition:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i \varepsilon_i = \mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1}$$

Substituting $\varepsilon_i = y_i - (\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta})$:

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1} &= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i \big(y_i - (\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta}) \big) && \text{(substitute explicit residual expression)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i y_i - \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i (\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta}) && \text{(distribute summation across terms)}
\end{aligned}
$$

So the vector score equation becomes:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i(\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta}) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i y_i$$

Assume the design matrix $\mathbf{X}$ has full column rank $p+1$. This rank condition implies that $\sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i \tilde{x}_i^\top = \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is an invertible $(p+1) \times (p+1)$ matrix. To solve for $\tilde{\beta}$, use the identity $\tilde{x}_i(\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta}) = (\tilde{x}_i \tilde{x}_i^\top)\tilde{\beta}$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i \tilde{x}_i^\top\right) \tilde{\beta} &= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i y_i && \text{(factor out vector } \tilde{\beta}) \\
\tilde{\beta} &= \left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i \tilde{x}_i^\top\right)^{-1} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i y_i && \text{(multiply by inverse matrix)} \\
\hat{\tilde{\beta}} &= \left(\underset{(p+1)\times n}{\underbrace{\mathbf{X}^\top}} \underset{n\times(p+1)}{\underbrace{\mathbf{X}}}\right)^{-1} \underset{(p+1)\times n}{\underbrace{\mathbf{X}^\top}} \underset{n\times 1}{\underbrace{\tilde{y}}} && \text{(matrix formulation of ordinary least squares / MLE vector)}
\end{aligned}$$

3.5 Hessian

$$\begin{aligned}
\ell_i'' &\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \ell_i && \text{(individual Hessian matrix definition)} \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \ell_i' && \text{(derivative of individual score vector)} \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \left(\frac{1}{\sigma^2} \tilde{x}_i \varepsilon_i\right) && \text{(substitute individual score)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \tilde{x}_i \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \varepsilon_i && \text{(factor out constant vector term } \tilde{x}_i) \\
&= \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \tilde{x}_i (-\tilde{x}_i^\top) && \text{(substitute transpose derivative } \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \varepsilon_i = -\tilde{x}_i^\top) \\
&= -\frac{1}{\sigma^2} \tilde{x}_i \tilde{x}_i^\top && \text{(simplify outer product term)}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\ell'' &\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}} \ell && \text{(total Hessian matrix definition)} \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \ell' && \text{(derivative of total score vector)} \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \ell_i' && \text{(substitute sum of individual scores)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\beta}^\top} \ell_i' && \text{(exchange summation and derivative)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \ell_i'' && \text{(substitute individual Hessian symbol)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(-\frac{1}{\sigma^2} \tilde{x}_i \tilde{x}_i^\top\right) && \text{(substitute individual Hessian expression)} \\
&= -\frac{1}{\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \tilde{x}_i \tilde{x}_i^\top && \text{(factor out constant scalar } -\frac{1}{\sigma^2}) \\
&= -\frac{1}{\sigma^2} \underset{(p+1)\times n}{\underbrace{\mathbf{X}^\top}} \underset{n\times(p+1)}{\underbrace{\mathbf{X}}} && \text{(express summation as matrix product)}
\end{aligned}$$

Expressed as a summation, the Hessian matrix is given by:

$$\ell'' = -\frac{1}{\sigma^2}\sum_{i=1}^{n}\tilde{x}_i\tilde{x}_i^\top \tag{7}$$

3.6 Alternative approach using matrix derivatives

We can obtain the score function and Hessian directly in matrix-vector form without differentiating and summing term-by-term for each observation.

The total log-likelihood gradient with respect to $\tilde{\beta}$ is:

$$\begin{aligned}
\ell'_{\tilde{\beta}}(\tilde{y} \mid \mathbf{x}, \tilde{\beta}, \sigma^2) &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial\tilde{\beta}}\ell(\tilde{y} \mid \mathbf{x}, \tilde{\beta}, \sigma^2) && \text{(definition of score vector)} \\
&= -\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\frac{\partial}{\partial\tilde{\beta}}\left(\sum_{i=1}^{n}\big(y_i - \big(\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta}\big)\big)^2\right) && \text{(substitute scalar sum of squares)}
\end{aligned} \tag{8}$$

Let's switch to matrix-vector notation:

The sum of squared residuals can be rewritten in vector notation using the inner product:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \tilde{x}_i^\top\tilde{\beta})^2 = (\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) \cdot (\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) = (\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta})^\top(\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta})$$

Expanding this quadratic vector form gives:

$$\begin{aligned}
(\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta})^\top(\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) &= \big(\tilde{y}^\top - \tilde{\beta}^\top\mathbf{X}^\top\big)(\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) && \text{(transpose of difference)} \\
&= \tilde{y}^\top\tilde{y} - \tilde{\beta}^\top\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{y} - \tilde{y}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} + \tilde{\beta}^\top\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} && \text{(expand matrix product)} \\
&= \tilde{y}^\top\tilde{y} - 2\tilde{y}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} + \tilde{\beta}^\top\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} && \text{(combine scalar transpose terms } \tilde{\beta}^\top\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{y} = \tilde{y}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta})
\end{aligned}$$

We will use some results from vector calculus[11]:

Differentiating each term in the expanded sum-of-squared-residuals quadratic form with respect to $\tilde{\beta}$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial}{\partial\tilde{\beta}}\left(\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \tilde{x}_i^\top\tilde{\beta})^2\right) &= \frac{\partial}{\partial\tilde{\beta}}(\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta})^\top(\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) && \text{(express in matrix vector form)} \\
&= \frac{\partial}{\partial\tilde{\beta}}\big(\tilde{y}^\top\tilde{y} - 2\tilde{y}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} + \tilde{\beta}^\top\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}\big) && \text{(substitute expanded form)} \\
&= \mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1} - 2\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{y} + 2\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} && \text{(matrix derivatives w.r.t. } \tilde{\beta}) \\
&= -2\mathbf{X}^\top(\tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) && \text{(factor out } -2\mathbf{X}^\top) \\
&= -2\mathbf{X}^\top(\tilde{y} - \mathrm{E}\big[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\big]) && \text{(substitute conditional mean } \mathrm{E}\big[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\big] = \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) \\
&= -2\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{\varepsilon} && \text{(substitute residual vector } \tilde{\varepsilon} = \tilde{y} - \mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta})
\end{aligned} \tag{9}$$

Multiplying the sum-of-squared-residuals gradient by the scalar factor $-\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}$ yields the full log-likelihood score vector $\ell'_{\tilde{\beta}}$:

[11] https://morrison-lab.github.io/mds/vector-calculus.html

$$
\begin{aligned}
\ell'_{\tilde{\beta}} &= -\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}(-2\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{\varepsilon}) && \text{(scale gradient by log-likelihood factor)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sigma^2}\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{\varepsilon} && \text{(simplify factor } -\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\cdot(-2)=\frac{1}{\sigma^2}\text{)}
\end{aligned}
$$

Setting the log-likelihood score vector equal to the zero vector:

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1} &= \frac{1}{\sigma^2}\mathbf{X}^\top(\tilde{y}-\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) && \text{(set score vector to zero vector)} \\
\mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1} &= \mathbf{X}^\top(\tilde{y}-\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}) && \text{(multiply by } \sigma^2>0\text{)} \\
\mathbf{0}_{(p+1)\times 1} &= \mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{y}-\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} && \text{(distribute } \mathbf{X}^\top \text{ across difference)} \\
\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{y} &= \mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} && \text{(rearrange terms)} \\
\hat{\tilde{\beta}} &= (\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{y} && \text{(multiply by inverse matrix } (\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X})^{-1}\text{)}
\end{aligned}
$$

3.6.1 Hessian

The Hessian (second derivative matrix) using matrix calculus is:

$$
\begin{aligned}
\ell''_{\tilde{\beta},\tilde{\beta}^\top}(\tilde{y}\mid\mathbf{x},\tilde{\beta},\sigma^2) &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \frac{\partial}{\partial\tilde{\beta}^\top}\left(\frac{1}{\sigma^2}\mathbf{X}^\top(\tilde{y}-\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta})\right) && \text{(differentiate score vector w.r.t. } \tilde{\beta}^\top\text{)} \\
&= -\frac{1}{\sigma^2}\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} && \text{(matrix derivative of linear term w.r.t. } \tilde{\beta}^\top\text{)}
\end{aligned}
$$

The Hessian matrix $-\frac{1}{\sigma^2}\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}$ is negative definite when $\mathbf{X}$ has full column rank $p+1$, confirming that $\hat{\tilde{\beta}}=(\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top\tilde{y}$ uniquely maximizes the log-likelihood and is the maximum likelihood estimator for $\tilde{\beta}$.

Similarly (not shown):

$$
\hat{\sigma}^2_{\text{ML}} = \frac{1}{n}(\tilde{y}-\mathbf{X}\hat{\tilde{\beta}})^\top(\tilde{y}-\mathbf{X}\hat{\tilde{\beta}})
$$

3.7 Residual Standard Deviation

$\hat{\sigma}$ represents an *estimate* of the *Residual Standard Deviation* parameter, σ. We can extract $\hat{\sigma}$ from the fitted model, using the `sigma()` function:

```
sigma(bw_lm2)
#> [1] 180.613
```

3.7.1 σ is NOT "Residual standard error"

In the `summary.lm()` output, this estimate is labeled as `"Residual standard error"`:

```
summary(bw_lm2)
#>
#> Call:
#> lm(formula = weight ~ sex + age + sex:age, data = bw)
#>
#> Residuals:
```

```
#>    Min     1Q Median     3Q    Max
#> -246.7 -138.1  -39.1  176.6  274.3
#>
#> Coefficients:
#>             Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
#> (Intercept)  -2141.7     1163.6   -1.84  0.08057 .
#> sexmale        873.0     1611.3    0.54  0.59395
#> age            130.4       30.0    4.35  0.00031 ***
#> sexmale:age    -18.4       41.8   -0.44  0.66389
#> ---
#> Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
#>
#> Residual standard error: 181 on 20 degrees of freedom
#> Multiple R-squared:  0.643,  Adjusted R-squared:  0.59
#> F-statistic:   12 on 3 and 20 DF,  p-value: 0.000101
```

However, this label is a misnomer: see note in `?stats::sigma`

3.8 Predicted and fitted values

Definition 3.1 (Predicted value)**.** In a regression model $\mathrm{p}(y|\tilde{x})$, the **predicted value** of y given $\tilde{x}$ is the estimated mean of Y given $\tilde{X} = \tilde{x}$:

$$\hat{y} \overset{\text{def}}{=} \hat{\mathrm{E}}\big[Y|\tilde{X} = \tilde{x}\big]$$

For linear models, the predicted value can be straightforwardly calculated by multiplying each predictor value x_j by its corresponding coefficient β_j and adding up the results:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{y} &= \hat{\mathrm{E}}\big[Y|\tilde{X} = \tilde{x}\big] \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \hat{\beta} \\ &= \hat{\beta}_0 \cdot 1 + \hat{\beta}_1 x_1 + \ldots + \hat{\beta}_p x_p\end{aligned}$$

Definition 3.2 (Fitted value)**.** For a given dataset $(\tilde{Y}, \mathbf{X})$ and corresponding fitted model $\mathrm{p}_{\hat{\beta}}(\tilde{y}|\mathbf{x})$, the **fitted value** of y_i is the predicted value (see Definition 3.1) of y when $\tilde{X} = \tilde{x}_i$ using the estimated parameters $\hat{\beta}$:

$$\hat{y}_i \overset{\text{def}}{=} \hat{\mathrm{E}}\big[Y_i|\tilde{X} = \tilde{x}_i\big] = \tilde{x}_i^\top \hat{\beta}$$

Example: prediction for the `birthweight` data

```
x <- c(1, 1, 40)
sum(x * coef(bw_lm1))
#> [1] 3225.49
```

R has built-in functions for prediction:

```
x <- tibble(age = 40, sex = "male")
bw_lm1 |> predict(newdata = x)
```

```
#>        1
#> 3225.49
```

If you don't provide `newdata`, R will use the covariate values from the original dataset:

```
predict(bw_lm1)
#>        1        2        3        4        5        6        7        8        9       10
#> 3225.49 3062.45 2983.70 2578.87 3225.49 3062.45 2621.02 2820.66 2741.91 3304.24
#>       11       12       13       14       15       16       17       18       19       20
#> 2862.81 2941.56 3346.38 3062.45 3225.49 2699.77 2862.81 2578.87 2983.70 2820.66
#>       21       22       23       24
#> 3225.49 2941.56 2983.70 3062.45
```

These special predictions are called the **fitted values** of the dataset (see Definition 3.2).

R has an extra function to get these values:

```
fitted(bw_lm1)
#>        1        2        3        4        5        6        7        8        9       10
#> 3225.49 3062.45 2983.70 2578.87 3225.49 3062.45 2621.02 2820.66 2741.91 3304.24
#>       11       12       13       14       15       16       17       18       19       20
#> 2862.81 2941.56 3346.38 3062.45 3225.49 2699.77 2862.81 2578.87 2983.70 2820.66
#>       21       22       23       24
#> 3225.49 2941.56 2983.70 3062.45
```

4 Assessing model fit

4.1 Goodness of fit

4.1.1 AIC and BIC

This section is adapted from Vittinghoff et al. (2012, sec. 4.5) and Kleinbaum et al. (2014, sec. 15).

When we use likelihood ratio tests, we are comparing how well different models fit the data.

Likelihood ratio tests require **nested** models: one must be a special case of the other.

AIC and BIC can be used to compare both nested and non-nested models.

4.1.2 Formulas

Definition 4.1 (Akaike Information Criterion (AIC))**.**

$$\text{AIC} = -2\ell(\hat{\theta}) + 2p$$

where $\ell(\hat{\theta})$ is the log-likelihood evaluated at the maximum-likelihood estimates $\hat{\theta}$, p is the number of estimated parameters (including $\hat{\sigma}^2$ for Gaussian models), and n is the number of observations.

Definition 4.2 (Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC))**.**

$$\text{BIC} = -2\ell(\hat{\theta}) + p\log(n)$$

where $\ell(\hat{\theta})$, p, and n are defined as in Definition 4.1.

4.1.3 Conceptual basis

Each criterion has two components:

- **Fit term** ($-2\ell(\hat{\theta})$): measures lack of fit — lower is better. A model with more parameters will always achieve a higher (or equal) log-likelihood on the observed data.
- **Penalty term** ($2p$ for AIC; $p\log(n)$ for BIC): penalizes model complexity to guard against overfitting.

Together, they balance **goodness of fit** against **parsimony**.

The AIC was introduced by Akaike (1974) and is grounded in information theory (specifically, the Kullback-Leibler divergence). The BIC was introduced by Schwarz (1978) as an approximation to the Bayes factor for model comparison.

4.1.4 AIC vs. BIC

Criterion	Penalty per parameter	Tends to select
AIC	2	larger models
BIC	$\log(n)$	smaller models

The BIC penalty exceeds the AIC penalty whenever $\log(n) > 2$, i.e., when $n > e^2 \approx 7.4$. In practice, BIC almost always penalizes additional parameters more heavily than AIC and therefore tends to select simpler (more parsimonious) models (Vittinghoff et al. 2012; Kleinbaum et al. 2014).

AIC in R

```
-2 * logLik(bw_lm2) |> as.numeric() +
  2 * (length(coef(bw_lm2)) + 1) # sigma counts as a parameter here
#> [1] 323.159

AIC(bw_lm2)
#> [1] 323.159
```

BIC in R

```
-2 * logLik(bw_lm2) |> as.numeric() +
  (length(coef(bw_lm2)) + 1) * log(nobs(bw_lm2))
#> [1] 329.049

BIC(bw_lm2)
#> [1] 329.049
```

4.1.5 Interpretation

- **Lower values are better.** There are no hypothesis tests or p-values associated with these criteria.
- To compare models, calculate the criterion for each model and choose the model with the **smallest value**.
- Differences of less than 2 units are generally considered negligible; differences greater than 10 are considered strong evidence in favor of the lower-criterion model.
- BIC tends to favor simpler models than AIC, especially when the sample size is large.

Table 22: Unique covariate combinations in the `birthweight` data, with replicate counts

```
bw_X_unique
#> # A tibble: 12 x 3
#>    sex      age     n
#>    <fct>  <dbl> <int>
#>  1 female    36     2
#>  2 female    37     1
#>  3 female    38     2
#>  4 female    39     2
#>  5 female    40     4
#>  6 female    42     1
#>  7 male      35     1
#>  8 male      36     1
#>  9 male      37     2
#> 10 male      38     3
#> 11 male      40     4
#> 12 male      41     1
```

4.1.6 (Residual) Deviance

Let q be the number of distinct covariate combinations in a data set.

```
bw_X_unique <-
  bw |>
  count(sex, age)

n_unique_bw <- nrow(bw_X_unique)
```

For example, in the `birthweight` data, there are $q = 12$ unique patterns (Table 22).

Definition 4.3 (Replicates)**.** If a given covariate pattern has more than one observation in a dataset, those observations are called **replicates**.

Exm

Example 4.1 (Replicates in the `birthweight` data)**.** In the `birthweight` dataset, there are 2 replicates of the combination "female, age 36" (Table 22).

Exercise 4.1 (Replicates in the `birthweight` data)**.** Which covariate pattern(s) in the `birthweight` data has the most replicates?

Solution (Replicates in the `birthweight` data)

Solution 4.1 (Replicates in the `birthweight` data). Two covariate patterns are tied for most replicates: males at age 40 weeks and females at age 40 weeks. 40 weeks is the usual length for human pregnancy (Polin et al. (2011)), so this result makes sense.

```
bw_X_unique |> dplyr::filter(n == max(n))
#> # A tibble: 2 x 3
#>   sex      age     n
#>   <fct>  <dbl> <int>
#> 1 female    40     4
#> 2 male      40     4
```

Saturated models

The most complicated model we could fit would have one parameter (a mean) for each covariate pattern, plus a variance parameter:

```
lm_max <-
  bw |>
  mutate(age = factor(age)) |>
  lm(
    formula = weight ~ sex:age - 1,
    data = _
  )

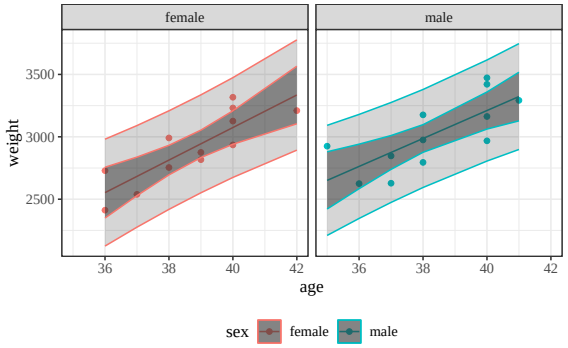
lm_max |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md()
```

Table 23: Saturated model for the `birthweight` data

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(12)	p
sex (male) × age35	2925.00	187.92	(2515.55, 3334.45)	15.56	< .001
sex (female) × age36	2570.50	132.88	(2280.98, 2860.02)	19.34	< .001
sex (male) × age36	2625.00	187.92	(2215.55, 3034.45)	13.97	< .001
sex (female) × age37	2539.00	187.92	(2129.55, 2948.45)	13.51	< .001
sex (male) × age37	2737.50	132.88	(2447.98, 3027.02)	20.60	< .001
sex (female) × age38	2872.50	132.88	(2582.98, 3162.02)	21.62	< .001
sex (male) × age38	2982.00	108.50	(2745.60, 3218.40)	27.48	< .001
sex (female) × age39	2846.00	132.88	(2556.48, 3135.52)	21.42	< .001
sex (female) × age40	3152.25	93.96	(2947.52, 3356.98)	33.55	< .001
sex (male) × age40	3256.25	93.96	(3051.52, 3460.98)	34.66	< .001
sex (male) × age41	3292.00	187.92	(2882.55, 3701.45)	17.52	< .001
sex (female) × age42	3210.00	187.92	(2800.55, 3619.45)	17.08	< .001

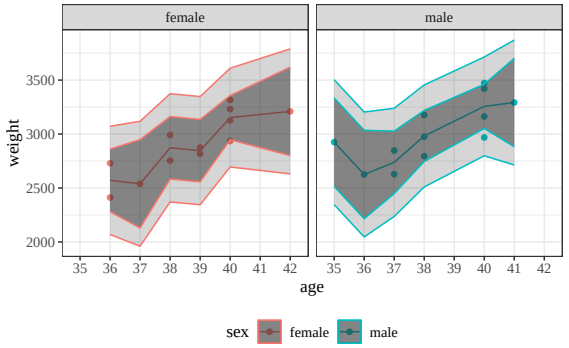
We call this model the **full**, **maximal**, or **saturated** model for this dataset.

```
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw, bw_lm2)
```



(a) Model 2 (linear with age:sex interaction)

```
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw |> mutate(age = factor(age)), lm_max)
```



(b) Saturated model

Figure 9: Model 2 and saturated model for `birthweight` data, with confidence and prediction intervals

---

We can calculate the log-likelihood of this model as usual:

```
logLik(lm_max)
#> 'log Lik.' -151.402 (df=13)
```

We can compare this model to our other models using chi-square tests, as usual:

```
library(lmtest)
lrtest(lm_max, bw_lm2)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 5
#>   `#Df` LogLik    Df Chisq `Pr(>Chisq)`
#>   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>        <dbl>
#> 1    13  -151.    NA  NA          NA
#> 2     5  -157.    -8  10.4         0.241
```

The likelihood ratio statistic for this test is

$$\lambda = 2 * (\ell_{\text{full}} - \ell) = 10.355374$$

where:

- ℓ_{full} is the log-likelihood of the full model: -151.401601
- ℓ is the log-likelihood of our comparison model (two slopes, two intercepts): -156.579288

This statistic is called the **deviance** or **residual deviance** for our two-slopes and two-intercepts model; it tells us how much the likelihood of that model deviates from the likelihood of the maximal model.

The corresponding p-value tells us whether there we have enough evidence to detect that our two-slopes, two-intercepts model is a worse fit for the data than the maximal model; in other words, it tells us if there's evidence that we missed any important patterns. (Remember, a nonsignificant p-value could mean that we didn't miss anything and a more complicated model is unnecessary, or it could mean we just don't have enough data to tell the difference between these models.)

4.1.7 Null Deviance

Similarly, the *least* complicated model we could fit would have only one mean parameter, an intercept:

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|X = x] = \beta_0$$

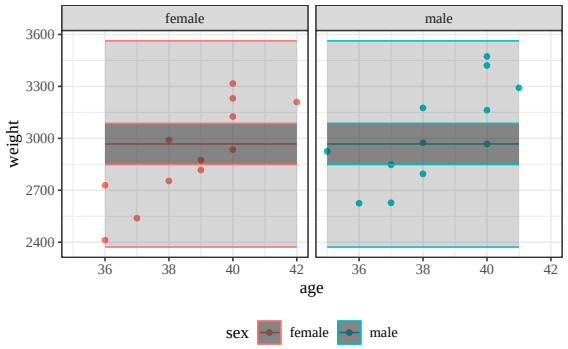
We can fit this model in R like so:

```r
lm0 <- lm(weight ~ 1, data = bw)

lm0 |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md()
```

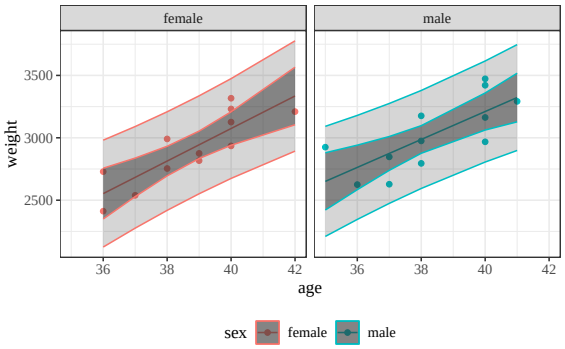
Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(23)	p
(Intercept)	2967.67	57.58	(2848.56, 3086.77)	51.54	< .001

```r
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw, lm0)
```



(a) Null model

```r
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw, bw_lm2)
```



(b) Model 2 (linear with age:sex interaction)

Figure 10: Null model and model 2 for `birthweight` data, with 95% confidence and prediction intervals.

This model also has a likelihood:

```r
logLik(lm0)
#> 'log Lik.' -168.955 (df=2)
```

And we can compare it to more complicated models using a likelihood ratio test:

```r
lrtest(bw_lm2, lm0)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 5
#>   `#Df` LogLik    Df Chisq `Pr(>Chisq)`
#>   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>        <dbl>
#> 1     5  -157.    NA  NA     NA
#> 2     2  -169.    -3  24.8    0.0000174
```

The likelihood ratio statistic for the test comparing the null model to the maximal model is

$$\lambda = 2 * (\ell_{\text{full}} - \ell_0) = 35.106732$$

where:

- ℓ_0 is the log-likelihood of the null model: -168.954967
- ℓ_{full} is the log-likelihood of the maximal model: -151.401601

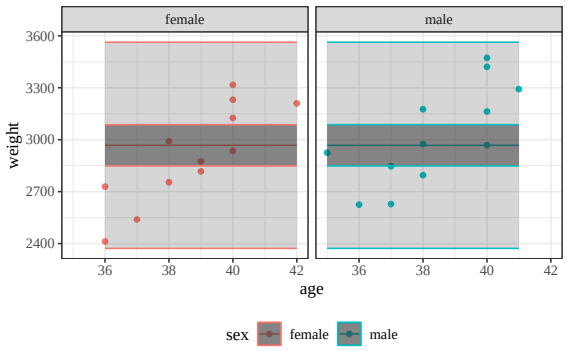
In R, this test is:

```r
lrtest(lm_max, lm0)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 5
#>   `#Df` LogLik    Df Chisq `Pr(>Chisq)`
#>   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>        <dbl>
```

```
#> 1    13  -151.    NA  NA      NA
#> 2     2  -169.   -11  35.1     0.000238
```

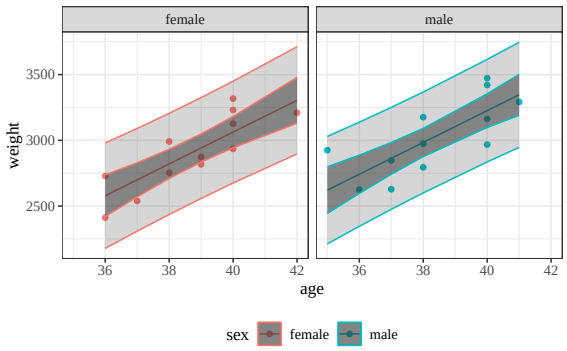
This log-likelihood ratio statistic is called the **null deviance**. It tells us whether we have enough data to detect a difference between the null and full models.

```
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw, lm0)
```



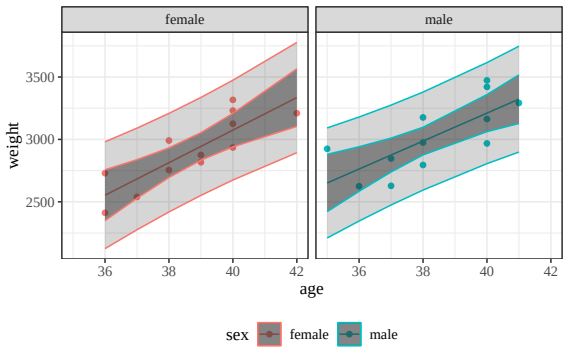
(a) Null model

```
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw, bw_lm1)
```



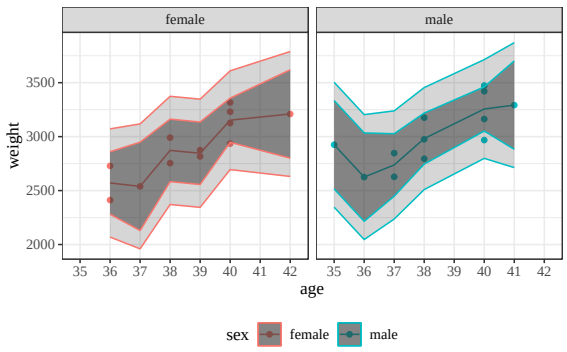
(b) No-interactions model (parallel slopes)

```
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw, bw_lm2)
```



(c) Model 2 (linear with age:sex interaction)

```
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw |> mutate(age = factor(age)), lm_max)
```



(d) Saturated model

Figure 11: Four models for `birthweight` data, with 95% confidence and prediction intervals. The spectrum from null to saturated includes many other possible models, such as quadratic polynomial models (with or without interactions) and generalized additive models (GAMs).

4.1.8 Gaussian Deviance vs. GLM Deviance

The residual deviance is a general concept that applies to all GLMs, including Gaussian linear regression. For any GLM, the residual deviance is:

$$D = 2(\ell_{\text{sat}} - \ell(\hat{\beta})) \tag{10}$$

where ℓ_{sat} is the log-likelihood of the saturated model and $\ell(\hat{\beta})$ is the log-likelihood of the fitted model. However, this formula simplifies differently depending on the distribution family, and the resulting test statistics have different null distributions.

Gaussian linear regression deviance

From Equation 6, the Gaussian log-likelihood is:

$$\ell(\hat{\beta}, \hat{\sigma}^2) = -\frac{n}{2}\log(2\pi\hat{\sigma}^2) - \frac{1}{2\hat{\sigma}^2}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2$$

The saturated model has one free mean parameter per distinct covariate pattern. When there are no replicates (each covariate pattern appears exactly once), it sets $\hat{\mu}_i = y_i$ for every observation, so its residual sum of squares is zero:

$$\ell_{\text{sat}}(\hat{\sigma}^2) = -\frac{n}{2}\log(2\pi\hat{\sigma}^2)$$

Substituting into Equation 10, the Gaussian deviance simplifies to the **residual sum of squares** (RSS), scaled by $\hat{\sigma}^2$:

$$D = 2(\ell_{\text{sat}} - \ell(\hat{\beta})) = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2}{\hat{\sigma}^2} = \frac{\text{RSS}}{\hat{\sigma}^2}$$

Because σ^2 is unknown and must be estimated, comparing deviances between two nested Gaussian models uses an **F-test**, which is exact under Gaussian assumptions. Substituting $D = \text{RSS}/\hat{\sigma}^2$, the $\hat{\sigma}^2$ factors cancel:

$$F = \frac{(D_1 - D_2)/(p_2 - p_1)}{D_2/(n - p_2)} = \frac{(\text{RSS}_1 - \text{RSS}_2)/(p_2 - p_1)}{\text{RSS}_2/(n - p_2)} \sim F_{p_2-p_1,\, n-p_2}$$

In R, `deviance()` applied to an `lm` object returns **RSS** (the unscaled deviance):

```
deviance(bw_lm2)
#> [1] 652425
sum(residuals(bw_lm2)^2)
#> [1] 652425
```

The two expressions return the same value.

The Gaussian linear regression model can equivalently be fit as a GLM with `family = gaussian`, which also returns RSS as the deviance:

```
bw_glm2 <- glm(
  weight ~ sex + age + sex:age,
  data = bw,
  family = gaussian
)

deviance(bw_lm2)
#> [1] 652425
deviance(bw_glm2)
#> [1] 652425
```

`deviance(bw_lm2)` and `deviance(bw_glm2)` return the same value, confirming that Gaussian linear regression is a special case of the GLM framework where the deviance equals RSS.

Non-Gaussian GLM deviance

For non-Gaussian GLMs, the deviance does **not** simplify to RSS. The formula depends on the distribution family:

Poisson:

$$D = 2\sum_{i=1}^{n}\left[y_i \log\left(\frac{y_i}{\hat{\mu}_i}\right) - (y_i - \hat{\mu}_i)\right]$$

Binomial:

$$D = 2\sum_{i=1}^{n}\left[y_i \log\left(\frac{y_i}{\hat{\pi}_i}\right) + (n_i - y_i)\log\left(\frac{n_i - y_i}{n_i - \hat{\pi}_i}\right)\right]$$

For Poisson and Binomial models, the dispersion parameter $\phi = 1$ is **fixed** rather than estimated. Consequently, the difference in deviances between two nested models follows an approximate χ^2 distribution:

$$D_1 - D_2 \dot{\sim} \chi^2_{p_2 - p_1}$$

This asymptotic result replaces the exact F-test used for Gaussian models.

Saturated vs. fully parametrized models with replicates

When some covariate patterns appear more than once (i.e., when there are **replicates**), it is important to distinguish between two special models:

- The **saturated model** has one free mean parameter per **distinct covariate pattern** (q parameters, where $q \leq n$ is the number of unique patterns).
- The **fully parametrized model** has one free mean parameter per **observation** (n parameters).

When there are no replicates ($q = n$), these two coincide. When there are replicates ($q < n$), the saturated model constrains all observations sharing a covariate pattern to have the same mean, but places no constraint on means across different patterns. See Kleinbaum and Klein (2010) for further discussion of this distinction.

Deviance is always measured relative to the **saturated model**, not the fully parametrized model.

Gaussian deviance with replicates

When covariate pattern k has n_k replicates with sample mean $\bar{y}_k$, the saturated model fits $\hat{\mu}_k = \bar{y}_k$ for each pattern k, so its residual sum of squares equals the **within-group (pure error) SS**:

$$\text{RSS}_{\text{sat}} = \sum_{k=1}^{q} \sum_{i:\tilde{x}_i = \tilde{x}_k} (y_i - \bar{y}_k)^2$$

This within-group residual sum of squares is nonzero whenever any covariate pattern has replicates with different response values. The Gaussian deviance relative to the saturated model is therefore:

$$D = 2(\ell_{\text{sat}} - \ell(\hat{\beta})) = \frac{\text{RSS} - \text{RSS}_{\text{sat}}}{\hat{\sigma}^2}$$

> **Note**
>
> R's `deviance()` applied to an `lm` object returns the **total fitted-model RSS**, not the deviance relative to the saturated model. To compute the deviance relative to the saturated model, subtract the saturated model's RSS: `deviance(lm_fit) - deviance(lm_saturated)`.

For the `birthweight` data, we can verify this directly using `bw_lm2` (the interaction model) and `lm_max` (the saturated model):

```
deviance(bw_lm2)                      # total RSS of fitted model
#> [1] 652425
deviance(lm_max)                      # within-group (pure error) SS
#> [1] 423783
deviance(bw_lm2) - deviance(lm_max)   # lack-of-fit SS (deviance vs. saturated)
#> [1] 228642
```

The lack-of-fit SS (`deviance(bw_lm2) - deviance(lm_max)`) measures how much additional unexplained variation remains after accounting for pure measurement error within covariate patterns.

GLM deviance with replicates

For a Binomial GLM fit to data **grouped by covariate pattern** (with y_k events and n_k observations for pattern k), the saturated model sets $\hat{\pi}_k^{\text{sat}} = y_k/n_k$ for each pattern k. R's `deviance()` correctly computes $2(\ell_{\text{sat}} - \ell(\hat{\beta}))$ using this grouping:

$$D = 2\sum_{k=1}^{q}\left[y_k \log\left(\frac{y_k/n_k}{\hat{\pi}_k}\right) + (n_k - y_k)\log\left(\frac{1-y_k/n_k}{1-\hat{\pi}_k}\right)\right]$$

By convention, terms with $y_k = 0$ or $y_k = n_k$ contribute zero to the sum, since $0\log(0) = 0$ in the limit.

When binomial data is **ungrouped** (individual Bernoulli observations, $n_i = 1$), R uses the **fully parametrized** model as its reference — assigning $\hat{\pi}_i = y_i \in \{0, 1\}$ to each individual observation. Since each predicted probability is exactly 0 or 1, every Bernoulli likelihood contribution equals 1, and hence $\ell_{\text{fp}} = 0$. Thus R's `deviance()` returns $-2\ell(\hat{\beta})$.

We can verify this directly: observations are ungrouped Bernoulli with repeated covariate patterns ($x \in \{0, 1\}$ appears three times each).

```
set.seed(42)
x_ug <- rep(0:1, each = 3)
y_ug <- c(0L, 1L, 0L, 1L, 1L, 0L)
fit_ug <- glm(y_ug ~ x_ug, family = binomial)
deviance(fit_ug)                      # R's deviance
#> [1] 7.63817
-2 * as.numeric(logLik(fit_ug))       # -2 * log-likelihood (using ell_fp = 0)
#> [1] 7.63817
```

The two values are equal, confirming that R uses $\ell_{\text{fp}} = 0$ as its reference when data are ungrouped.

> **Note**
>
> This reference model is the **fully parametrized** model (one parameter per observation), not the **saturated** model (one parameter per distinct covariate pattern). They coincide only when there are no repeated covariate patterns ($q = n$). When patterns do repeat ($q < n$), the saturated model sets $\hat{\pi}_k = y_k/n_k$ per pattern, giving $\ell_{\text{sat}} < 0$.
> `deviance()` for ungrouped data **cannot** be used as a goodness-of-fit test against the χ^2 distribution when $q < n$. The correct GOF statistic is $2(\ell_{\text{sat}} - \ell(\hat{\beta}))$, but R's `deviance()` for ungrouped data returns $-2\ell(\hat{\beta})$ (using $\ell_{\text{fp}} = 0$). These two quantities differ by $-2\ell_{\text{sat}} > 0$ whenever $q < n$. Even if each covariate pattern has many replicates (large n_k), R's ungrouped deviance is the wrong statistic to compare against $\chi^2(q-p)$. To obtain a valid GOF test when patterns repeat, fit the model using **grouped** data (one row per pattern with y_k and n_k), so that R uses the saturated model as its reference.
> For further discussion, see Dunn and Smyth (2018, chap. 9) and this Stats Stack Exchange thread[a].
>
> [a] https://stats.stackexchange.com/questions/626597/is-there-a-justification-for-the-bernoulli-deviance-in-the-r-stats-package

Summary

Feature	Gaussian linear regression	Non-Gaussian GLMs (e.g., Poisson, Binomial)
Deviance formula	$(\text{RSS} - \text{RSS}_{\text{sat}})/\hat{\sigma}^2$	$2(\ell_{\text{sat}} - \ell(\hat{\beta}))$
`deviance()` in R	Returns total RSS	Returns $2(\ell_{\text{sat}} - \ell(\hat{\beta}))$
Saturated model reference	Per covariate pattern	Per covariate pattern (grouped) or per observation (ungrouped)
Dispersion ϕ	Unknown; estimated as $s^2 = \text{RSS}/(n-p)$	Fixed ($\phi = 1$)
Test for nested models	F-test (exact)	χ^2-test (asymptotic)

4.2 Diagnostics

> **Tip**
>
> This section is adapted from Dobson and Barnett (2018, secs. 6.2–6.3) and Dunn and Smyth (2018) Chapter 3[a].
>
> [a] https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-1-4419-0118-7_3

4.2.1 Assumptions in linear regression models

$$Y_i|\tilde{X}_i \sim_{\perp\!\!\!\perp} \text{N}(\mu_i, \sigma^2)$$

$$\mu_i = \tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{\beta}$$

1. **Normality**

The model assumes that the distribution conditional on a given X value is Gaussian.

2. **Correct Functional Form** of Conditional Mean Structure (Linear Component)

The model assumes that the conditional means have the structure:

$$\text{E}\left[Y|\tilde{X} = \tilde{x}\right] = \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{\beta}$$

3. **Homoskedasticity**

The model assumes that variance σ^2 is constant (with respect to $\tilde{x}$).

4. **Independence**

The model assumes that the observations are statistically independent.

4.2.2 Direct visualization

The most direct way to examine the fit of a model is to compare it to the raw observed data.

```
bw <-
  bw |>
  mutate(
    predlm2 = predict(bw_lm2)
  ) |>
  arrange(sex, age)

plot1_interact <-
  plot1 %+% bw +
  geom_line(aes(y = predlm2))

print(plot1_interact)
```

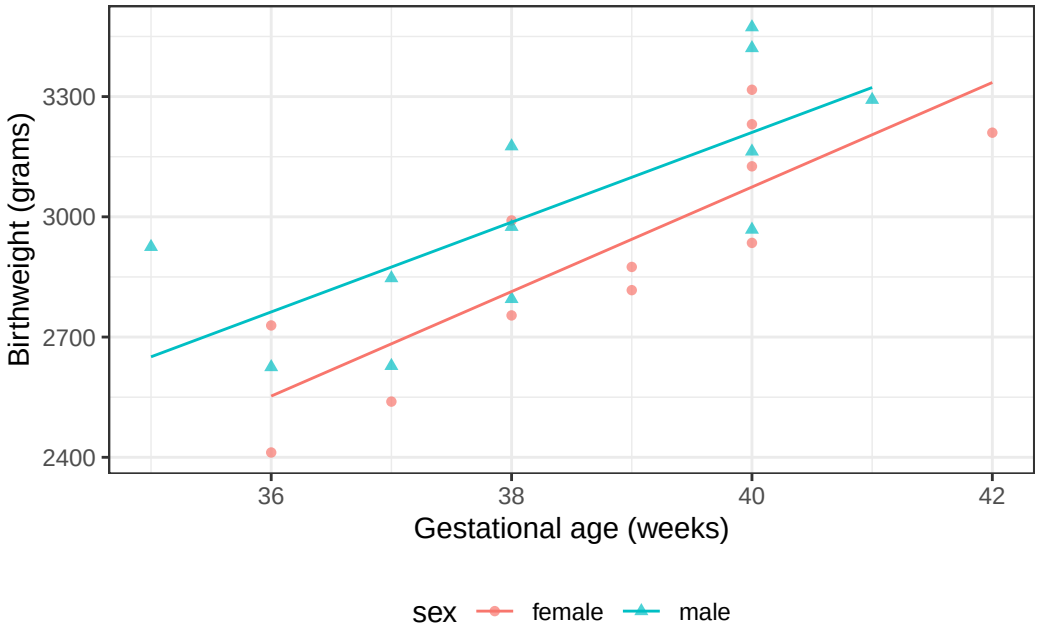


Figure 12: Birthweight model with interaction term

It's not easy to assess these assumptions from this model. If there are multiple continuous covariates, it becomes even harder to visualize the raw data.

Fitted model for `hers` data

Consider the `hers` data from Vittinghoff et al. (2012).

The "heart and estrogen/progestin study" (HERS) was a clinical trial of hormone therapy for prevention of recurrent heart attacks and death among 2,763 post-menopausal women with existing coronary heart disease (CHD) (Hulley et al. 1998).

The trial was conducted at 20 US clinical centers. Participants were randomized to receive either conjugated equine estrogens (0.625 mg/day) plus medroxyprogesterone acetate (2.5 mg/day) or a matching placebo (Hulley et al. 1998). Women were followed for an average of 4.1 years (Hulley et al. 1998).

The primary outcome was nonfatal myocardial infarction or CHD death (Hulley et al. 1998).

Table 24: `hers` data

```
hers <- rmb::hers |> haven::zap_labels()
hers
#> # A tibble: 2,763 x 37
#>       HT   age raceth nonwhite smoking drinkany exercise physact globrat
#>    <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl>    <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl>    <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl>
#>  1     0    70      2        1       0        0        0       5       3
#>  2     0    62      2        1       0        0        0       1       3
#>  3     1    69      1        0       0        0        0       3       3
#>  4     0    64      1        0       1        1        0       1       3
#>  5     0    65      1        0       0        0        0       2       3
#>  6     1    68      2        1       0        1        0       3       3
#>  7     0    70      1        0       0        0        0       3       2
#>  8     1    69      1        0       0        0        1       5       4
#>  9     1    61      1        0       0        1        1       3       4
#> 10     1    62      1        0       1        1        0       2       3
#> # i 2,753 more rows
#> # i 28 more variables: poorfair <dbl>, medcond <dbl>, htnmeds <dbl>,
#> #   statins <dbl>, diabetes <dbl>, dmpills <dbl>, insulin <dbl>, weight <dbl>,
#> #   BMI <dbl>, waist <dbl>, WHR <dbl>, glucose <dbl>, weight1 <dbl>,
#> #   BMI1 <dbl>, waist1 <dbl>, WHR1 <dbl>, glucose1 <dbl>, tchol <dbl>,
#> #   LDL <dbl>, HDL <dbl>, TG <dbl>, tchol1 <dbl>, LDL1 <dbl>, HDL1 <dbl>,
#> #   TG1 <dbl>, SBP <dbl>, DBP <dbl>, age10 <dbl>
```

Suppose we consider models with and without intercept terms (i.e., possibly forcing the intercept to go through 0):

```
hers_lm_with_int <- lm(
  na.action = na.exclude,
  LDL ~ smoking * age, data = hers
)


library(equatiomatic)
equatiomatic::extract_eq(hers_lm_with_int)
```

$$\text{LDL} = \alpha + \beta_1(\text{smoking}) + \beta_2(\text{age}) + \beta_3(\text{smoking} \times \text{age}) + \epsilon \tag{11}$$

```
hers_lm_no_int <- lm(
  na.action = na.exclude,
  LDL ~ age + smoking:age - 1, data = hers
)

library(equatiomatic)
equatiomatic::extract_eq(hers_lm_no_int)
```

$$\text{LDL} = \beta_1(\text{age}) + \beta_2(\text{age} \times \text{age}_{\text{smoking}}) + \epsilon \tag{12}$$

Table 25: `hers` data models with and without intercepts

(a) With intercept

```
library(gtsummary)
hers_lm_with_int |>
  tbl_regression(intercept = TRUE)
```

Characteristic	Beta	95% CI	p-value
(Intercept)	154	138, 170	<0.001
current smoker	54	15, 94	0.007
age in years	-0.14	-0.38, 0.09	0.2
current smoker * age in years	-0.79	-1.4, -0.17	0.012

Abbreviation: CI = Confidence Interval

(b) No intercept

```
hers_lm_no_int |>
  tbl_regression(intercept = TRUE)
```

Characteristic	Beta	95% CI	p-value
age in years	2.1	2.1, 2.2	<0.001
age in years * current smoker	0.19	0.12, 0.26	<0.001

Abbreviation: CI = Confidence Interval

```r
library(sjPlot)

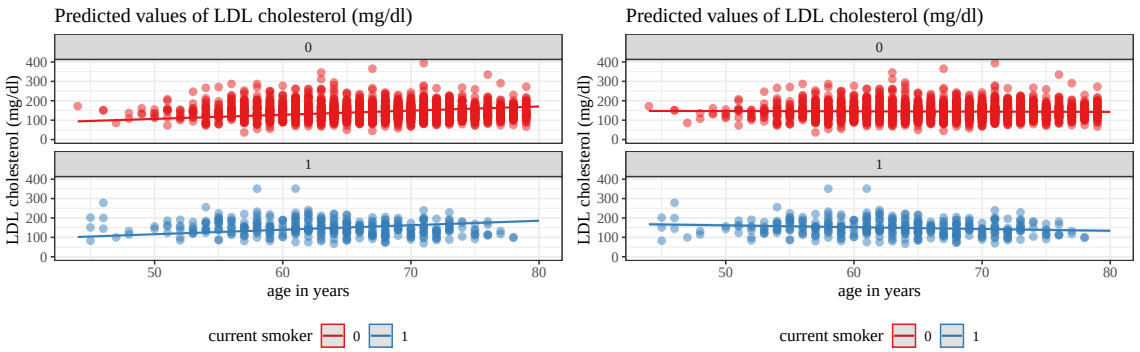
hers_plot1 <- hers_lm_no_int |>
  sjPlot::plot_model(
    type = "pred",
    terms = c("age", "smoking"),
    show.data = TRUE
  ) +
  facet_wrap(~group_col, ncol = 1) +
  expand_limits(y = 0) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom")

hers_plot1
```

```r
library(sjPlot)

hers_plot2 <- hers_lm_with_int |>
  sjPlot::plot_model(
    type = "pred",
    terms = c("age", "smoking"),
    show.data = TRUE
  ) +
  facet_wrap(~group_col, ncol = 1) +
  expand_limits(y = 0) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom")

hers_plot2
```



(a) No intercept

(b) With intercept

Figure 13: `hers` data models with and without intercepts

4.2.3 Residuals

Maybe we can transform the data and model in some way to make it easier to inspect.

Definition 4.4 (Deviation of an observation from its subpopulation mean)**.** The **deviation of an observation from its subpopulation mean** in a probabilistic model $p(Y \mid X)$, is the difference between an observed value and its model-implied mean given covariates:

$$e(y_i) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} y_i - \mathrm{E}[Y_i \mid X_i] \tag{13}$$

Many sources call deviations "error" or "noise." The model-implied mean can be viewed as an estimate of Y_i, before y_i is observed. However, an estimation error is defined as an estimate minus its estimand (see estimation error[12]), and deviation is the observed value minus its estimand, so the deviation is actually the *negative* of the estimation error of the mean $\mathrm{E}[Y_i \mid X_i]$ with respect to its estimand Y_i:

$$e(y_i) = -(\mathrm{E}[Y_i \mid X_i] - y_i)$$

On the other hand, each observation y_i can be viewed as a nonparametric estimate of $\mu_i = \mathrm{E}[Y_i \mid X_i]$ (albeit an imprecise one, individually, since $n = 1$):

$$y_i = \hat{\mu}_i^{(NP)}$$

where $\hat{\mu}_i^{(NP)}$ denotes the nonparametric estimate from a single observed value y_i.

[12] https://morrison-lab.github.io/sds/estimation.html#def-estimation-error

Thus, the deviation can be interpreted as the estimation error of y_i with respect to $\mathrm{E}[Y_i \mid X_i]$:

$$\begin{aligned} e(y_i) &= y_i - \mu_i \\ &= \hat{\mu}_i^{(NP)} - \mu_i \\ &= \varepsilon\left(\hat{\mu}_i^{(NP)}\right) \end{aligned}$$

We can rearrange Equation 13 to view y_i as the sum of its mean plus the deviation (often called error/noise):

$$y_i = \mathrm{E}[Y_i \mid X_i] + e(y_i)$$

Definition 4.5 (Signal (statistical sense))**.** In statistical modeling, the **signal** is the deterministic part of the model. For mean-based models, the signal is the model-implied mean function, for example $\mathrm{E}[Y \mid X]$ (or $\mathrm{E}[Y]$ when there are no covariates).

Theorem 4.1 (Deviations in Gaussian models)**.** *If Y has a Gaussian distribution, then $e(Y)$ also has a Gaussian distribution, and vice versa.*

Proof

Proof. By Definition 4.4, $e(Y \mid X = x) = Y - \mathrm{E}[Y \mid X = x]$. Let $\mu(x) = \mathrm{E}[Y \mid X = x]$. Since $e(Y \mid X = x) = Y - \mu(x)$ is an affine function of Y, and Gaussian distributions are closed under affine transformations, if $Y \mid X = x \sim \mathrm{N}(\mu(x), \sigma^2)$, then:

$$e(Y \mid X = x) = Y - \mu(x) \sim \mathrm{N}(\mu(x) - \mu(x), \sigma^2) = \mathrm{N}(0, \sigma^2)$$

Conversely, since $Y = \mathrm{E}[Y \mid X = x] + e(Y \mid X = x) = \mu(x) + e(Y \mid X = x)$, if $e(Y \mid X = x) \sim \mathrm{N}(0, \sigma^2)$, then $Y \mid X = x = \mu(x) + e(Y \mid X = x) \sim \mathrm{N}(\mu(x), \sigma^2)$. □

Definition 4.6 (Residuals)**.** A **residual** is the difference between an observed value and its corresponding fitted value, $\hat{y}$:

$$r \overset{\text{def}}{=} y - \hat{y}$$

For indexed observations, the residual is defined as:

$$r_i \overset{\text{def}}{=} y_i - \hat{y}_i$$

For a particular fitted model, each residual r_i is tied to its corresponding fitted value $\hat{y}_i$. The fitted value $\hat{y}_i$ is often a sample mean or fitted conditional mean, but not always.

Exm

Example 4.2 (Residuals in `birthweight` data)**.**

```
plot1_interact +
  facet_wrap(~sex) +
  geom_segment(
    aes(
      x = age,
      y = predlm2,
      xend = age,
      yend = weight,
      col = sex,
      group = id
    ),
    linetype = "dotted"
  )
```

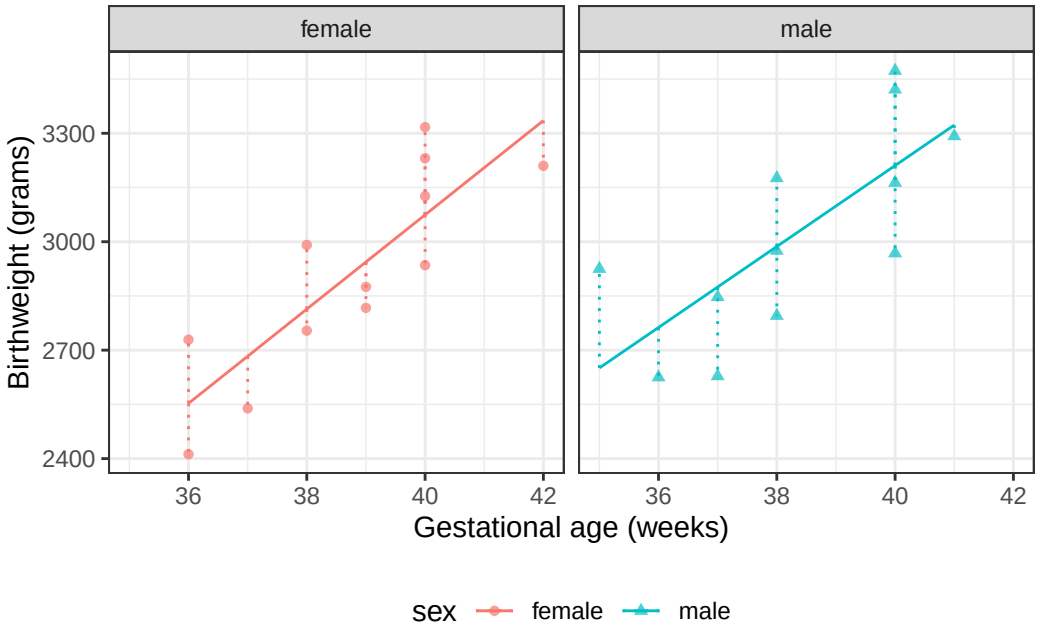


Figure 14: Fitted values and residuals for interaction model for `birthweight` data

---

4.3 Residuals of fitted values vs subpopulation-mean deviations

The residual is a plug-in estimate of the deviation of an observation from its subpopulation mean:

$$\begin{aligned} e(y_i) &= y_i - \mathrm{E}[Y_i \mid X_i] \\ \hat{e}(y_i) &= y_i - \hat{y}_i \\ &= r_i \end{aligned}$$

Different sources are not fully consistent about these terms. For terminology in this course, we use:

- **deviation** for deviation of an observation from its population mean (typically conditional on covariates). This quantity is often called **error** in other sources, even though it doesn't directly involve an estimate; cf., https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Errors_and_residuals;
- **estimation error** for deviation of an estimate from its estimand;
- **residual** for deviation of an observed value from a fitted value.

4.4 General characteristics of residuals

Definition 4.7 (Hat matrix)**.** For an ordinary least squares linear model with design matrix $\mathbf{X}$, the **hat matrix** is

$$H = \mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top$$

so the fitted values satisfy

$$\hat{\tilde{Y}} = H\tilde{Y}$$

Theorem 4.2 (Mean and variance of residuals)**.** *For an ordinary least squares linear model with fitted values $\hat{y}_i = \tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{\beta}$ (and fitted-value vector $\hat{\tilde{Y}}$), if the conditional mean is correctly specified so that:*

$$\mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] = \mathbf{X}\beta$$

equivalently:

$$\mathrm{E}\left[\hat{\tilde{Y}} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] = \mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right]$$

and if the errors are homoskedastic so that $\mathrm{Var}\left(\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right) = \sigma^2 \mathbb{I}_n$ where $\mathbb{I}_n$ is the $n \times n$ identity matrix, then, treating $\mathbf{X}$ as fixed in this derivation, the residual moments are:

$$\mathrm{E}[\tilde{r} \mid \mathbf{X}] = 0 \tag{14}$$

$$\mathrm{Var}(r_i \mid \mathbf{X}) = \sigma^2(1 - h_{ii}) \tag{15}$$

The conditional mean result (Equation 14) uses unbiasedness of fitted values. The conditional variance result (Equation 15) uses the homoskedasticity condition with the OLS hat-matrix representation.
When leverage is roughly uniform, $h_{ii} \approx k/n$, where $k = \mathrm{rank}(\mathbf{X})$ (so $k = p + 1$ for a full-rank model with an intercept and p predictors), so $\mathrm{Var}(r_i) \approx \sigma^2$ as n grows.

Proof

Proof. Equation 14:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathrm{E}[\tilde{r} \mid \mathbf{X}] &= \mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} - \hat{\tilde{Y}} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] \\
&= \mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] - \mathrm{E}\left[\hat{\tilde{Y}} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] \\
&= \mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] - \mathrm{E}\left[H\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] \\
&= \mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] - H\,\mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] \\
&= \mathrm{E}\left[\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\right] - H\mathbf{X}\beta \\
&= \mathbf{X}\beta - H\mathbf{X}\beta \\
&= \mathbf{X}\beta - \mathbf{X}\beta \\
&= \tilde{0}
\end{aligned}$$

Equation 15:

$$
\begin{aligned}
\tilde{r} &= (\mathbb{I}_n - H)\tilde{Y} \\
\operatorname{Var}(\tilde{r} \mid \mathbf{X}) &= \operatorname{Var}\Big((\mathbb{I}_n - H)\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\Big) \\
&= (\mathbb{I}_n - H)\operatorname{Var}\Big(\tilde{Y} \mid \mathbf{X}\Big)(\mathbb{I}_n - H)^\top \\
&= (\mathbb{I}_n - H)\sigma^2\mathbb{I}_n(\mathbb{I}_n - H)^\top \\
&= \sigma^2(\mathbb{I}_n - H)(\mathbb{I}_n - H)^\top \\
&= \sigma^2(\mathbb{I}_n - H)^2 \\
&= \sigma^2(\mathbb{I}_n - 2H + H^2) \\
&= \sigma^2(\mathbb{I}_n - H) \qquad (\text{since } H^2 = H) \\
\operatorname{Var}(r_i \mid \mathbf{X}) &= [\operatorname{Var}(\tilde{r} \mid \mathbf{X})]_{ii} \\
&= [\sigma^2(\mathbb{I}_n - H)]_{ii} \\
&= \sigma^2(1 - h_{ii})
\end{aligned}
$$

□

Theorem 4.3 (Conditional distribution of residuals in Gaussian models)**.** *In a Gaussian linear regression model, the residuals r_i, conditional on the design matrix $\mathbf{X}$, are normally distributed:*

$$r_i \mid \mathbf{X} \sim \mathrm{N}(0,\ \sigma^2(1 - h_{ii})) \tag{16}$$

where h_{ii} is the i-th diagonal element of the hat matrix (Definition 4.7). When leverage is roughly uniform, $\sigma^2(1 - h_{ii}) \approx \sigma^2$ for large n; replacing the unknown σ^2 with its estimate $\hat{\sigma}^2$ gives:

$$r_i \approx \mathrm{N}(0, \hat{\sigma}^2) \tag{17}$$

Proof

Proof. Using the hat matrix (Definition 4.7), the residual vector is $\tilde{r} = (I - H)\tilde{Y}$, so the i-th residual is a linear combination of the observations:

$$r_i = [(I - H)\tilde{Y}]_i = \sum_{j=1}^{n} (\delta_{ij} - h_{ij})\, Y_j$$

where δ_{ij} is the Kronecker delta ($\delta_{ij} = 1$ if $i = j$, else $\delta_{ij} = 0$).
Given $\mathbf{X}$, the random variables $Y_1, \ldots, Y_n$ are conditionally independent Gaussians by the Gaussian model assumption. Therefore, conditional on $\mathbf{X}$, the residual r_i is a linear combination of independent Gaussians, so r_i is Gaussian.
The mean and variance follow from Theorem 4.2:

$$
\begin{aligned}
\mathrm{E}[r_i \mid \mathbf{X}] &= 0 \\
\operatorname{Var}(r_i \mid \mathbf{X}) &= \sigma^2(1 - h_{ii})
\end{aligned}
$$

Therefore $r_i \mid \mathbf{X} \sim \mathrm{N}(0, \sigma^2(1 - h_{ii}))$. □

4.5 Computing residuals in R

R provides a function for residuals:

```
resid(bw_lm2)
#>         1         2         3         4         5         6         7         8
#>  176.2667 -140.7333 -144.1333  -59.5333  177.4667 -126.9333  -68.9333  242.6667
#>         9        10        11        12        13        14        15        16
#> -139.3333   51.6667  156.6667 -125.1333  274.2759 -137.7069  -27.6897 -246.6897
#>        17        18        19        20        21        22        23        24
#> -191.6724  189.3276  -11.6724 -242.6379  -47.6379  262.3621  210.3621  -30.6207
```

Exercise 4.2. Check R's output by computing the residuals directly.

Solution

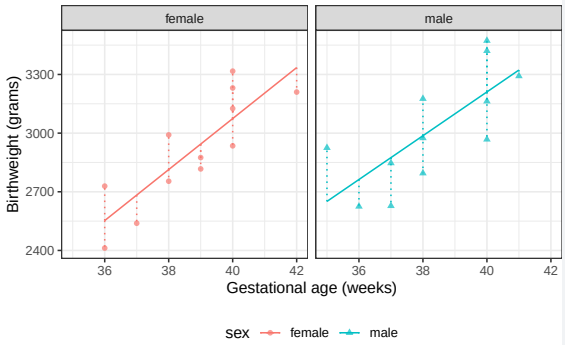
Solution.

```
bw$weight - fitted(bw_lm2)
#>         1         2         3         4         5         6         7         8
#>  176.2667 -140.7333 -144.1333  -59.5333  177.4667 -126.9333  -68.9333  242.6667
#>         9        10        11        12        13        14        15        16
#> -139.3333   51.6667  156.6667 -125.1333  274.2759 -137.7069  -27.6897 -246.6897
#>        17        18        19        20        21        22        23        24
#> -191.6724  189.3276  -11.6724 -242.6379  -47.6379  262.3621  210.3621  -30.6207
```

This manually calculated vector matches R's output!

4.6 Graphing the residuals

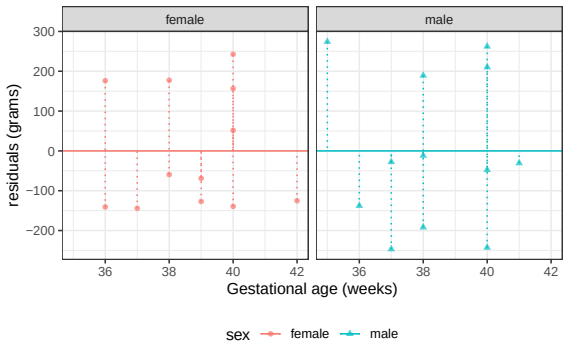
```
plot1_interact +
  facet_wrap(~sex) +
  geom_segment(
    aes(
      x = age,
      y = predlm2,
      xend = age,
      yend = weight,
      col = sex,
      group = id
    ),
    linetype = "dotted"
  )
```



(a) fitted values

```
bw <- bw |>
  mutate(
    resids_intxn =
      weight - fitted(bw_lm2)
  )

plot_bw_resid <-
  bw |>
  ggplot(aes(
    x = age,
    y = resids_intxn,
    linetype = sex,
    shape = sex,
    col = sex
  )) +
  theme_bw() +
  xlab("Gestational age (weeks)") +
  ylab("residuals (grams)") +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom") +
  geom_hline(aes(
    yintercept = 0,
    col = sex
  )) +
  geom_segment(
    aes(yend = 0),
    linetype = "dotted"
  ) +
  geom_point(alpha = .7)
# expand_limits(y = 0, x = 0)
print(plot_bw_resid + facet_wrap(~sex))
```



(b) Residuals

Figure 15: Fitted values and residuals for interaction model for `birthweight` data

---

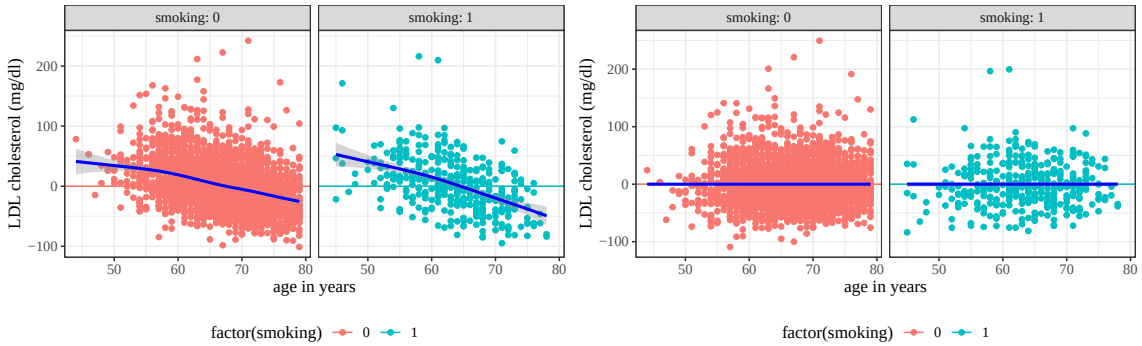
4.7 Residuals versus predictors

```
hers <- hers |>
  mutate(
    resids_no_intcpt =
      LDL - fitted(hers_lm_no_int),
    resids_with_intcpt =
```

```
      LDL - fitted(hers_lm_with_int)
  )
```

```
hers |>
  arrange(age) |>
  ggplot() +
  aes(x = age, y = resids_no_intcpt, col
  geom_point() +
  geom_hline(aes(yintercept = 0, col = fa
  facet_wrap(~smoking, labeller = "label_
  theme(legend.position = "bottom") +
  geom_smooth(col = "blue")
```

```
hers |>
  arrange(age) |>
  ggplot() +
  aes(x = age, y = resids_with_intcpt, col = factor(smoking
  geom_point() +
  geom_hline(aes(yintercept = 0, col = factor(smoking))) +
  facet_wrap(~smoking, labeller = "label_both") +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom") +
  geom_smooth(col = "blue")
```



(a) no intercept

(b) with intercept

Figure 16: Residuals of `hers` data vs predictors

4.8 Residuals versus fitted values

If the model contains multiple continuous covariates, how do we check for errors in the mean structure assumption?

```
library(ggfortify)
hers_lm_no_int |>
  update(na.action = na.omit) |>
  autoplot(
    which = 1,
    ncol = 1,
    smooth.colour = NA
  ) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, col = "red")
```

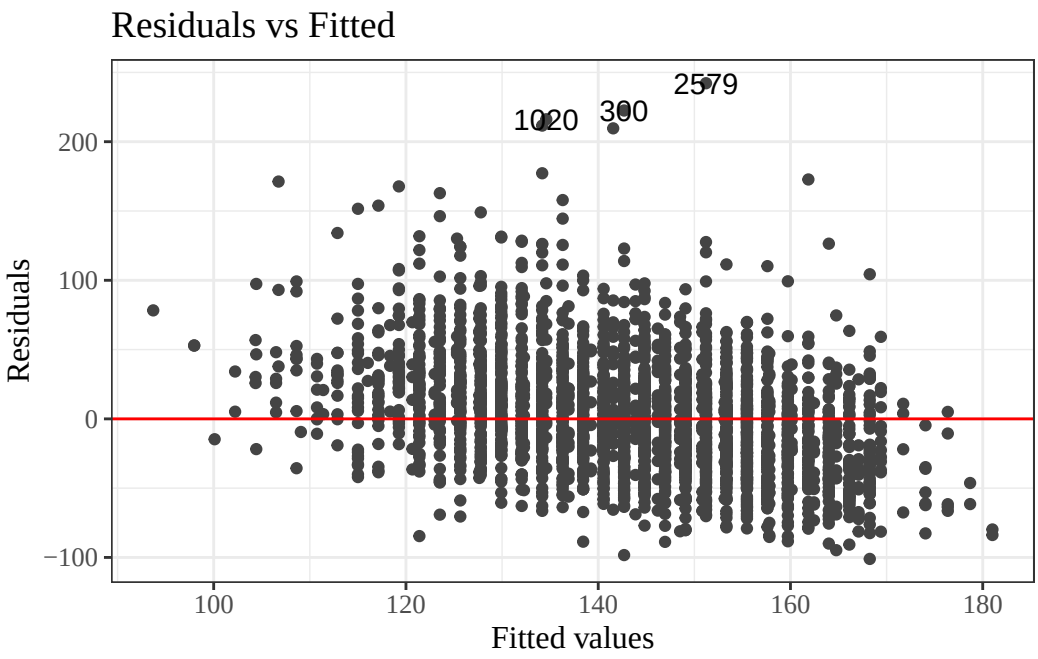


Figure 17: Residuals of interaction model for `hers` data

We can add a LOESS smooth to visualize where the residual mean is nonzero:

```
library(ggfortify)
hers_lm_no_int |>
  update(na.action = na.omit) |>
  autoplot(
    which = 1,
    ncol = 1
  ) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, col = "red")
```

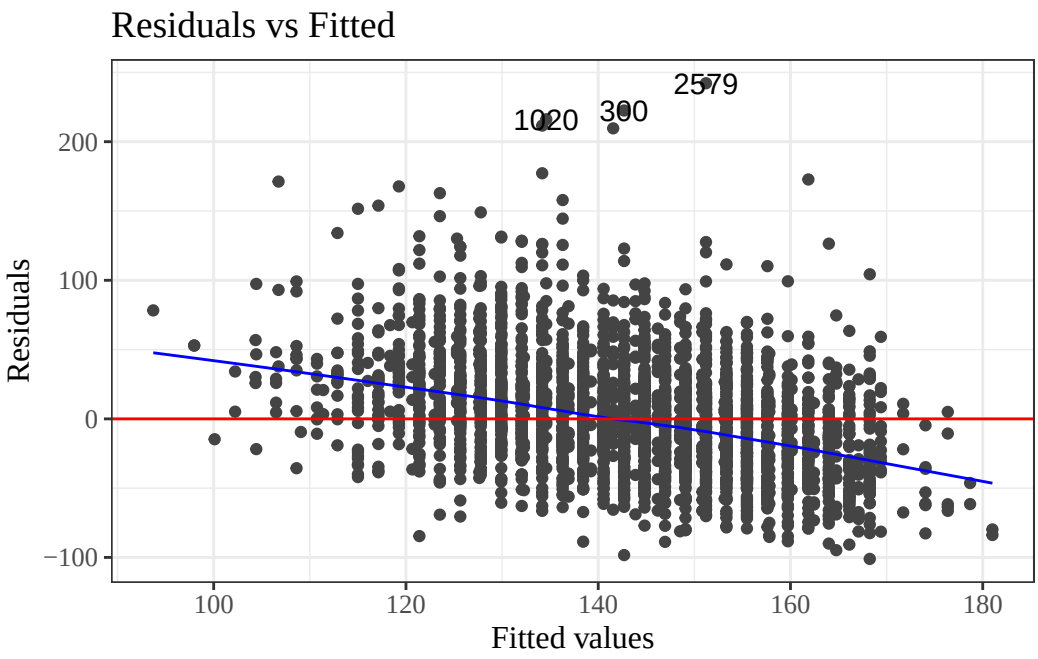
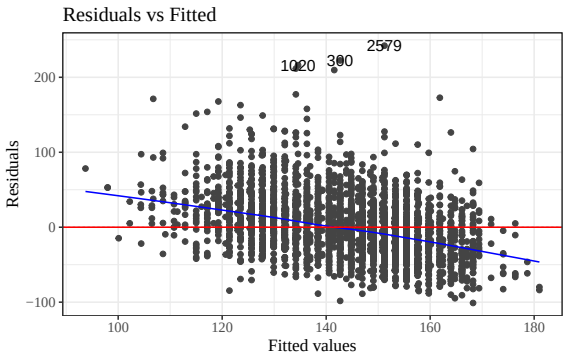


Figure 18: Residuals of interaction model for `hers` data, no intercept term

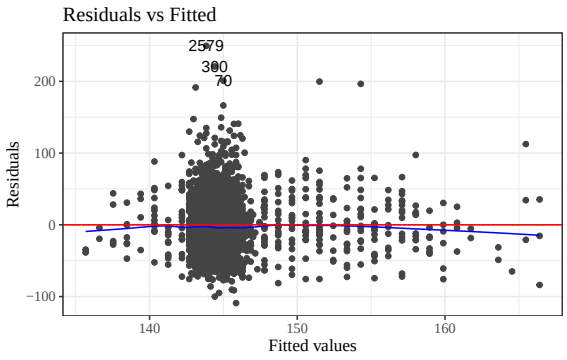
---

```
library(ggfortify)
hers_lm_no_int |>
  update(na.action = na.omit) |>
  autoplot(
    which = 1,
    ncol = 1
  ) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, col = "red")
```



(a) no intercept term

```
hers_lm_with_int |>
  update(na.action = na.omit) |>
  autoplot(
    which = 1,
    ncol = 1
  ) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, col = "red")
```



(b) with intercept term

Figure 19: Residuals of interaction model for `hers` data, with and without intercept term

---

Definition 4.8 (Standardized residuals)**.** For an ordinary linear model, the estimated standard deviation of the ith residual is

$$\widehat{\mathrm{SD}}(r_i) = \hat{\sigma}\sqrt{1 - h_{ii}}$$

so the standardized residual is

$$r'_i = \frac{r_i}{\widehat{\mathrm{SD}}(r_i)} = \frac{r_i}{\hat{\sigma}\sqrt{1-h_{ii}}}$$

Hence, with enough data and a correct model, each standardized residual has an approximately standard Gaussian **marginal** distribution; that is,

$$r'_i \dot{\sim} N(0,1)$$

but they are not independent. If H is the hat matrix with entries h_{ij}, then

$$\mathrm{Cov}(r_i, r_j \mid \mathbf{X}) = \begin{cases} \sigma^2(1-h_{ii}), & i = j, \\ -\sigma^2 h_{ij}, & i \neq j, \end{cases}$$

and therefore

$$\mathrm{Cov}(r'_i, r'_j \mid \mathbf{X}) \approx \begin{cases} 1, & i = j, \\ \dfrac{-h_{ij}}{\sqrt{(1-h_{ii})(1-h_{jj})}}, & i \neq j, \end{cases}$$

In particular, for $i \neq j$, these covariances are generally nonzero.

4.8.1 Marginal distributions of residuals

To look for problems with our model, we can check whether the residuals r_i and standardized residuals r'_i look like they have the distributions that they are supposed to have, according to the model.

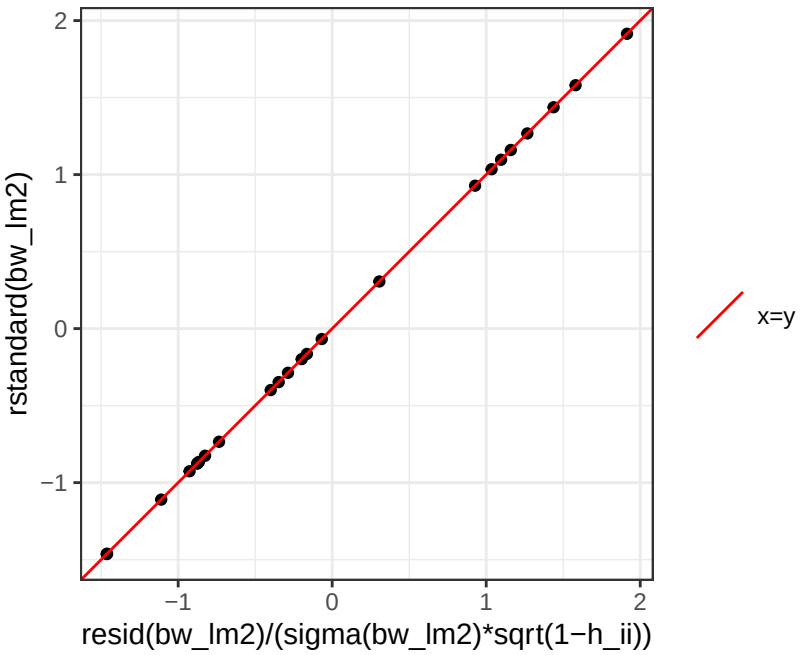
Standardized residuals in R

```
h_ii <- hatvalues(bw_lm2)
manual_std_resid <- resid(bw_lm2) / (sigma(bw_lm2) * sqrt(1 - h_ii))
manual_std_resid
#>          1          2          3          4          5          6          7
#>  1.1598166 -0.9260109 -0.8747917 -0.3472255  1.0350665 -0.7347315 -0.3990086
#>          8          9         10         11         12         13         14
#>  1.4375164 -0.8253872  0.3060646  0.9280669 -0.8761592  1.9142780 -0.8655921
#>         15         16         17         18         19         20         21
#> -0.1642993 -1.4637574 -1.1101599  1.0965787 -0.0676062 -1.4615865 -0.2869582
#>         22         23         24
#>  1.5803994  1.2671652 -0.1980543
rstandard(bw_lm2)
#>          1          2          3          4          5          6          7
#>  1.1598166 -0.9260109 -0.8747917 -0.3472255  1.0350665 -0.7347315 -0.3990086
#>          8          9         10         11         12         13         14
#>  1.4375164 -0.8253872  0.3060646  0.9280669 -0.8761592  1.9142780 -0.8655921
#>         15         16         17         18         19         20         21
#> -0.1642993 -1.4637574 -1.1101599  1.0965787 -0.0676062 -1.4615865 -0.2869582
#>         22         23         24
#>  1.5803994  1.2671652 -0.1980543
```

These residual vectors are nearly identical. Any differences are from numerical rounding.

```
rstandard_compare_plot <-
  tibble(
    x = resid(bw_lm2) / (sigma(bw_lm2) * sqrt(1 - h_ii)),
    y = rstandard(bw_lm2)
  ) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = x, y = y)) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_bw() +
  coord_equal() +
  xlab("resid(bw_lm2)/(sigma(bw_lm2)*sqrt(1-h_ii))") +
  ylab("rstandard(bw_lm2)") +
  geom_abline(
    aes(
      intercept = 0,
      slope = 1,
      col = "x=y"
    )
  ) +
  labs(colour = "") +
  scale_colour_manual(values = "red")

print(rstandard_compare_plot)
```



Let's add these residuals to the `tibble` of our dataset:

```
bw <-
  bw |>
  mutate(
    fitted_lm2 = fitted(bw_lm2),
    resid_lm2 = resid(bw_lm2),
    resid_lm2_alt = weight - fitted_lm2,
    std_resid_lm2 = rstandard(bw_lm2),
    std_resid_lm2_alt =
      resid_lm2 / (sigma(bw_lm2) * sqrt(1 - h_ii))
  )
```

```
bw |>
  select(
    sex,
    age,
    weight,
    fitted_lm2,
    resid_lm2,
    std_resid_lm2
  )
#> # A tibble: 24 x 6
#>    sex      age weight fitted_lm2 resid_lm2 std_resid_lm2
#>    <fct>  <dbl>  <dbl>      <dbl>     <dbl>         <dbl>
#>  1 female    36   2729      2553.     176.          1.16
#>  2 female    36   2412      2553.    -141.         -0.926
#>  3 female    37   2539      2683.    -144.         -0.875
#>  4 female    38   2754      2814.     -59.5        -0.347
#>  5 female    38   2991      2814.     177.          1.04
#>  6 female    39   2817      2944.    -127.         -0.735
#>  7 female    39   2875      2944.     -68.9        -0.399
#>  8 female    40   3317      3074.     243.          1.44
#>  9 female    40   2935      3074.    -139.         -0.825
#> 10 female    40   3126      3074.      51.7         0.306
#> # i 14 more rows
```

Now let's build histograms:

```
resid_marginal_hist <-
  bw |>
  ggplot(aes(x = resid_lm2)) +
  geom_histogram()

print(resid_marginal_hist)
```

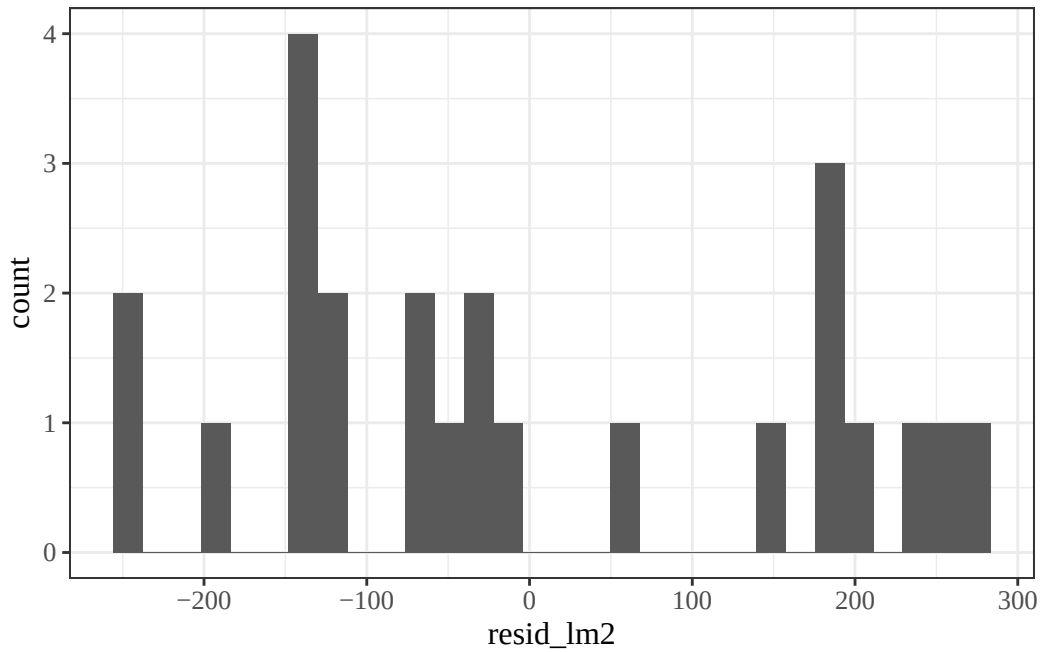


Figure 20: Marginal distribution of (nonstandardized) residuals

Hard to tell with this small amount of data, but I'm a bit concerned that the histogram doesn't show a bell-curve shape.

```
std_resid_marginal_hist <-
  bw |>
  ggplot(aes(x = std_resid_lm2)) +
  geom_histogram()

print(std_resid_marginal_hist)
```

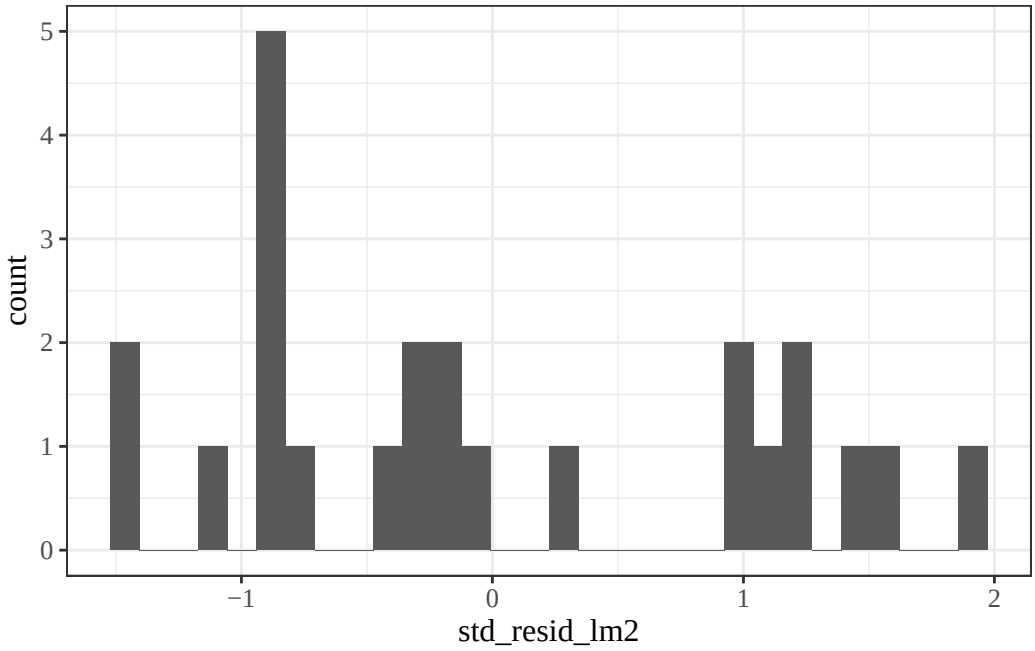


Figure 21: Marginal distribution of standardized residuals

This standardized residual histogram looks similar, although the scale of the x-axis got narrower, because we divided by $\hat{\sigma}$ (roughly speaking).

Still hard to tell if the distribution is Gaussian.

4.8.2 QQ plot of standardized residuals

Another way to assess whether the standardized residuals follow a standard normal distribution is a **quantile-quantile (QQ) plot**.

A QQ plot compares the empirical distribution of a dataset to a theoretical reference distribution. Each point corresponds to one observation:

- The **x-axis** (Theoretical Quantiles) shows the $N(0,1)$ quantile corresponding to the plotting position p_i used for the ith ordered residual. In R, `qqnorm()` obtains these plotting positions from `ppoints(n)`.
- The **y-axis** (Standardized Residuals) shows the observed standardized residuals, plotted in increasing order as $r_{(1)} \leq \cdots \leq r_{(n)}$. In QQ-plot terminology, these ordered values are sample quantiles[13]. The QQ plot uses points

$$\left(\Phi^{-1}(p_i),\, r_{(i)}\right), \quad i = 1, \ldots, n,$$

[13] https://morrison-lab.github.io/sds/nonparametric-models.html#def-sample-quantile

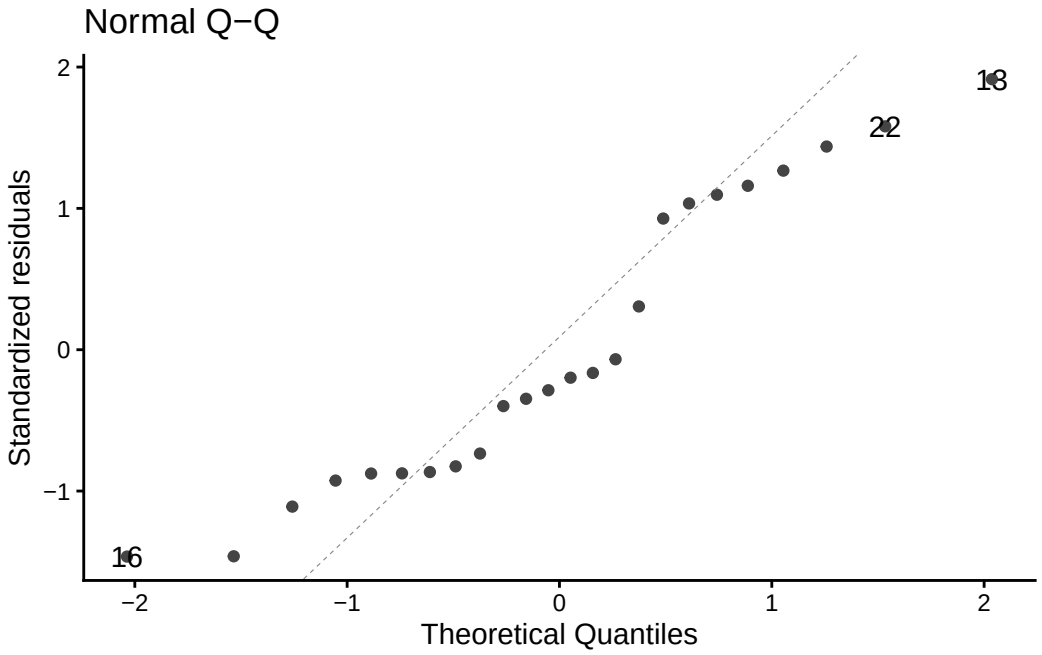
where p_i denotes the plotting positions returned by `ppoints(n)`. For the common midpoint choice $p_i = (i - 0.5)/n$, the sample quantile at p_i equals $r_{(i)}$. More generally, `qqnorm()` pairs the ith ordered residual with the corresponding theoretical quantile computed from its plotting position. So both labels are correct: `qqnorm()` emphasizes the quantile role ("Sample Quantiles"), while `autoplot.lm()` emphasizes the underlying ordered values ("Standardized residuals").

If the standardized residuals approximately follow $N(0, 1)$, the points should fall approximately on a straight line.

```
library(ggfortify)
# needed to make ggplot2::autoplot() work for `lm` objects

qqplot_lm2_auto <-
  bw_lm2 |>
  autoplot(
    which = 2, # options are 1:6; can do multiple at once
    ncol = 1
  ) +
  theme_classic()

print(qqplot_lm2_auto)
```



If the Gaussian model were correct, the points should fall approximately on the reference line.

The **reference line** passes through the pairs of theoretical and empirical quantiles at probabilities 0.25 and 0.75: it connects $(\Phi^{-1}(0.25), \widehat{Q}_{0.25})$ and $(\Phi^{-1}(0.75), \widehat{Q}_{0.75})$, where Φ^{-1} is the standard normal quantile function and $\widehat{Q}_p$ is the p-th sample quantile of the standardized residuals. If the standardized residuals are approximately $N(0, 1)$, this line should be close to the identity line $y = x$, and the points should fall roughly along a straight line.

Systematic deviations from the line suggest departures from normality:

- **S-shaped curves**: heavier or lighter tails than the normal distribution
- **Concave or convex curves**: skewness
- **Individual points far from the line**: potential outliers

Fig 2.4 panel (c) in Dobson and Barnett (2018) is a little different; they didn't specify how they produced it, but other statistical analysis systems do things differently from R.

See also Dunn and Smyth (2018) §3.5.4[14].

QQ plot: typical patterns

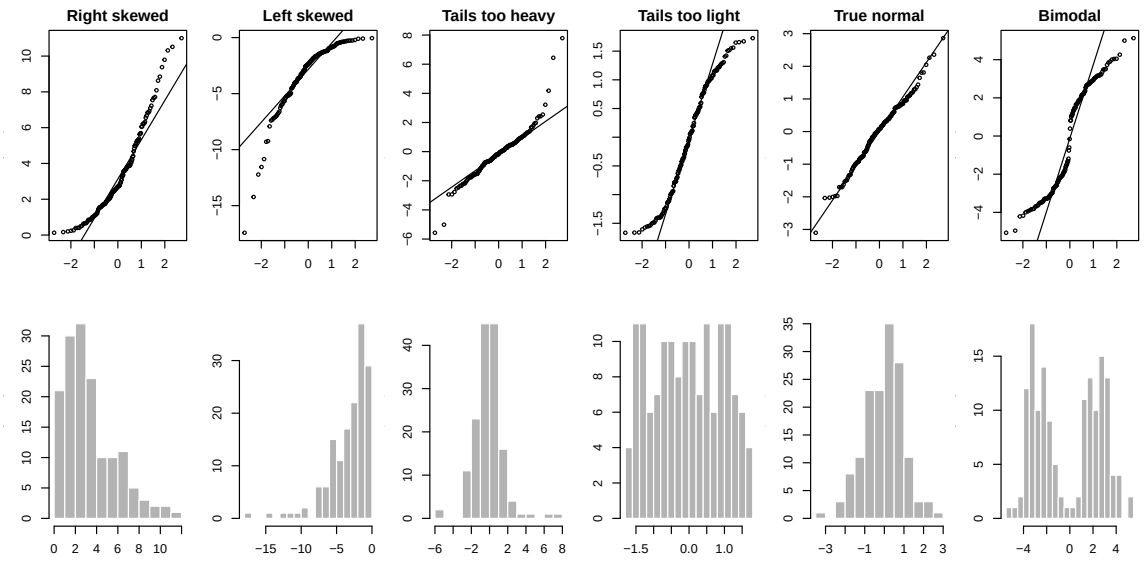
[14] https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-1-4419-0118-7_3#Sec14:~:text=3.5.4%20Q%E2%80%93Q%20Plots%20and%20Normality

```r
set.seed(36) # seed chosen for Fig. 3.6 reproduction
n <- 150     # sample size as in @dunn2018generalized Fig. 3.6

sims <- list(
  "Right skewed"    = rchisq(n, df = 3),
  "Left skewed"     = -rchisq(n, df = 3),
  "Tails too heavy" = rt(n, df = 3),
  "Tails too light" = runif(n, -sqrt(3), sqrt(3)),
  "True normal"     = rnorm(n),
  "Bimodal"         = c(rnorm(n / 2, -2.5), rnorm(n / 2, 2.5))
)

old_par <- par(
  mfcol = c(2, 6),
  mar = c(3, 3, 2, 0.5),
  oma = c(0, 0, 0, 0)
)

for (nm in names(sims)) {
  qqnorm(
    sims[[nm]],
    main = nm,
    xlab = "Theoretical Quantiles",
    ylab = "Sample Quantiles",
    pch = 1,
    cex = 0.6
  )
  qqline(sims[[nm]])
  hist(
    sims[[nm]],
    main = "",
    xlab = "Residuals",
    ylab = "Frequency",
    col = "grey70",
    border = "white",
    breaks = 15
  )
}
```




```r
par(old_par)
```

Figure 22: Typical QQ-plot patterns for six types of residual distribution. Adapted from Dunn and Smyth (2018, fig. 3.6), with thanks to the authors, reproduced here using simulated data ($n = 150$). Each column shows one distribution scenario: a QQ plot (top) paired with a histogram of the simulated data (bottom).

4.8.3 QQ plot - how it's built

To construct a QQ plot by hand:

1. Assign each standardized residual a **plotting position** p_i based on its rank among the n observations. R's default formula for $n > 10$ is:

$$p_i = \frac{\text{rank}_i - 0.5}{n}$$

2. Compute the **theoretical quantile**: $q_i = \Phi^{-1}(p_i)$, the value from $N(0,1)$ that corresponds to probability p_i.
3. Plot (q_i, r'_i) — theoretical quantile q_i on the x-axis, observed standardized residual r'_i (see Definition 4.8) on the y-axis.
4. Add the **reference line** through the pairs of theoretical and empirical quantiles at probabilities 0.25 and 0.75.

```
bw <- bw |>
  mutate(
    # plotting position: (rank - 0.5) / n
    p = (rank(std_resid_lm2) - 1 / 2) / n(),
    expected_quantiles_lm2 = qnorm(p)
  )

qqplot_lm2 <-
  bw |>
  ggplot(
    aes(
      x = expected_quantiles_lm2,
      y = std_resid_lm2,
      col = sex,
      shape = sex
    )
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_classic() +
  theme(legend.position = "none") + # removing the plot legend
  ggtitle("Normal Q-Q") +
  xlab("Theoretical Quantiles") +
  ylab("Standardized residuals")

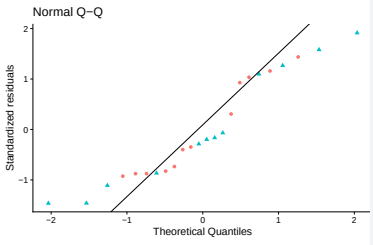
# find the reference line through the (theoretical, empirical) quantile pairs
# at probabilities 0.25 and 0.75:

ps <- c(.25, .75) # reference probabilities
a <- quantile(rstandard(bw_lm2), ps) # empirical quantiles
b <- qnorm(ps) # theoretical quantiles

qq_slope <- diff(a) / diff(b)
qq_intcpt <- a[1] - b[1] * qq_slope

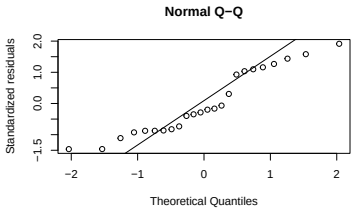
qqplot_lm2 <-
  qqplot_lm2 +
  geom_abline(slope = qq_slope, intercept = qq_intcpt)
```

```
print(qqplot_lm2)
```



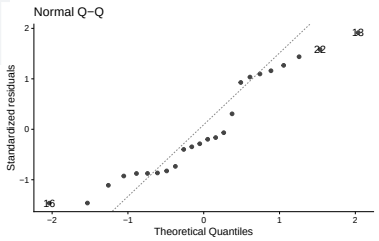
(a) `ggplot2` (manual construction)

```
std_resid_lm2 <- rstandard(
qqnorm(
  std_resid_lm2,
  main = "Normal Q-Q",
  xlab = "Theoretical Quant
  ylab = "Standardized resi
)
qqline(std_resid_lm2)
```



(b) base R (`qqnorm` + `qqline`)

```
library(ggfortify)
autoplot(
  bw_lm2,
  which = 2,
  ncol = 1
) +
  theme_classic()
```



(c) `ggfortify::autoplot()`

Figure 23: Three equivalent ways to produce a QQ plot of the standardized residuals for the `birthweight` model (Equation 2). All three plots show the same data and reference line.

4.8.4 Formal diagnostic tests for linear regression assumptions

Graphical diagnostics are usually the first step, but formal tests can provide numerical summaries.

For linear regression residuals, four common tests are:

- `fligner.test()` for equal variances across groups (the Fligner–Killeen test).
- Levene / Brown–Forsythe test (a median-centered Levene variant, where standard Levene centers on group means, and Brown–Forsythe centers on group medians for more robustness; e.g., via `car::leveneTest(..., center = median)` or equivalent code).
- `lmtest::bptest()` for error variance that changes with the covariates (the Breusch–Pagan test).
- `shapiro.test()` / Shapiro–Wilk test[15] for normality.

Fligner–Killeen test (homoskedasticity across groups)

Suppose residuals are split into groups ($g = 1, \dots, G$), for example by a categorical predictor.

The test starts from absolute deviations from each group median:

$$d_{gi} = |e_{gi} - \text{median}(e_{g1}, \dots, e_{g,n_g})|.$$

After ranking the pooled d_{gi} values, the Fligner–Killeen statistic is built from normal scores of those ranks.

Under the null hypothesis of equal variances, the test statistic is approximately χ^2_{G-1}. Small p-values suggest heteroskedasticity.

Levene / Brown–Forsythe test (homoskedasticity across groups)

Levene's test transforms residuals to within-group absolute deviations:

$$z_{gi} = |e_{gi} - c_g|,$$

[15] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Shapiro%E2%80%93Wilk_test

where c_g is the group center.

Classical Levene uses the group mean for c_g. Brown–Forsythe uses the group median, which is more robust.

Then run a one-way ANOVA on z_{gi} by group:

$$F = \frac{\mathrm{MS}_{\text{between}}}{\mathrm{MS}_{\text{within}}} \sim F_{G-1,N-G} \quad \text{under } H_0.$$

Small p-values suggest unequal residual variance.

For simple linear regression, Kutner et al. (2005, 116–17) describes the Brown–Forsythe test by splitting observations into two X-level groups (low versus high), computing absolute deviations from each group median, and applying a two-sample pooled-variance t test: let

$$z_{ij} = |e_{ij} - \tilde{e}_i|,$$

where j indexes observations within group i, and $\tilde{e}_i$ is the median residual in group i. Then:

$$t_{\mathrm{BF}} = \frac{\bar{z}_1 - \bar{z}_2}{s_p\sqrt{1/n_1 + 1/n_2}}, \quad t_{\mathrm{BF}} \approx t_{n_1+n_2-2} \text{ under } H_0.$$

Here, $\bar{z}_1$ and $\bar{z}_2$ are the means of the z_{ij} values in groups $i = 1$ and $i = 2$, s_p is their pooled standard deviation, and n_1, n_2 are the two group sample sizes. Large $|t_{\mathrm{BF}}|$ indicates nonconstant residual variance.

Breusch–Pagan test (variance changing with covariates)

The Fligner–Killeen and Levene tests compare residual variances across the levels of a grouping variable. The Breusch–Pagan test instead asks whether the error variance changes with the covariates themselves, which can be continuous (Breusch and Pagan 1979).

Definition 4.9 (Breusch–Pagan statistic)**.** Let $r_1, \ldots, r_n$ be the residuals from a fitted linear regression model, and let z_i be a vector of q covariates for observation i (by default, the model's own predictors, without the intercept).
The **auxiliary regression** is the ordinary least-squares regression of the squared residuals r_i^2 on z_i, with an intercept; let R^2_{aux} be its coefficient of determination.
The **studentized Breusch–Pagan statistic** (Koenker 1981) is:

$$\mathrm{BP} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} nR^2_{\text{aux}} \tag{18}$$

The **original Breusch–Pagan statistic** (Breusch and Pagan 1979) uses $\hat{\sigma}^2 \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^n r_i^2$ and regresses $g_i \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} r_i^2/\hat{\sigma}^2$ on z_i; the statistic is half of that regression's explained sum of squares.

Theorem 4.4 (Null distribution of the Breusch–Pagan statistic)**.** *Under the null hypothesis that the error variance is constant,* $\mathrm{Var}(Y_i \mid z_i) = \sigma^2$ *for every* i*, both versions of the Breusch–Pagan statistic are approximately* χ^2_q *in large samples. The original version also assumes Gaussian errors (Breusch and Pagan 1979); the studentized version does not (Koenker 1981).*

The proof uses large-sample score-test theory, which is beyond the scope of these notes; see Breusch and Pagan (1979) and Koenker (1981).

The null hypothesis concerns the errors, not the residuals: even when the error variance is constant, the residual variances differ with leverage (Equation 15).

Large values of the statistic, and small p-values, suggest that the error variance changes with z_i.

Exm

Example 4.3 (Breusch–Pagan test for the `birthweight` interaction model)**.** For the `birthweight` interaction model (Equation 2), z_i holds sex, gestational age, and their interaction, so $q = 3$. We fit both auxiliary regressions by hand and compare the results with `lmtest::bptest()`:

```
bp_data <-
  bw |>
  mutate(
    resid_sq = resid(bw_lm2)^2,
    g = resid_sq / mean(resid_sq)
  )

bp_n <- nobs(bw_lm2)

bp_aux <- lm(resid_sq ~ sex + age + sex:age, data = bp_data)
bp_r2 <- summary(bp_aux)$r.squared
bp_stat <- bp_n * bp_r2
bp_p <- pchisq(bp_stat, df = 3, lower.tail = FALSE)

bp_aux_g <- lm(g ~ sex + age + sex:age, data = bp_data)
bp_ess <- sum((fitted(bp_aux_g) - mean(bp_data$g))^2)
bp_orig <- bp_ess / 2
bp_orig_p <- pchisq(bp_orig, df = 3, lower.tail = FALSE)

lmtest::bptest(bw_lm2)
#>
#>  studentized Breusch-Pagan test
#>
#> data:  bw_lm2
#> BP = 2.504, df = 3, p-value = 0.475
lmtest::bptest(bw_lm2, studentize = FALSE)
#>
#>  Breusch-Pagan test
#>
#> data:  bw_lm2
#> BP = 0.8871, df = 3, p-value = 0.829
```

By Definition 4.9, the studentized statistic is:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{BP} &\overset{\text{def}}{=} n R^2_{\text{aux}} && \text{(definition of the studentized statistic)} \\ &= 24 \times 0.10435 && \text{(substitute } n \text{ and } R^2_{\text{aux}}\text{)} \\ &\approx 2.504 && \text{(arithmetic)} \end{aligned} \tag{19}$$

and the original statistic is:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{BP}_{\text{orig}} &\overset{\text{def}}{=} \tfrac{1}{2}\mathrm{ESS}_g && \text{(definition of the original statistic)} \\ &= \tfrac{1}{2} \times 1.7742 && \text{(substitute the explained sum of squares)} \\ &\approx 0.887 && \text{(arithmetic)} \end{aligned} \tag{20}$$

Comparing each value with a χ^2_3 distribution (Theorem 4.4) gives $p \approx 0.47$ for the studentized statistic and $p \approx 0.83$ for the original statistic, which match `bptest()`. Neither test gives evidence that the error variance changes with sex or gestational age. The two statistics differ noticeably. The original statistic divides the explained sum of squares by 2, which is the variance of ε_i^2/σ^2 when the errors are Gaussian, and so the variance that g_i approaches in large samples under Gaussian errors; the studentized statistic equals the same explained sum of squares divided by the mean squared deviation of the g_i values (their variance with divisor

> n) instead, which here is about 0.71. A non-significant result from only 24 babies is weak evidence that the variance is constant, so we would still look at the residual plots.

Shapiro–Wilk test (normality of standardized residuals)

For ordered standardized residuals $r_{(1)} \le \cdots \le r_{(n)}$, the Shapiro–Wilk statistic is:

$$W = \frac{\left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i r_{(i)}\right)^2}{\sum_{i=1}^{n} (r_i - \bar{r})^2},$$

where a_i are constants from normal-order-statistic moments. The numerator uses ordered residuals $r_{(i)}$, while the denominator uses the original (unordered) residuals.

If residuals are Gaussian, W tends to be close to 1. Small W (and small p-value) indicates departure from normality.

Numerical example (`birthweight` interaction model)

```
diag_bw <-
  broom::augment(bw_lm2, data = bw) |>
  transmute(
    sex,
    resid_lm2 = .resid,
    std_resid_lm2 = .std.resid
  )

fligner_bw <- fligner.test(resid_lm2 ~ sex, data = diag_bw)

levene_bw <-
  diag_bw |>
  group_by(sex) |>
  mutate(
    med_resid = median(resid_lm2),
    abs_dev = abs(resid_lm2 - med_resid)
  ) |>
  ungroup()

levene_fit <- aov(abs_dev ~ sex, data = levene_bw)
levene_tab <- summary(levene_fit)[[1]]
levene_F <- unname(levene_tab[1, "F value"])
levene_p <- unname(levene_tab[1, "Pr(>F)"])

shapiro_bw <- shapiro.test(diag_bw$std_resid_lm2)

tibble(
  test = c(
    "Fligner--Killeen: equal variance by sex",
    "Levene/Brown--Forsythe: equal variance by sex",
    "Shapiro--Wilk: normality of standardized residuals"
  ),
  statistic = c(
    unname(fligner_bw$statistic),
    levene_F,
    unname(shapiro_bw$statistic)
  ),
```

```
  p_value = c(
    fligner_bw$p.value,
    levene_p,
    shapiro_bw$p.value
  )
) |>
  mutate(
    statistic = signif(statistic, 4),
    p_value = signif(p_value, 4)
  )
#> # A tibble: 3 x 3
#>   test                                                statistic p_value
#>   <chr>                                                   <dbl>   <dbl>
#> 1 Fligner--Killeen: equal variance by sex               0.00240  0.961
#> 2 Levene/Brown--Forsythe: equal variance by sex         0.326    0.574
#> 3 Shapiro--Wilk: normality of standardized residuals    0.919    0.0548
```

Interpretation rule: for all three tests in this table, a small p-value is evidence against the corresponding model assumption.

Compared with visual diagnostics:

- Fligner–Killeen / Levene summarizes the same heteroskedasticity signal that we inspect in residuals-vs-fitted (Figure 24) and scale-location (Figure 32) plots.
- Shapiro–Wilk summarizes the same normality signal that we inspect in QQ plots (Figure 23c) and standardized-residual histograms (Figure 21).
- Use tests and plots together: the tests provide a single numerical summary, while the plots show the shape and practical size of departures.

4.8.5 Conditional distributions of residuals

If our Gaussian linear regression model is correct, the residuals r_i and standardized residuals r'_i should have:

- an approximately Gaussian distribution, with:
- a mean of 0
- a constant variance

This mean and variance structure should be true **for every** value of x.

If we didn't correctly guess the functional form of the linear component of the mean, for covariate vector $x = (x_1, \dots, x_p)$,

$$\mathrm{E}[Y \mid X = x] = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_1 + \cdots + \beta_p x_p$$

Then the residuals might have nonzero mean.

Regardless of whether we guessed the mean function correctly, the variance of the residuals might differ between values of x.

Residuals versus fitted values

To look for these issues, we can plot the residuals r_i against the fitted values $\hat{y}_i$ (Figure 24).

```
autoplot(bw_lm2, which = 1, ncol = 1) |> print()
```

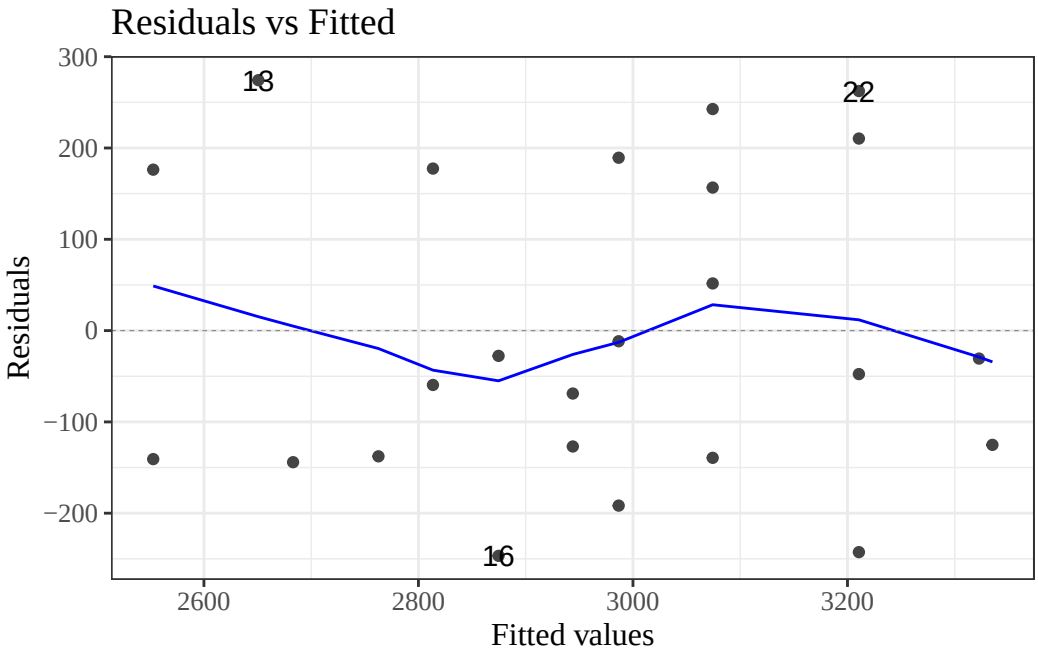


Figure 24: `birthweight` model (Equation 2): residuals versus fitted values

If the model is correct, the blue line should stay flat and close to 0, and the cloud of dots should have the same vertical spread regardless of the fitted value.

If not, we probably need to change the functional form of the linear component of the mean,

$$\mathrm{E}[Y \mid X = x] = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_1 + \cdots + \beta_p x_p$$

Example: PLOS Medicine title length data

(Adapted from Dobson and Barnett (2018), §6.7.1)

```
data(PLOS, package = "dobson")
library(ggplot2)
fig1 =
  PLOS |>
  ggplot(
    aes(x = authors,
        y = nchar)
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom") +
  labs(col = "") +
  guides(col=guide_legend(ncol=3))
fig1
```

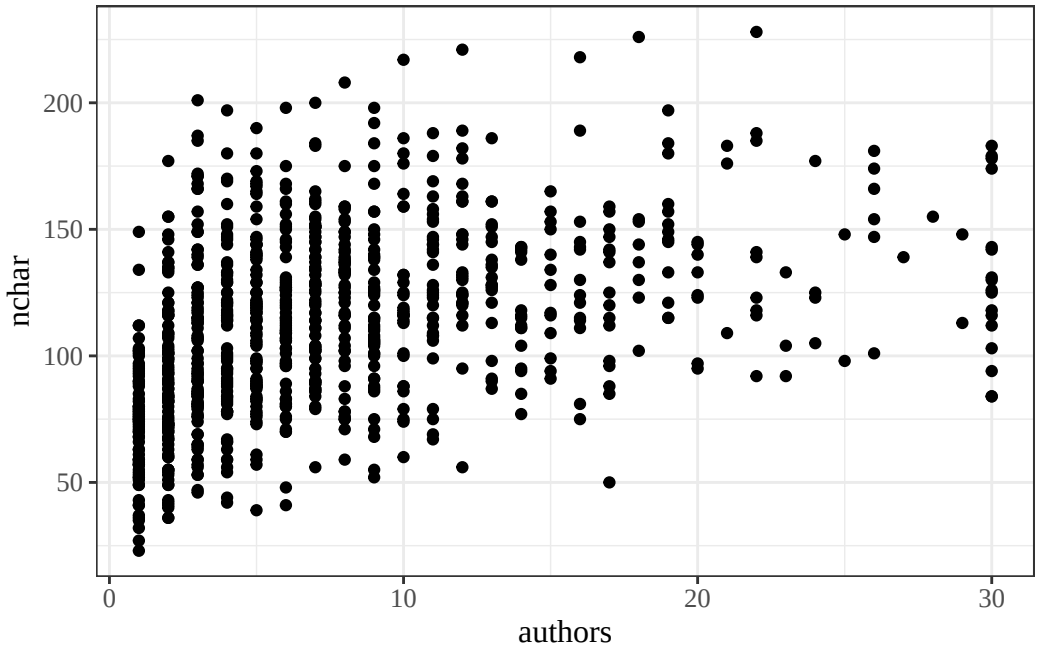


Figure 25: Number of authors versus title length in *PLOS Medicine* articles

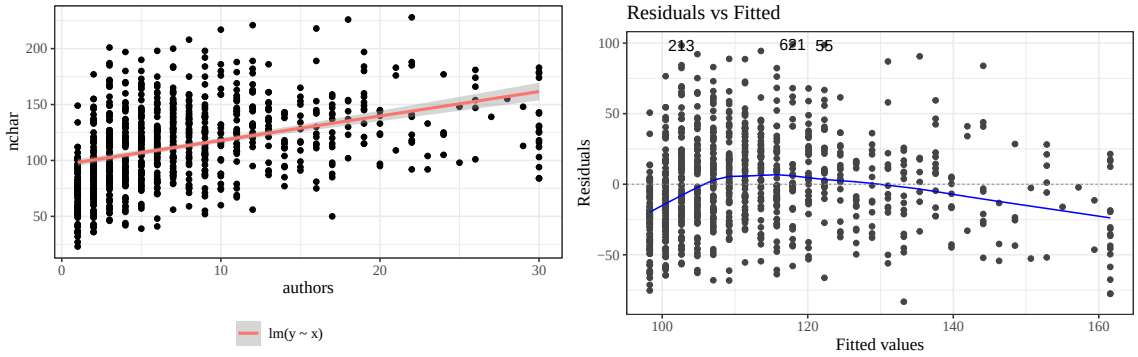
---

Linear fit

```
lm_PLOS_linear = lm(
  formula = nchar ~ authors,
  data = PLOS)
```

```
fig2 = fig1 +
  geom_smooth(
    method = "lm",
               fullrange = TRUE,
               aes(col = "lm(y ~ x)"))
fig2

library(ggfortify)
autoplot(lm_PLOS_linear, which = 1, ncol = 1)
```



(a) Data and fit

(b) Residuals vs fitted

Figure 26: Number of authors versus title length in *PLOS Medicine*, with linear model fit

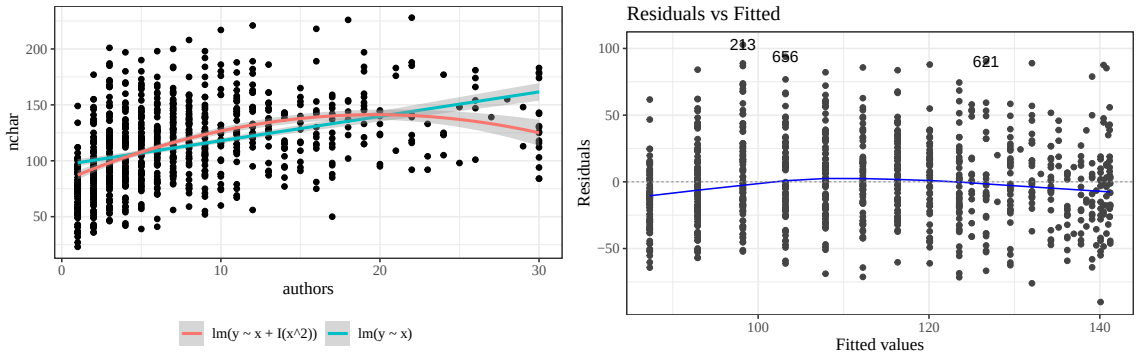
---

Quadratic fit

```
lm_PLOS_quad = lm(
  formula = nchar ~ authors + I(authors^2),
  data = PLOS)
```

```
fig3 =
  fig2 +
geom_smooth(
    method = "lm",
    fullrange = TRUE,
    formula = y ~ x + I(x ^ 2),
    aes(col = "lm(y ~ x + I(x^2))")
  )
fig3

autoplot(lm_PLOS_quad, which = 1, ncol = 1)
```



(a) Data and fit

(b) Residuals vs fitted

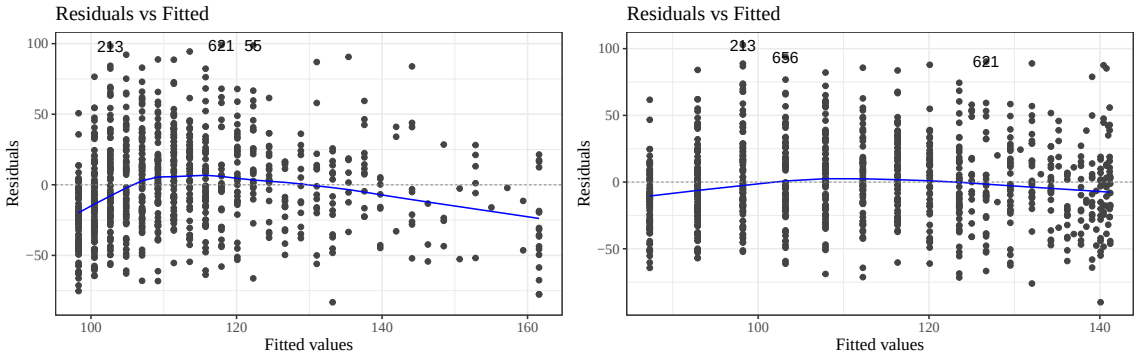
Figure 27: Number of authors versus title length in *PLOS Medicine*, with quadratic model fit

---

Linear versus quadratic fits

```
library(ggfortify)
autoplot(lm_PLOS_linear, which = 1, ncol = 1)

autoplot(lm_PLOS_quad, which = 1, ncol = 1)
```



(a) Linear

(b) Quadratic

Figure 28: Residuals versus fitted plot for linear and quadratic fits to `PLOS` data

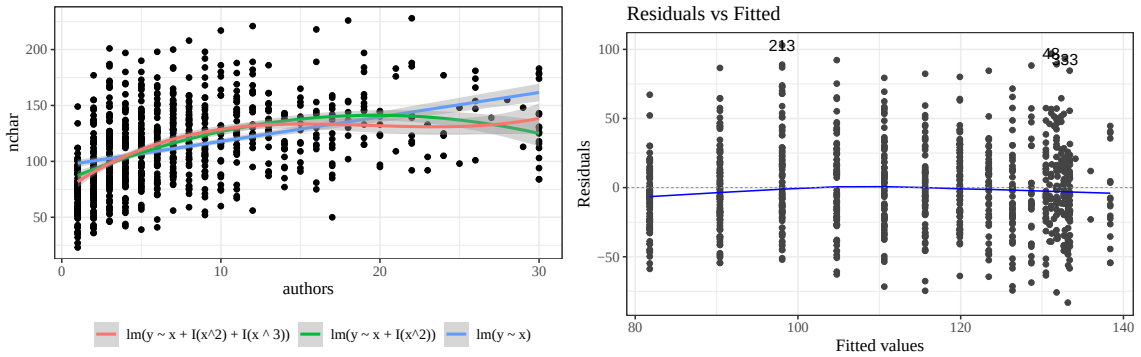
---

Cubic fit

```
lm_PLOS_cub = lm(
  formula = nchar ~ authors + I(authors^2) + I(authors^3),
  data = PLOS)
```

```
fig4 =
  fig3 +
geom_smooth(
    method = "lm",
    fullrange = TRUE,
    formula = y ~ x + I(x ^ 2) + I(x ^ 3),
    aes(col = "lm(y ~ x + I(x^2) + I(x ^ 3))")
  )
fig4

autoplot(lm_PLOS_cub, which = 1, ncol = 1)
```



(a) Data and fit

(b) Residuals vs fitted

Figure 29: Number of authors versus title length in *PLOS Medicine*, with cubic model fit

---

Logarithmic fit

```
lm_PLOS_log = lm(nchar ~ log(authors), data = PLOS)
```

```
fig5 = fig4 +
  geom_smooth(
    method = "lm",
    fullrange = TRUE,
    formula = y ~ log(x),
    aes(col = "lm(y ~ log(x))")
  )
fig5

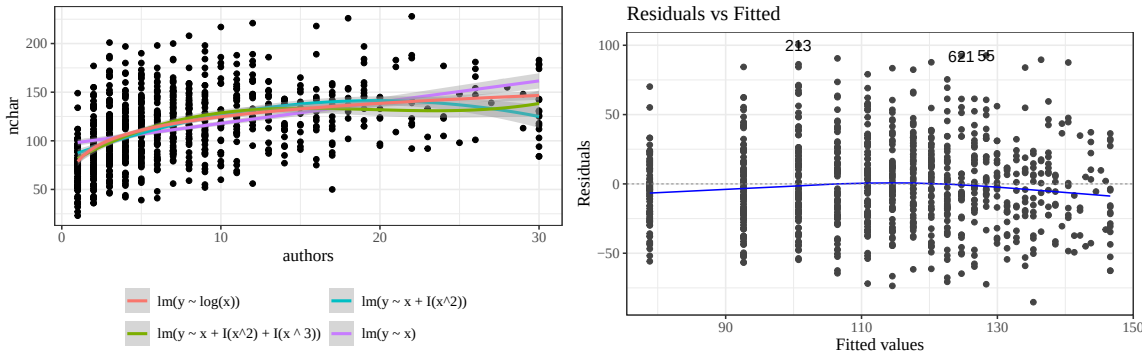
autoplot(lm_PLOS_log, which = 1, ncol = 1)
```

Table 26: linear vs quadratic

```
anova(lm_PLOS_linear, lm_PLOS_quad)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 6
#>   Res.Df     RSS    Df `Sum of Sq`     F  `Pr(>F)`
#>    <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl>       <dbl> <dbl>     <dbl>
#> 1    876 947502.    NA          NA    NA   NA
#> 2    875 880950.     1       66552.  66.1  1.46e-15
```

Table 27: quadratic vs cubic

```
anova(lm_PLOS_quad, lm_PLOS_cub)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 6
#>   Res.Df     RSS    Df `Sum of Sq`     F  `Pr(>F)`
#>    <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl>       <dbl> <dbl>     <dbl>
#> 1    875 880950.    NA          NA    NA   NA
#> 2    874 865933.     1       15018.  15.2  0.000106
```



(a) Data and fit

(b) Residuals vs fitted

Figure 30: logarithmic fit

Model selection

AIC/BIC

```
AIC(lm_PLOS_quad)
#> [1] 8567.61
AIC(lm_PLOS_cub)
#> [1] 8554.51
```

```
AIC(lm_PLOS_cub)
#> [1] 8554.51
AIC(lm_PLOS_log)
#> [1] 8543.63
```

```
BIC(lm_PLOS_cub)
#> [1] 8578.4
BIC(lm_PLOS_log)
#> [1] 8557.97
```

Extrapolation is dangerous

```
fig_all = fig5 +
  xlim(0, 60)
fig_all
```

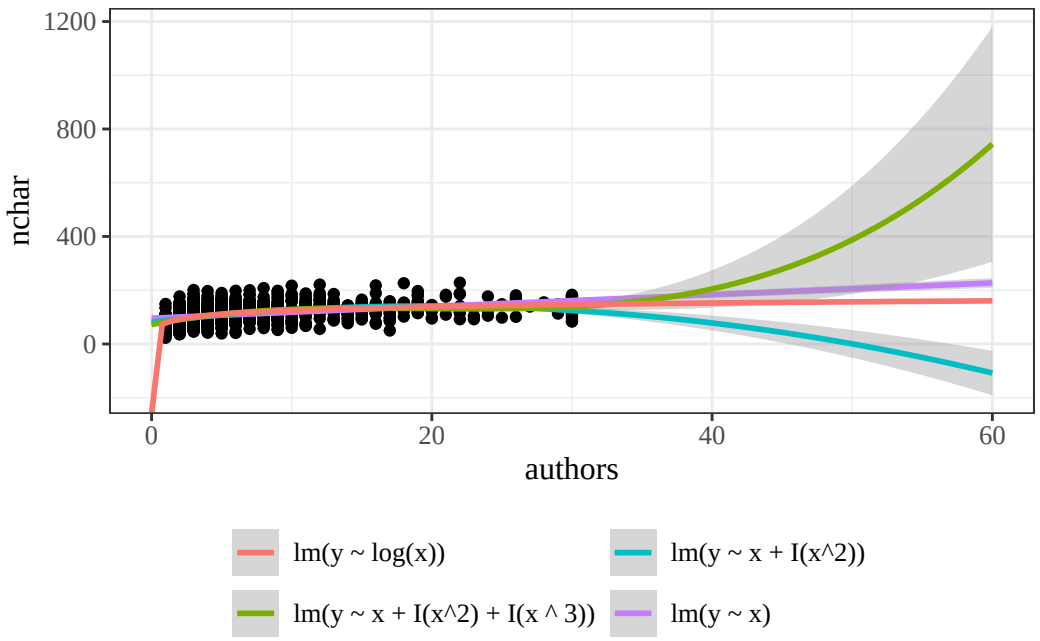


Figure 31: Number of authors versus title length in *PLOS Medicine*

Scale-location plot

We can also plot the square roots of the absolute values of the standardized residuals against the fitted values (Figure 32).

```
autoplot(bw_lm2, which = 3, ncol = 1) |> print()
```

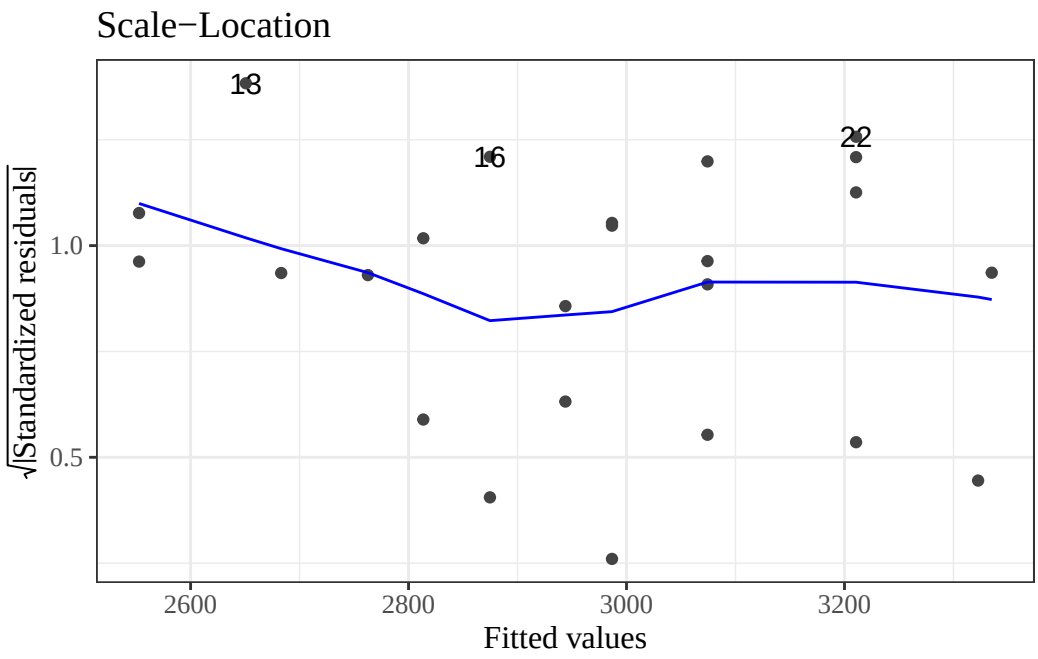


Figure 32: Scale-location plot of `birthweight` data

Here, the blue line doesn't need to be near 0, but it should be flat. If not, the residual variance σ^2 might not be constant, and we might need to transform our outcome Y (or use a model that allows non-constant variance).

Residuals versus leverage

We can also plot our standardized residuals against "leverage", which roughly speaking is a measure of how unusual each x_i value is. Very unusual x_i values can have extreme effects on the model fit, so we might want to remove those observations as outliers, particularly if they have large residuals.

```
autoplot(bw_lm2, which = 5, ncol = 1) |> print()
```

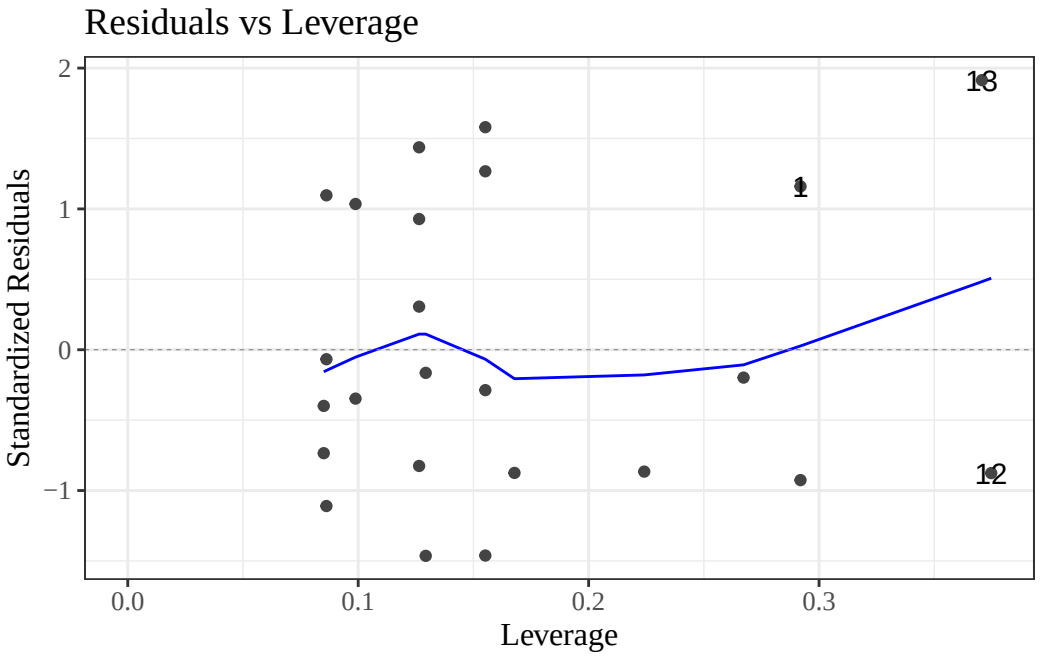


Figure 33: `birthweight` model with interactions (Equation 2): residuals versus leverage

The blue line should be relatively flat and close to 0 here. The curved dashed contour lines show where Cook's distance equals 0.5 and 1; observations near or beyond those contours have substantial influence on the fit (see Section 4.8.6).

4.8.6 Cook's distance

> **Tip**
>
> This section is adapted from Dobson and Barnett (2018, sec. 6.3).

Residuals and leverage each capture one aspect of an observation's influence on the model fit. Cook's distance (Cook 1977) combines them into a single diagnostic.

Definition 4.10 (Cook's distance)**.** For ordinary least squares with p parameters, the **Cook's distance** for observation i is

$$D_i \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \frac{(\hat{\tilde{\beta}}_{(-i)} - \hat{\tilde{\beta}})^\top \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} (\hat{\tilde{\beta}}_{(-i)} - \hat{\tilde{\beta}})}{p\,\hat{\sigma}^2} \tag{21}$$

where $\hat{\tilde{\beta}}_{(-i)}$ is the least-squares estimate obtained after deleting observation i.

Because refitting the model n times is expensive, Equation 21 has an equivalent closed-form expression that uses only quantities from the full-data fit:

$$D_i = \frac{(r_i')^2}{p} \cdot \frac{h_{ii}}{1 - h_{ii}} \tag{22}$$

where r_i' is the standardized residual (Definition 4.8) and h_{ii} is the leverage (diagonal of the hat matrix, Definition 4.7).

Exm

Example 4.4. Consider a regression with $p = 2$ parameters. Suppose observation i has standardized residual $r_i' = 2$ and leverage $h_{ii} = 0.3$. Applying Equation 22,

$$D_i = \frac{(2)^2}{2} \cdot \frac{0.3}{1 - 0.3} = 2 \cdot 0.43 \approx 0.86.$$

Equation 22 shows that influence has two ingredients:

- **Residual size** ($(r_i')^2$): a poorly fitted observation pushes D_i up regardless of its leverage.
- **Leverage** ($h_{ii}/(1 - h_{ii})$): high leverage amplifies the effect of even a moderate residual.

An observation must be both unusual in its predictor values *and* poorly fitted to have a large Cook's distance.

Cook's distance plot

We can visualize Cook's distances for all observations using `autoplot` with `which = 4` (Figure 34).

```
autoplot(bw_lm2, which = 4, ncol = 1) |> print()
```

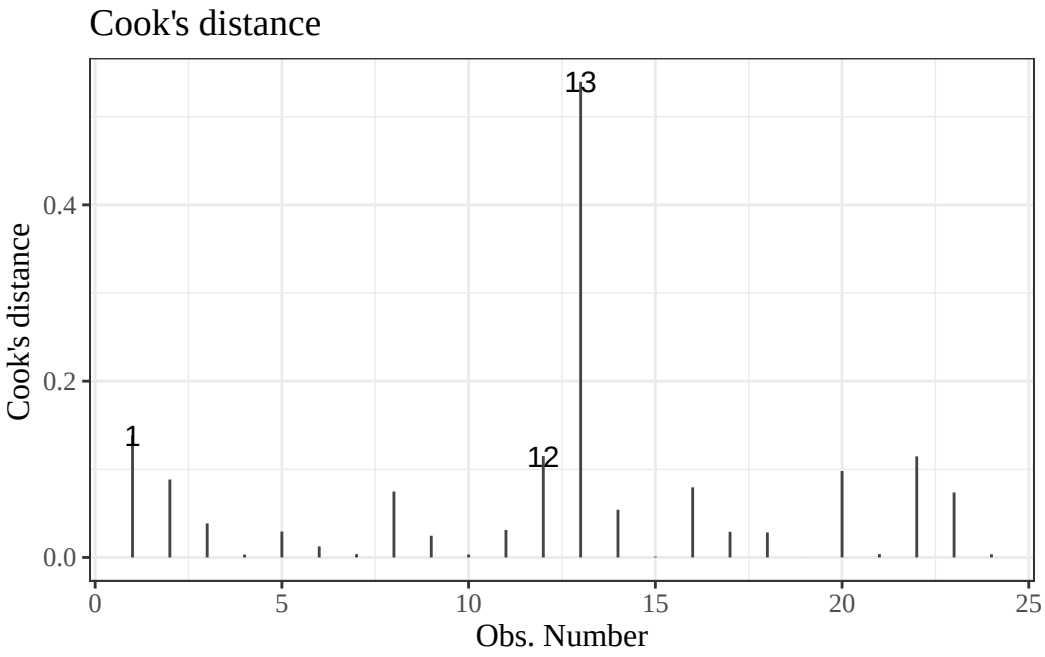


Figure 34: Cook's distance for `birthweight` model with interactions (Equation 2)

A commonly cited rule of thumb (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.3) flags observation i as influential if

$$D_i > 1$$

A more conservative threshold is $D_i > 4/n$ (Bollen and Jackman 1990).

Observations exceeding either threshold warrant closer inspection: check whether they represent genuine data or recording errors, and consider refitting the model with and without them to assess sensitivity.

The residuals-versus-leverage plot (Figure 33) also displays Cook's distance contours as curved dashed lines. An observation lying near or beyond a contour line has substantial influence on the fit.

Computing Cook's distances in R:

```
cooks.distance(bw_lm2)
#>           1           2           3           4           5           6
#> 0.138666533 0.088394496 0.038580119 0.003306326 0.029380480 0.012546308
#>           7           8           9          10          11          12
#> 0.003700182 0.074772987 0.024651000 0.003389576 0.031165758 0.115007141
#>          13          14          15          16          17          18
#> 0.539629434 0.054112479 0.001002262 0.079551451 0.029067335 0.028360493
#>          19          20          21          22          23          24
#> 0.000107797 0.098092422 0.003781150 0.114688577 0.073731478 0.003576445
```

Exercise 4.3. Verify Equation 22 for the observations in `bw_lm2`: compute D_i using the standardized residuals and leverage values, and check that the result matches `cooks.distance(bw_lm2)`.

Solution

Solution.

```
r_prime <- rstandard(bw_lm2)
h <- hatvalues(bw_lm2)
p <- length(coef(bw_lm2))

D_manual <- (r_prime^2 / p) * (h / (1 - h))
cbind(manual = D_manual, builtin = cooks.distance(bw_lm2)) |> head(3)
#>      manual   builtin
#> 1 0.1386665 0.1386665
#> 2 0.0883945 0.0883945
#> 3 0.0385801 0.0385801
```

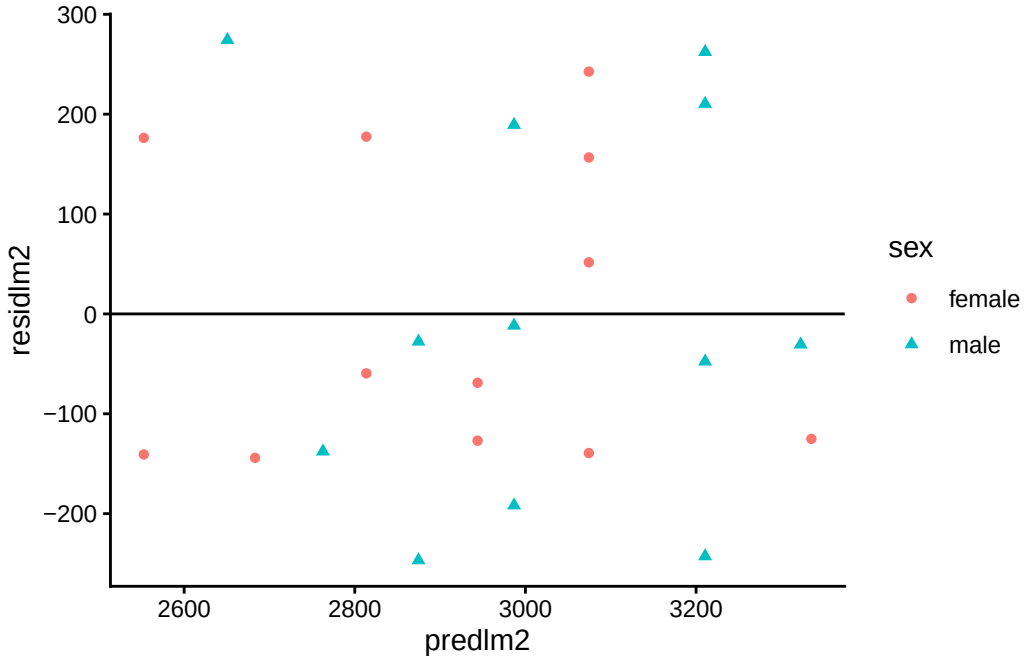
4.8.7 Diagnostics constructed by hand

```
bw <-
  bw |>
  mutate(
    predlm2 = predict(bw_lm2),
    residlm2 = weight - predlm2,
    std_resid = residlm2 / sigma(bw_lm2),
    # std_resid_builtin = rstandard(bw_lm2), # uses leverage
    sqrt_abs_std_resid = std_resid |> abs() |> sqrt()
  )
```

Residuals vs fitted

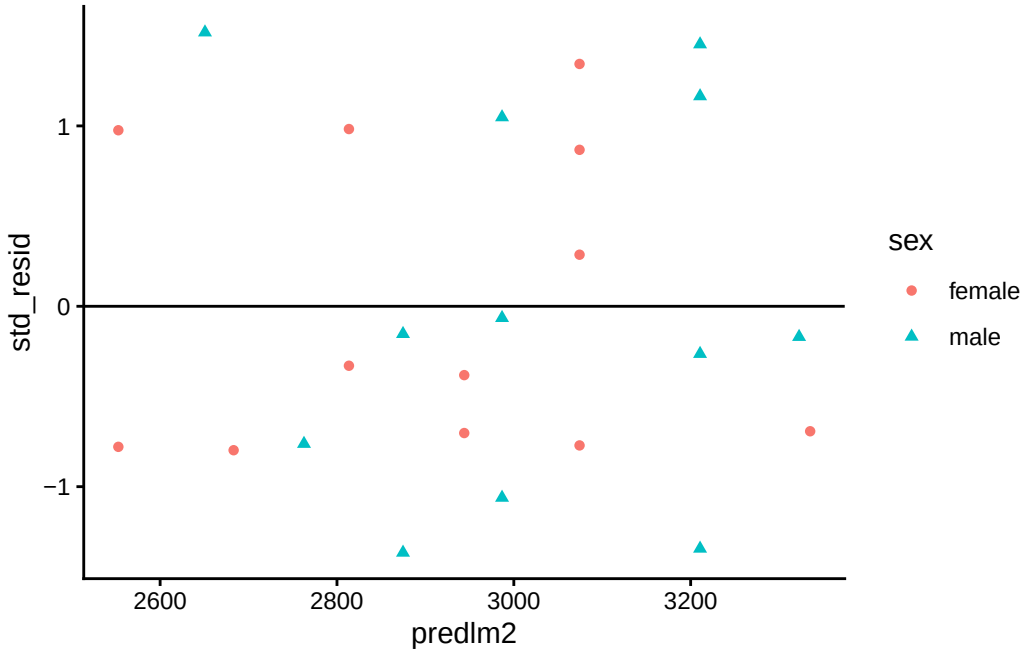
```
resid_vs_fit <- bw |>
  ggplot(
    aes(x = predlm2, y = residlm2, col = sex, shape = sex)
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_classic() +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0)

print(resid_vs_fit)
```



Standardized residuals vs fitted

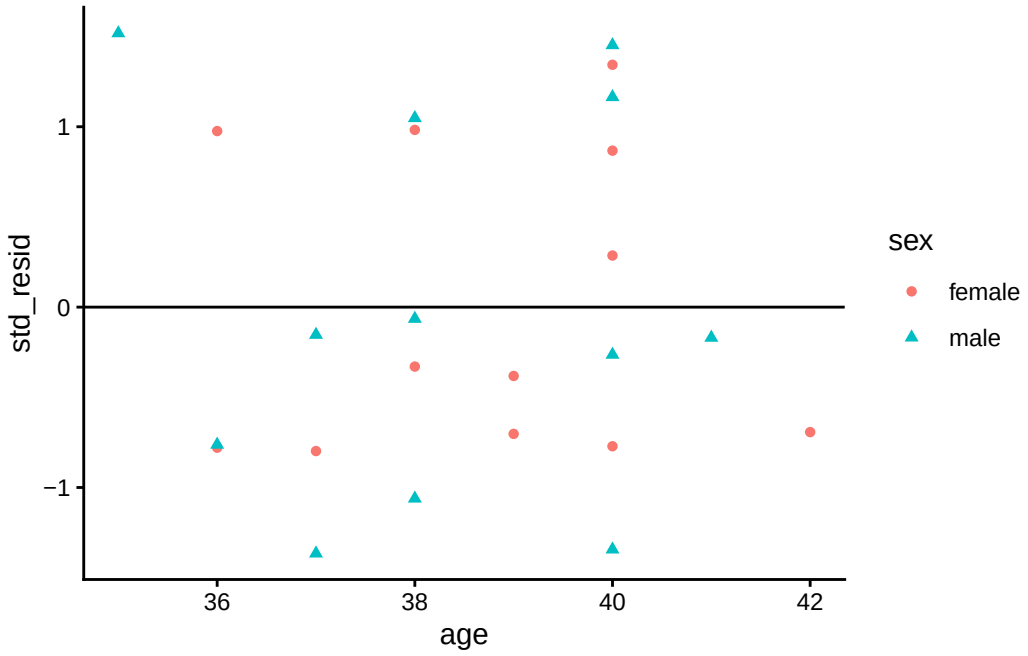
```
bw |>
  ggplot(
    aes(x = predlm2, y = std_resid, col = sex, shape = sex)
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_classic() +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0)
```



Standardized residuals vs gestational age

```
bw |>
  ggplot(
```

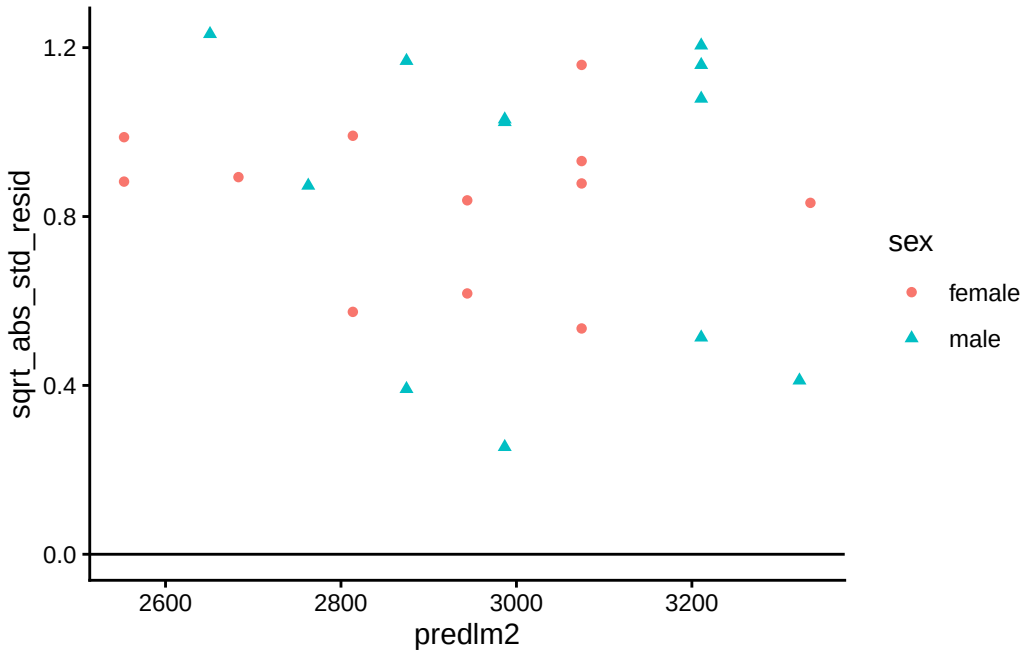
```
    aes(x = age, y = std_resid, col = sex, shape = sex)
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_classic() +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0)
```



`sqrt(abs(std_resid))` vs fitted

Compare with `autoplot(bw_lm2, 3)` (note: `autoplot` uses leverage-adjusted `rstandard()`)

```
bw |>
  ggplot(
    aes(x = predlm2, y = sqrt_abs_std_resid, col = sex, shape = sex)
  ) +
  geom_point() +
  theme_classic() +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0)
```



4.8.8 Diagnostics for the independence assumption

The independence assumption means that the model errors are independent, or at least uncorrelated, across observations after conditioning on the predictors in the model. Because those errors are unobserved, we usually assess this assumption using residual-based plots and formal tests.

For data with a natural ordering (for example, time, spatial location, or clinic visit sequence), we usually assess independence with both plots and formal tests (Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12; Chatterjee and Hadi 2015, chap. 6).

Definition 4.11 (Common diagnostics for independence)**.**

1. Residuals versus observation order (or time) plots: patterns, runs, or drifts can indicate dependence (Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12).
2. Correlograms: plot the sample autocorrelation function (ACF), and often the partial autocorrelation function (PACF), to look for serial structure (Chatterjee and Hadi 2015, chap. 6).
3. Durbin-Watson test: tests for first-order serial correlation in regression residuals (Chatterjee and Hadi 2015, chap. 9; Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12).
4. Breusch-Godfrey test: tests for higher-order serial correlation, and is more flexible than Durbin-Watson in many regression settings (Chatterjee and Hadi 2015, chap. 9; Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12).

Mathematical details for Durbin-Watson and Breusch-Godfrey

Suppose the observations have a meaningful order, indexed by $t = 1, \dots, n$. Let e_t denote the OLS residual from a fitted regression model.

Definition 4.12 (Durbin-Watson diagnostic)**.** The test statistic is

$$d = \frac{\sum_{t=2}^{n} (e_t - e_{t-1})^2}{\sum_{t=1}^{n} e_t^2}$$

which is approximately $2(1 - \hat{r}_1)$, where $\hat{r}_1$ is the sample lag-1 residual autocorrelation (Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12; Chatterjee and Hadi 2015, chap. 6). This approximation is most useful in standard large-sample linear-model settings, and is less straightforward in models with

lagged outcomes (Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12).
The null and alternatives are typically framed through an AR(1) error model:

$$\varepsilon_t = \rho\varepsilon_{t-1} + u_t.$$

Here, ε_t is the autocorrelated regression error process, and u_t is a white-noise innovation term. The null is $H_0 : \rho = 0$, and alternatives can be one-sided or two-sided, depending on whether we suspect positive, negative, or any serial correlation (Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12).

Definition 4.13 (Breusch-Godfrey diagnostic)**.** For a test of order p, we run an auxiliary regression of residuals on: the original regressors, and lagged residuals $e_{t-1}, \dots, e_{t-p}$. If R^2_{aux} is from that auxiliary model, the LM statistic is

$$\text{LM} = (n-p)R^2_{\text{aux}},$$

and under $H_0 : \rho_1 = \cdots = \rho_p = 0$, it is asymptotically χ^2_p (Chatterjee and Hadi 2015, chap. 6; Draper and Smith 2014, chap. 11).

Exm

Example 4.5 (Simulated example for independence diagnostics)**.** The following simulation generates ordered data with positively autocorrelated errors. This serial correlation creates a setting where independence should fail. We generate the error term from an AR(1) process with coefficient 0.7, matching the notation in the mathematical details section.

```r
set.seed(204)

n_obs <- 120
x <- seq(-1, 1, length.out = n_obs)
ar_errors <- as.numeric(arima.sim(model = list(ar = 0.7), n = n_obs, sd = 1))
y <- 2 + 1.5 * x + ar_errors

serial_dep_exm <- tibble::tibble(
  time_index = seq_len(n_obs),
  x = x,
  y = y
)

serial_dep_exm_lm <- lm(y ~ x, data = serial_dep_exm)

summary(serial_dep_exm_lm)
#>
#> Call:
#> lm(formula = y ~ x, data = serial_dep_exm)
#>
#> Residuals:
#>     Min      1Q  Median      3Q     Max
#> -2.6747 -0.9128 -0.0552  1.0087  2.5022
#>
#> Coefficients:
#>             Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
#> (Intercept)    1.998      0.110   18.13  < 2e-16 ***
#> x              1.773      0.189    9.37  6.4e-16 ***
#> ---
#> Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
#>
#> Residual standard error: 1.21 on 118 degrees of freedom
#> Multiple R-squared:  0.426,  Adjusted R-squared:  0.422
#> F-statistic: 87.7 on 1 and 118 DF,  p-value: 6.36e-16
```

Residuals versus order:

```r
serial_dep_exm |>
  dplyr::mutate(resid = resid(serial_dep_exm_lm)) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = time_index, y = resid)) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, linetype = "dashed", color = "gray50") +
  geom_line(color = "steelblue") +
  theme_classic() +
  labs(
    x = "Observation order",
    y = "Residual"
  )
```

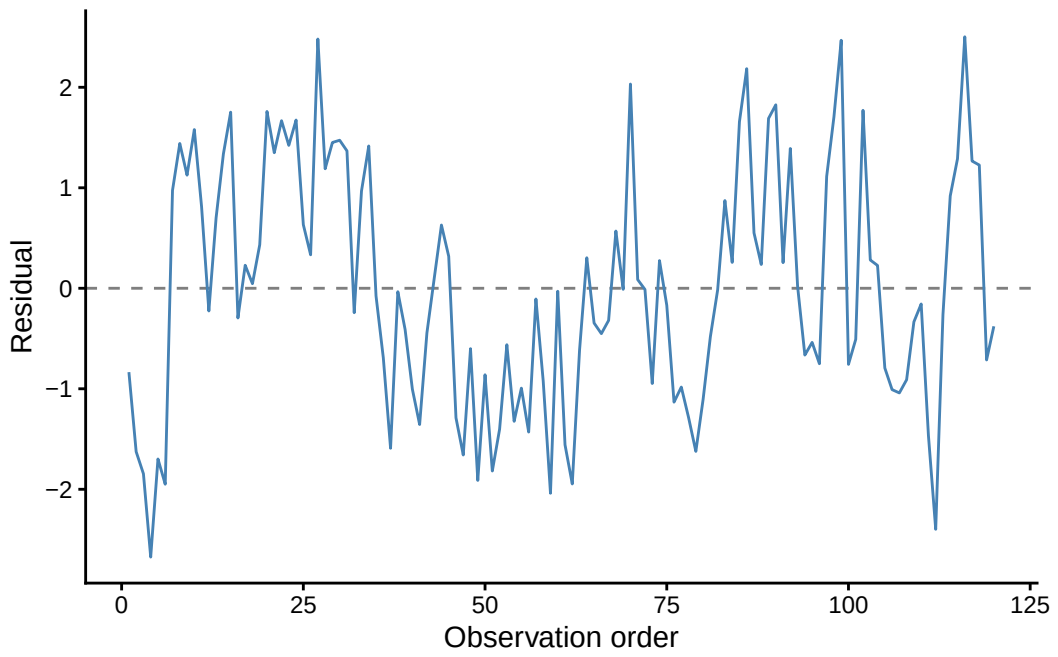


Figure 35: Residuals versus observation order for simulated data

Correlogram diagnostics:

```
local({
  op <- par(no.readonly = TRUE)
  on.exit(par(op), add = TRUE)
  par(mfrow = c(1, 2))
  acf(
    resid(serial_dep_exm_lm),
    main = "Residual ACF"
  )
  pacf(
    resid(serial_dep_exm_lm),
    main = "Residual PACF"
  )
})
```

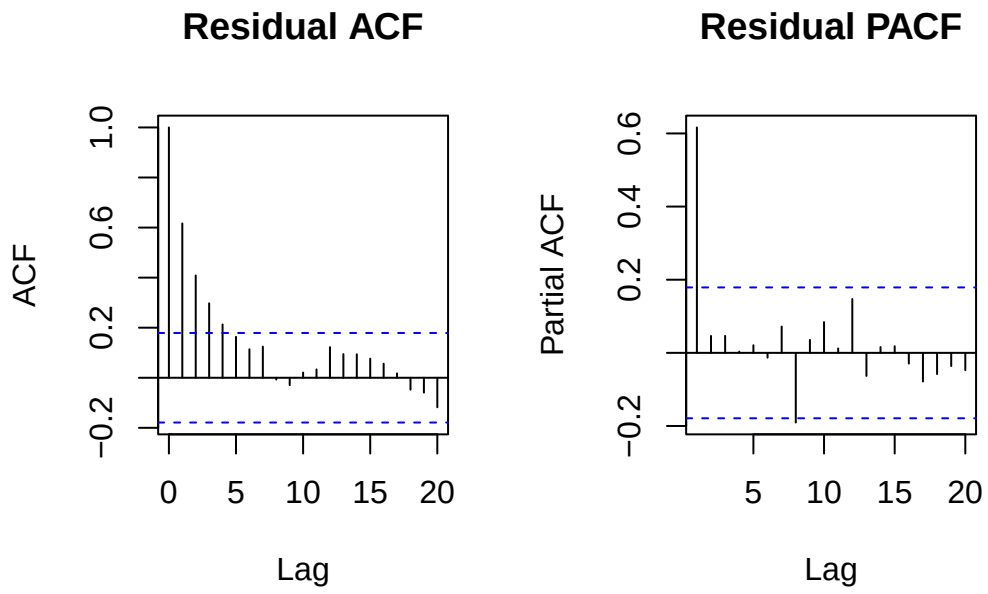


Figure 36: Residual ACF and PACF for simulated data

Durbin-Watson and Breusch-Godfrey tests:

```
lmtest::dwtest(serial_dep_exm_lm, alternative = "two.sided")
#>
#>  Durbin-Watson test
#>
#> data:  serial_dep_exm_lm
#> DW = 0.7623, p-value = 4.16e-12
#> alternative hypothesis: true autocorrelation is not 0
lmtest::bgtest(serial_dep_exm_lm, order = 4)
#>
#>  Breusch-Godfrey test for serial correlation of order up to 4
#>
#> data:  serial_dep_exm_lm
#> LM test = 45.94, df = 4, p-value = 2.53e-09
```

In this example, the residual-order plot and correlogram suggest serial dependence, and both formal tests reject independence.

Exm

Example 4.6 (Real-data examples for independence diagnostics)**.** We can also run the same diagnostics on real ordered data sets.

Nile annual river flow

```r
nile_df <- tibble::tibble(
  year = as.numeric(time(datasets::Nile)),
  flow = as.numeric(datasets::Nile)
)

nile_lm <- lm(flow ~ year, data = nile_df)

summary(nile_lm)
#>
#> Call:
#> lm(formula = flow ~ year, data = nile_df)
#>
#> Residuals:
#>    Min     1Q Median     3Q    Max
#> -483.7  -98.2  -23.2  111.4  368.7
#>
#> Coefficients:
#>             Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
#> (Intercept) 6132.174   1001.758    6.12  1.9e-08 ***
#> year          -2.714      0.522   -5.20  1.1e-06 ***
#> ---
#> Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
#>
#> Residual standard error: 151 on 98 degrees of freedom
#> Multiple R-squared:  0.217,  Adjusted R-squared:  0.209
#> F-statistic: 27.1 on 1 and 98 DF,  p-value: 1.07e-06
lmtest::dwtest(nile_lm, alternative = "two.sided")
#>
#>  Durbin-Watson test
#>
#> data:  nile_lm
#> DW = 1.247, p-value = 9.37e-05
#> alternative hypothesis: true autocorrelation is not 0
lmtest::bgtest(nile_lm, order = 4)
#>
#>  Breusch-Godfrey test for serial correlation of order up to 4
#>
#> data:  nile_lm
#> LM test = 15.94, df = 4, p-value = 0.0031
```

```r
nile_df |>
  dplyr::mutate(resid = resid(nile_lm)) |>
  ggplot(aes(x = year, y = resid)) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, linetype = "dashed", color = "gray50") +
  geom_line(color = "steelblue") +
  theme_classic() +
  labs(
    x = "Year",
    y = "Residual"
  )
```

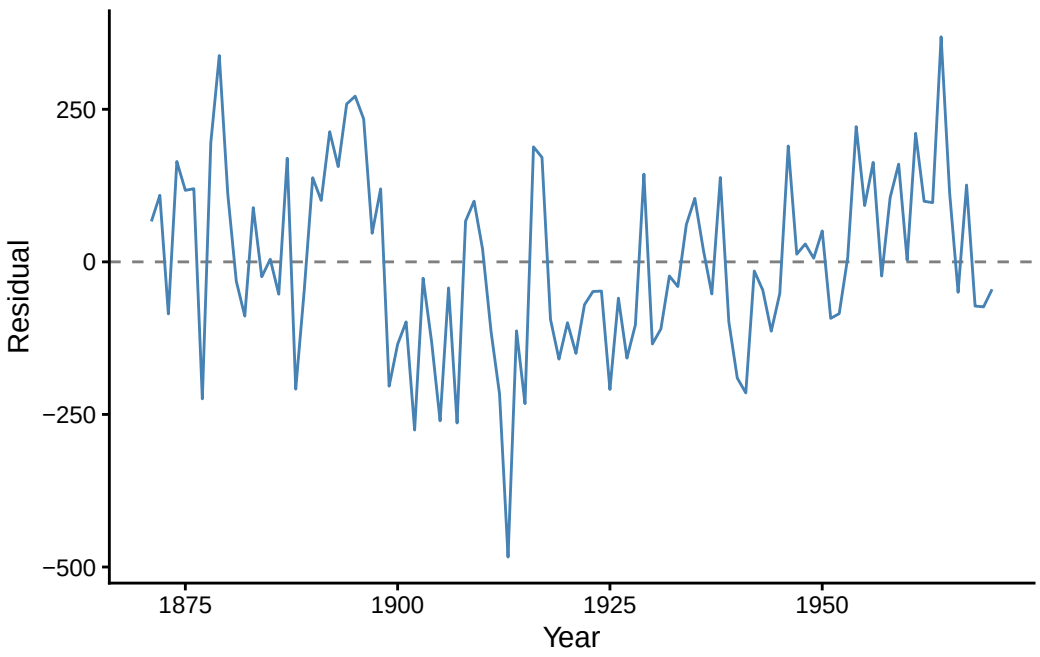


Figure 37: Residuals versus year for Nile flow model

Mauna Loa atmospheric carbon dioxide (`co2`)

```r
co2_df <- tibble::tibble(
  decimal_year = as.numeric(time(datasets::co2)),
  co2_ppm = as.numeric(datasets::co2)
)

co2_lm <- lm(co2_ppm ~ decimal_year, data = co2_df)

summary(co2_lm)
#>
#> Call:
#> lm(formula = co2_ppm ~ decimal_year, data = co2_df)
#>
#> Residuals:
#>    Min     1Q Median     3Q    Max
#> -6.040 -1.948 -0.002  1.911  6.515
#>
#> Coefficients:
#>               Estimate Std. Error t value Pr(>|t|)
#> (Intercept)  -2.25e+03   2.13e+01    -106   <2e-16 ***
#> decimal_year  1.31e+00   1.07e-02     122   <2e-16 ***
#> ---
#> Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
#>
#> Residual standard error: 2.62 on 466 degrees of freedom
#> Multiple R-squared:  0.969,  Adjusted R-squared:  0.969
#> F-statistic: 1.48e+04 on 1 and 466 DF,  p-value: <2e-16
lmtest::dwtest(co2_lm, alternative = "two.sided")
#>
#>  Durbin-Watson test
#>
#> data:  co2_lm
#> DW = 0.2124, p-value <2e-16
#> alternative hypothesis: true autocorrelation is not 0
lmtest::bgtest(co2_lm, order = 12)
#>
#>  Breusch-Godfrey test for serial correlation of order up to 12
#>
#> data:  co2_lm
#> LM test = 453.9, df = 12, p-value <2e-16
```

For both real-data examples, the diagnostics indicate residual dependence, consistent with their time-ordered structure.

No single diagnostic is definitive. In practice, we combine visual and formal diagnostics, and interpret them in the context of study design (Kutner et al. 2005, chap. 12; Draper and Smith 2014, chap. 11).

4.9 Model selection

(adapted from Dobson and Barnett (2018) §6.3.3; for more information on prediction, see James et al. (2013) and Harrell (2015)).

If we have a lot of covariates in our dataset, we might want to choose a small subset to use in our model.

There are a few possible metrics to consider for choosing a "best" model.

4.9.1 DAGs for variable selection

For explanatory models, variable inclusion should not rely on automated algorithms alone. Directed acyclic graphs (DAGs) can help us encode substantive assumptions about which variables are confounders, mediators, or colliders.

In a Dobson-style workflow, we use the DAG first to decide a defensible adjustment set, then compare candidate regression models within that set using predictive or likelihood-based criteria. This approach keeps model selection aligned with study design, rather than only with numerical fit.

In this workflow, the DAG encodes hypothesized time ordering and causal pathways. This structure helps us decide which variables belong in the candidate model set before we run stepwise, subset, or penalized selection methods. The key point is that a variable can improve apparent fit while still distorting the effect we care about if it sits on a causal pathway or induces collider bias (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.3.3).

Exm

Example 4.7 (high temperatures and mortality)**.** Suppose the research question is: "What is the effect of high temperatures on deaths?"
A plausible DAG includes: high temperatures → deaths, high temperatures → blackouts, high temperatures → forest fires, blackouts → deaths, forest fires → air pollution, and both forest fires and air pollution → deaths (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.3.3).

```
dag_heat_deaths <- ggdag::dagify(
  D ~ T + B + F + P,
  B ~ T,
  F ~ T,
  P ~ F,
  exposure = "T",
  outcome = "D",
  labels = c(
    T = "High temperatures",
    D = "Deaths",
    B = "Blackouts",
    F = "Forest fires",
    P = "Air pollution"
  )
)

dag_heat_deaths |>
  ggdag::ggdag(use_labels = "label") +
  ggdag::theme_dag()
```

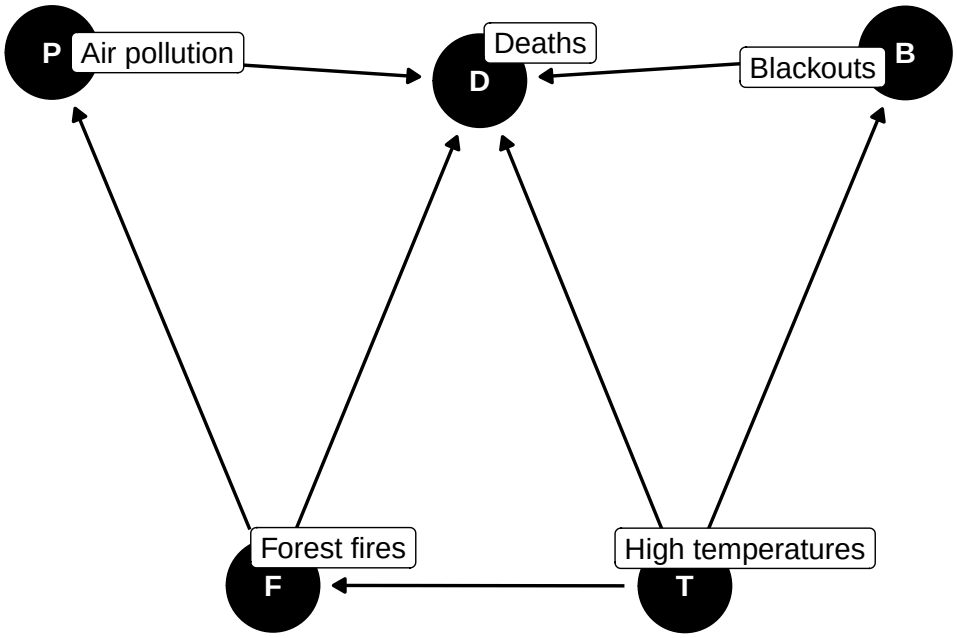


Figure 38: DAG for the high temperatures and mortality example.

If our estimand is the total effect of high temperatures on deaths, then blackouts, forest fires, and air pollution are mediators on downstream pathways. Adjusting for them would remove part of the effect we are trying to estimate.
But if the estimand changes to the effect of blackouts on deaths, then high temperatures become a confounder because they are a common cause of both blackouts and deaths. So the same variable can be "adjust for" or "do not adjust for" depending on the causal question.

Exm

Example 4.8 (salmonellosis and weather)**.** For daily salmonellosis counts, a plausible DAG has temperature and rainfall as direct causes of risk, with both variables also affecting humidity. If humidity has no direct arrow to salmonellosis, then humidity is not a causal driver; it mainly reflects shared variation from temperature and rainfall. Including humidity in the regression is therefore usually unnecessary for estimating the weather effects, and it may reduce interpretability because humidity is a collider of temperature and rainfall. Conditioning on humidity can induce misleading associations and bias weather-effect estimates when that conditioning opens a path between temperature and rainfall that is not otherwise blocked (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.3.3).

```r
dag_salmonellosis_weather <- ggdag::dagify(
  S ~ T + R + C,
  H ~ T + R,
  T ~ Se,
  R ~ Se,
  labels = c(
    S = "Salmonellosis",
    T = "Temperature",
    R = "Rainfall",
    H = "Humidity",
    C = "Test change",
    Se = "Season"
  )
)

dag_salmonellosis_weather |>
  ggdag::ggdag(use_labels = "label") +
  ggdag::theme_dag()
```

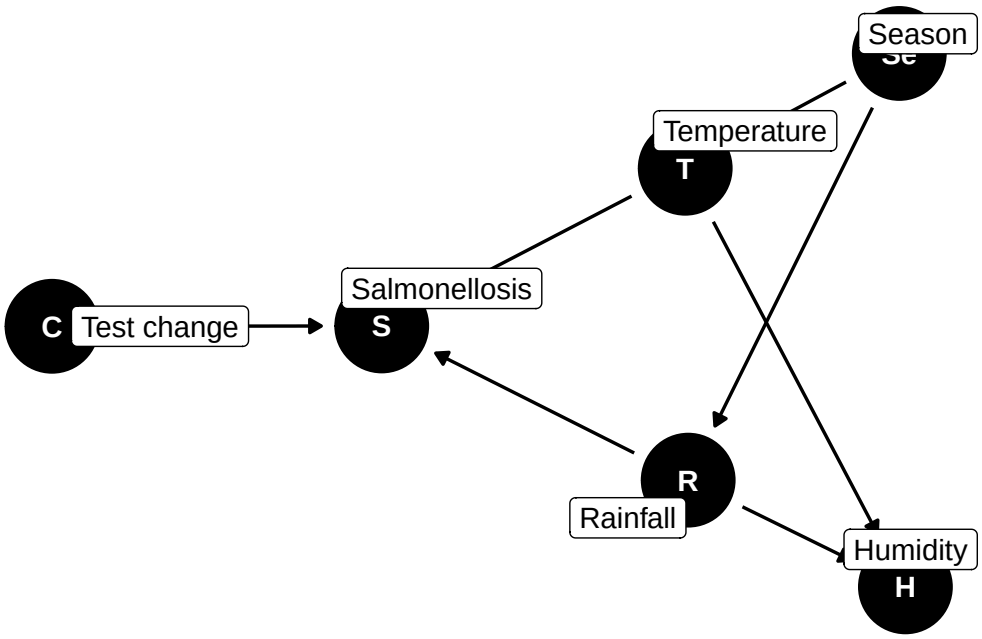


Figure 39: DAG for the salmonellosis and weather example.

The same DAG can include a “change in test” indicator when surveillance switched to a more sensitive diagnostic test. That variable can improve predictive accuracy and face validity, but omitting it does not invalidate causal interpretation for temperature and rainfall effects if it is not on their causal paths (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.3.3).
Likewise, season may cause both temperature and rainfall, but if season has no direct path to salmonellosis beyond those weather variables, including season can obscure interpretation of the proximal weather effects (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.3.3).
Finally, DAG-informed variable definitions matter. In one intensive-care example, a “nutrition score” looked highly predictive of mortality until investigators clarified that people near death were often coded as zero because no assessment was completed. So the recorded variable combined nutrition with prognosis, and naive selection would overstate its scientific meaning (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.3.3).

4.9.2 Mean squared error

We might want to minimize the **mean squared error**, $\mathrm{E}[(y-\hat{y})^2]$, for new observations that weren't in our data set when we fit the model.

Unfortunately,

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i-\hat{y}_i)^2$$

gives a biased estimate of $\mathrm{E}[(y-\hat{y})^2]$ for new data. If we want an unbiased estimate, we will have to be clever.

This optimism in sample fit is one reason that R^2 is not enough for model selection. R^2 does not decrease as we add explanatory variables, even when those variables do not improve out-of-sample prediction. Selecting a model by maximizing R^2 alone can lead to overfitting, since R^2 does not penalize this non-decreasing property.

With a training/test split, we estimate coefficients in the training data and compute prediction error in held-out data:

$$\hat{\beta}_{\text{train}} = ({X_{\text{train}}}^{\top} X_{\text{train}})^{-1} {X_{\text{train}}}^{\top} y_{\text{train}}$$

$$\hat{e}_{i,\text{test}} = y_{\text{test},i} - \left\{ \hat{\beta}_{0,\text{train}} + \sum_{j=1}^{p} \hat{\beta}_{j,\text{train}} x_{\text{test},ij} \right\}, \quad i \in \text{test set}$$

$$\text{RMSE} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{n_{\text{test}}} \sum_{i \in \text{test set}} (\hat{e}_{i,\text{test}})^2}$$

4.10 Train/validation/test splits

In many applications, we split the data into training, validation, and test sets. This validation approach extends the basic train/test split by separating model tuning from final model assessment. This framework follows (James et al. 2021, 198–201).

- Use the **training set** to estimate model parameters.
- Use the **validation set** to compare candidate models, choose transformations, or tune hyperparameters.
- Use the **test set** once at the end to estimate final out-of-sample performance.

Keeping the test set untouched during model building helps avoid optimistic bias from repeatedly trying many models. If data are limited, k-fold cross-validation can replace a single validation split for more stable tuning.

Exm

Example 4.9 (Numerical example)**.** The following example (Example 4.9) uses R's built-in `mtcars` dataset ($n = 32$ cars) to predict fuel efficiency (`mpg`) from vehicle weight (`wt`). It uses one random split to compare linear, quadratic, cubic, and quartic models (`mpg ~ wt`, `mpg ~ wt + I(wt^2)`, `mpg ~ wt + I(wt^2) + I(wt^3)`, and `mpg ~ wt + I(wt^2) + I(wt^3) + I(wt^4)`) on a validation set, then reports the chosen model's test RMSE on untouched test data (James et al. 2021, 213).

```r
set.seed(108)
n <- nrow(mtcars)

n_train <- floor(0.6 * n)
n_valid <- floor(0.2 * n)

idx_train <- sample.int(n, size = n_train)
idx_remaining <- setdiff(seq_len(n), idx_train)
idx_valid <- sample(idx_remaining, size = n_valid)
idx_test <- setdiff(idx_remaining, idx_valid)

split_sizes <- tibble::tibble(
  split = c("training", "validation", "test"),
  n = c(length(idx_train), length(idx_valid), length(idx_test))
)
```

Table 28: Sizes of the training, validation, and test splits

```r
split_sizes
#> # A tibble: 3 x 2
#>   split          n
#>   <chr>      <int>
#> 1 training      19
#> 2 validation     6
#> 3 test           7
```

```r
train_dat <- mtcars[idx_train, ]
valid_dat <- mtcars[idx_valid, ]
test_dat <- mtcars[idx_test, ]

model_linear <- lm(mpg ~ wt, data = train_dat)
model_quadratic <- lm(mpg ~ wt + I(wt^2), data = train_dat)
model_cubic <- lm(mpg ~ wt + I(wt^2) + I(wt^3), data = train_dat)
model_quartic <- lm(
  mpg ~ wt + I(wt^2) + I(wt^3) + I(wt^4),
  data = train_dat
)

compute_rmse <- function(model, data) {
  sqrt(mean((data$mpg - predict(model, newdata = data))^2))
}

candidate_models <- list(
  linear = model_linear,
  quadratic = model_quadratic,
  cubic = model_cubic,
  quartic = model_quartic
)

validation_results <- tibble::tibble(
  model = names(candidate_models)
) |>
  dplyr::mutate(
    training_RMSE = purrr::map_dbl(
      model,
      \(model_name) compute_rmse(candidate_models[[model_name]], train_dat)
    ),
    validation_RMSE = purrr::map_dbl(
      model,
      \(model_name) compute_rmse(candidate_models[[model_name]], valid_dat)
    )
  )

model_labels <- c(
  linear = "linear model",
  quadratic = "quadratic model",
  cubic = "cubic model",
  quartic = "quartic model"
)

chosen_model_name <-
  validation_results |>
  dplyr::arrange(validation_RMSE) |>
  dplyr::slice(1) |>
  dplyr::pull(model)

chosen_model_label <- model_labels[[chosen_model_name]]

chosen_model <- candidate_models[[chosen_model_name]]
chosen_model_validation_rmse <- compute_rmse(chosen_model, valid_dat)

performance_comparison <- tibble::tibble(
  split = c("validation", "test"),
  model = chosen_model_name,
  RMSE = c(
    chosen_model_validation_rmse,
    compute_rmse(chosen_model, test_dat)
  )
```

```r
partition_colors <- c(
  training = "#1b9e77",
  validation = "#d95f02",
  test = "#7570b3"
)
partition_shapes <- c(
  training = 16,
  validation = 17,
  test = 15
)
wt_range <- range(c(train_dat$wt, valid_dat$wt, test_dat$wt))
mpg_range <- range(c(train_dat$mpg, valid_dat$mpg, test_dat$mpg))
wt_grid <- seq(wt_range[1], wt_range[2], length.out = 200)
```

```r
plot(
  train_dat$wt,
  train_dat$mpg,
  xlab = "wt",
  ylab = "mpg",
  pch = partition_shapes[["training"]],
  xlim = wt_range,
  ylim = mpg_range,
  col = partition_colors[["training"]]
)
points(
  valid_dat$wt,
  valid_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["validation"]],
  col = partition_colors[["validation"]]
)
points(
  test_dat$wt,
  test_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["test"]],
  col = partition_colors[["test"]]
)
abline(model_linear, col = "blue", lwd = 2)
legend(
  "topright",
  legend = c("training", "validation", "test", "linear fit"),
  col = c(unname(partition_colors), "blue"),
  pch = c(unname(partition_shapes), NA),
  lty = c(NA, NA, NA, 1),
  lwd = c(NA, NA, NA, 2),
  bty = "n"
)
```

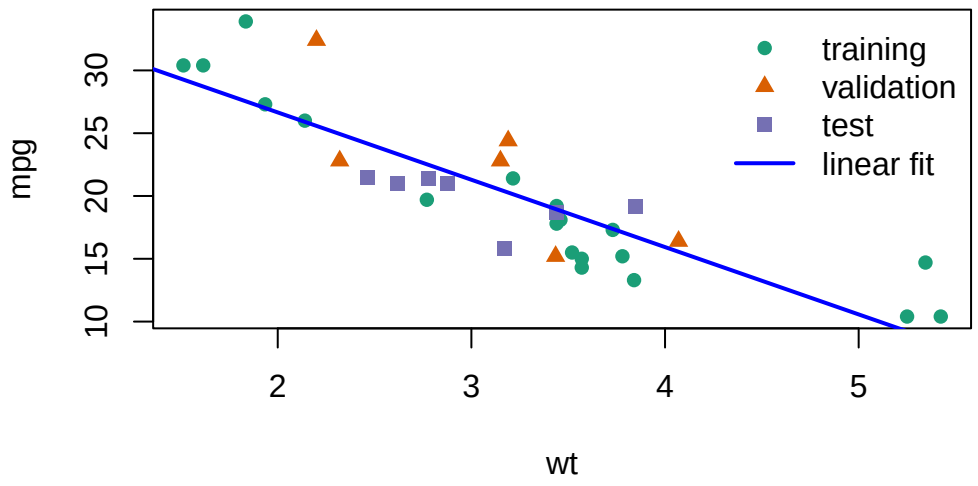


Figure 40: Linear model fit superimposed on data partitions

```r
plot(
  train_dat$wt,
  train_dat$mpg,
  xlab = "wt",
  ylab = "mpg",
  pch = partition_shapes[["training"]],
  xlim = wt_range,
  ylim = mpg_range,
  col = partition_colors[["training"]]
)
points(
  valid_dat$wt,
  valid_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["validation"]],
  col = partition_colors[["validation"]]
)
points(
  test_dat$wt,
  test_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["test"]],
  col = partition_colors[["test"]]
)
quadratic_pred <- predict(
  model_quadratic,
  newdata = data.frame(wt = wt_grid)
)
lines(wt_grid, quadratic_pred, col = "blue", lwd = 2)
legend(
  "topright",
  legend = c("training", "validation", "test", "quadratic fit"),
  col = c(unname(partition_colors), "blue"),
  pch = c(unname(partition_shapes), NA),
  lty = c(NA, NA, NA, 1),
  lwd = c(NA, NA, NA, 2),
  bty = "n"
)
```

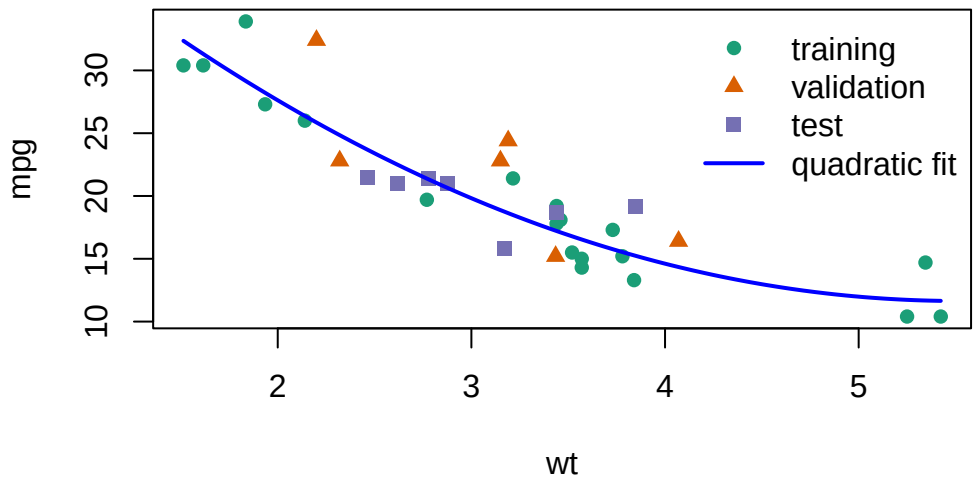


Figure 41: Quadratic model fit superimposed on data partitions

```r
plot(
  train_dat$wt,
  train_dat$mpg,
  xlab = "wt",
  ylab = "mpg",
  pch = partition_shapes[["training"]],
  xlim = wt_range,
  ylim = mpg_range,
  col = partition_colors[["training"]]
)
points(
  valid_dat$wt,
  valid_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["validation"]],
  col = partition_colors[["validation"]]
)
points(
  test_dat$wt,
  test_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["test"]],
  col = partition_colors[["test"]]
)
cubic_pred <- predict(
  model_cubic,
  newdata = data.frame(wt = wt_grid)
)
lines(wt_grid, cubic_pred, col = "blue", lwd = 2)
legend(
  "topright",
  legend = c("training", "validation", "test", "cubic fit"),
  col = c(unname(partition_colors), "blue"),
  pch = c(unname(partition_shapes), NA),
  lty = c(NA, NA, NA, 1),
  lwd = c(NA, NA, NA, 2),
  bty = "n"
)
```

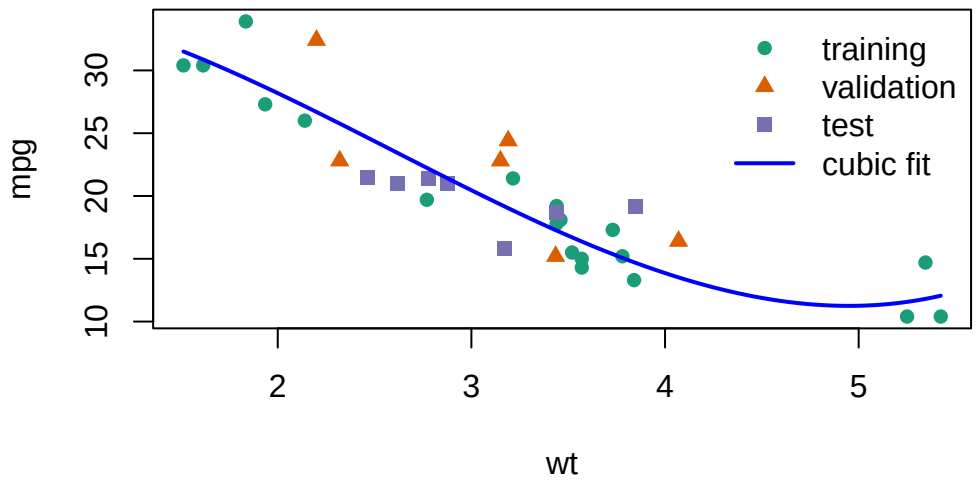


Figure 42: Cubic model fit superimposed on data partitions

```
plot(
  train_dat$wt,
  train_dat$mpg,
  xlab = "wt",
  ylab = "mpg",
  pch = partition_shapes[["training"]],
  xlim = wt_range,
  ylim = mpg_range,
  col = partition_colors[["training"]]
)
points(
  valid_dat$wt,
  valid_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["validation"]],
  col = partition_colors[["validation"]]
)
points(
  test_dat$wt,
  test_dat$mpg,
  pch = partition_shapes[["test"]],
  col = partition_colors[["test"]]
)
quartic_pred <- predict(
  model_quartic,
  newdata = data.frame(wt = wt_grid)
)
lines(wt_grid, quartic_pred, col = "blue", lwd = 2)
legend(
  "topright",
  legend = c("training", "validation", "test", "quartic fit"),
  col = c(unname(partition_colors), "blue"),
  pch = c(unname(partition_shapes), NA),
  lty = c(NA, NA, NA, 1),
  lwd = c(NA, NA, NA, 2),
  bty = "n"
)
```

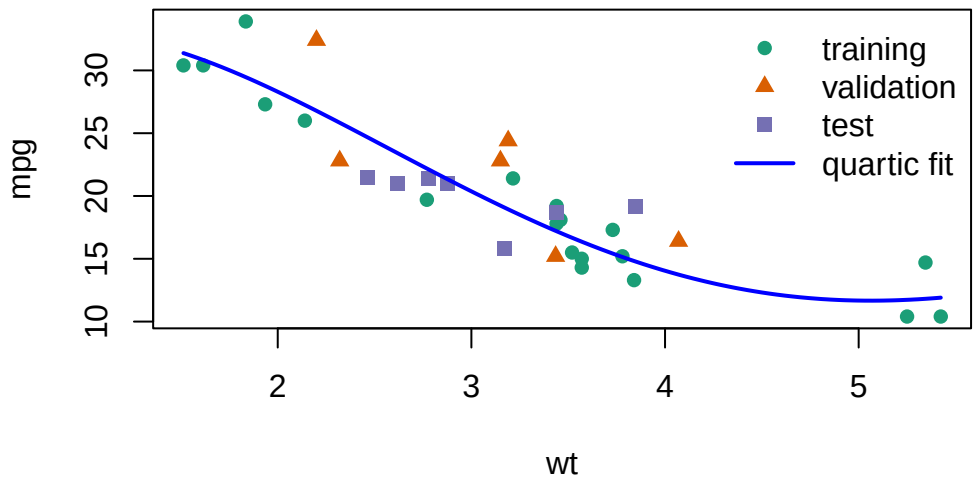


Figure 43: Quartic model fit superimposed on data partitions

Table 29: Training and validation RMSE for candidate models

```
validation_results
#> # A tibble: 4 x 3
#>   model     training_RMSE validation_RMSE
#>   <chr>             <dbl>           <dbl>
#> 1 linear             2.80            3.84
#> 2 quadratic          1.96            4.16
#> 3 cubic              1.91            3.98
#> 4 quartic            1.90            3.97
```

The chosen model is the linear model, because it has the lower validation RMSE.

Table 30: Validation and test RMSE for the chosen model

```
performance_comparison
#> # A tibble: 2 x 3
#>   split      model   RMSE
#>   <chr>      <chr>  <dbl>
#> 1 validation linear  3.84
#> 2 test       linear  2.44
```

4.11 Cross-validation

Rather than one arbitrary split, k-fold cross-validation repeatedly partitions the data into training and test folds. For each split we compute prediction error, then summarize errors across folds and replications. The preferred model has lower prediction error, with simpler models favored when errors are similar.

When the number of candidate explanatory variables is small, we can compare all possible subsets

(2^p models) using the same cross-validation metric.

```
data("carbohydrate", package = "dobson")
library(cvTools)
full_model <- lm(carbohydrate ~ ., data = carbohydrate)
cv_full <-
  full_model |> cvFit(
    data = carbohydrate, K = 5, R = 10,
    y = carbohydrate$carbohydrate
  )

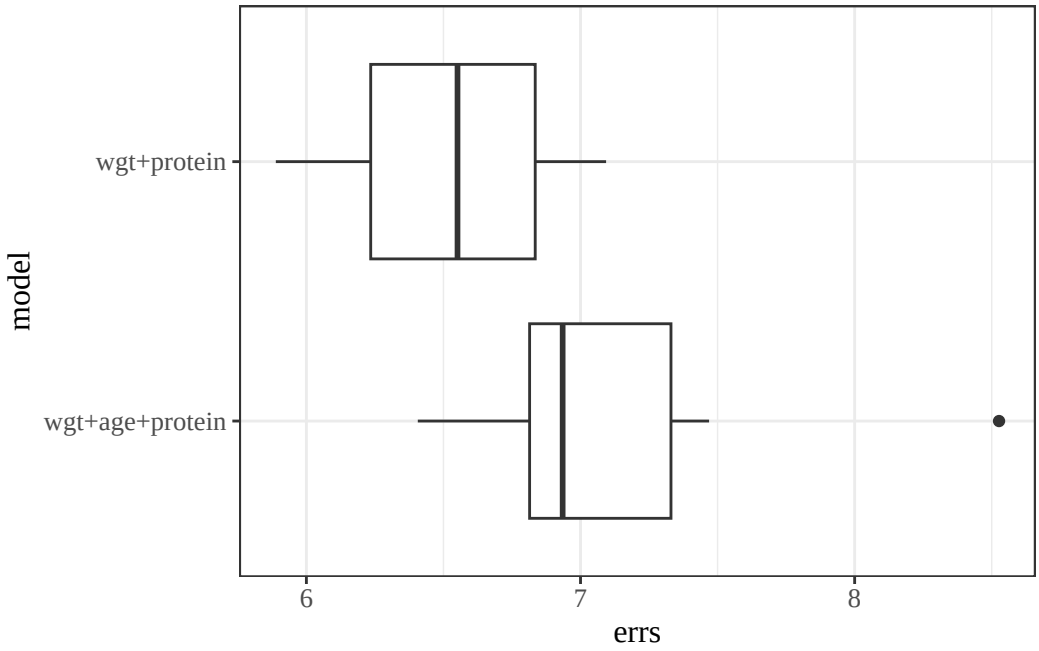
reduced_model <- full_model |> update(formula = ~ . - age)

cv_reduced <-
  reduced_model |> cvFit(
    data = carbohydrate, K = 5, R = 10,
    y = carbohydrate$carbohydrate
  )
```

```
results_reduced <-
  tibble(
    model = "wgt+protein",
    errs = cv_reduced$reps[]
  )
results_full <-
  tibble(
    model = "wgt+age+protein",
    errs = cv_full$reps[]
  )

cv_results <-
  bind_rows(results_reduced, results_full)

cv_results |>
  ggplot(aes(y = model, x = errs)) +
  geom_boxplot()
```



4.11.1 comparing metrics

```
compare_results <- tribble(
  ~model, ~cvRMSE, ~r.squared, ~adj.r.squared, ~trainRMSE, ~loglik,
  "full",
  cv_full$cv,
  summary(full_model)$r.squared,
  summary(full_model)$adj.r.squared,
  sigma(full_model),
  logLik(full_model) |> as.numeric(),
  "reduced",
  cv_reduced$cv,
  summary(reduced_model)$r.squared,
  summary(reduced_model)$adj.r.squared,
  sigma(reduced_model),
  logLik(reduced_model) |> as.numeric()
)

compare_results
#> # A tibble: 2 x 6
#>   model   cvRMSE r.squared adj.r.squared trainRMSE loglik
#>   <chr>    <dbl>     <dbl>         <dbl>     <dbl>  <dbl>
#> 1 full      7.13     0.481         0.383      5.96  -61.8
#> 2 reduced   6.53     0.445         0.380      5.97  -62.5
```

```
anova(full_model, reduced_model)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 6
#>   Res.Df   RSS    Df `Sum of Sq`     F `Pr(>F)`
#>    <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>       <dbl> <dbl>    <dbl>
#> 1     16  568.    NA        NA    NA      NA
#> 2     17  606.    -1       -38.4  1.08    0.314
```

4.12 Best subset selection

When the number of candidate predictors is modest, we can use **best subset selection**. For each model size $k = 0, 1, \ldots, p$, we fit all $\binom{p}{k}$ models and keep the best model of size k (e.g., by lowest RSS in the training data).

Best subset selection yields at most $p + 1$ candidate models to compare across model sizes, using criteria such as cross-validated prediction error, C_p, AIC/BIC, or adjusted R^2. In that sense, best subset selection is more exhaustive than one-path methods like forward or backward stepwise selection.

For a full algorithmic treatment, including validation and criterion-based comparison across model size, see the ISLR treatment of best subset selection (James et al. 2013).

```
hers_subset <- rmb::hers |> haven::zap_labels() |>
  dplyr::select(LDL, age, weight, BMI, HDL, TG, SBP) |>
  tidyr::drop_na()

hers_lm_subset <- lm(
  LDL ~ age + weight + BMI + HDL + TG + SBP,
  data = hers_subset
)

hers_best_subset <- olsrr::ols_step_best_subset(hers_lm_subset)

hers_best_subset$metrics |>
  dplyr::arrange(dplyr::desc(adjr)) |>
  dplyr::slice_head(n = 5)
#> # A tibble: 5 x 14
#>   mindex     n predictors     rsquare    adjr predrsq    cp    aic   sbic    sbc
#>    <int> <int> <chr>            <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl>  <dbl>  <dbl>
#> 1      5     5 age BMI HDL T~ 0.0131  0.0113  0.00868  5.04 27730. 19934. 27771.
#> 2      4     4 age BMI TG SBP 0.0127  0.0112  0.00900  4.27 27729. 19933. 27764.
#> 3      6     6 age weight BM~ 0.0131  0.0110  0.00802  7    27732. 19936. 27779.
#> 4      3     3 age TG SBP     0.0113  0.0103  0.00839  5.91 27730. 19935. 27760.
#> 5      2     2 age TG         0.00825 0.00752 0.00602 12.5  27737. 19941. 27761.
#> # i 4 more variables: msep <dbl>, fpe <dbl>, apc <dbl>, hsp <dbl>
```

4.13 Stepwise regression

Stepwise methods are another common approach. Forward selection adds variables one at a time. Backward selection starts with the full model and removes variables sequentially. Both approaches can select different models from the same data.

> ⚠ Caution about stepwise selection
>
> Stepwise regression has several known problems:
> - It tends to select too many variables (overfitting)
> - P-values and confidence intervals are biased after selection
> - It ignores model uncertainty
> - Results can be unstable across different samples
>
> Consider using cross-validation, penalized methods (like Lasso), or subject-matter knowledge instead. See Harrell (2015) and Heinze et al. (2018) for more discussion.

```
olsrr::ols_step_both_aic(full_model)
#>
#>
#>                               Stepwise Summary
```

```
#> ------------------------------------------------------------------------
#> Step    Variable         AIC        SBC       SBIC       R2       Adj. R2
#> ------------------------------------------------------------------------
#>  0      Base Model     140.773    142.764    83.068    0.00000    0.00000
#>  1      protein (+)    137.950    140.937    80.438    0.21427    0.17061
#>  2      weight (+)     132.981    136.964    77.191    0.44544    0.38020
#> ------------------------------------------------------------------------
#>
#> Final Model Output
#> ------------------
#>
#>                            Model Summary
#> ----------------------------------------------------------------
#> R                        0.667       RMSE                 5.505
#> R-Squared                0.445       MSE                 30.301
#> Adj. R-Squared           0.380       Coef. Var           15.879
#> Pred R-Squared           0.236       AIC                132.981
#> MAE                      4.593       SBC                136.964
#> ----------------------------------------------------------------
#>  RMSE: Root Mean Square Error
#>  MSE: Mean Square Error
#>  MAE: Mean Absolute Error
#>  AIC: Akaike Information Criteria
#>  SBC: Schwarz Bayesian Criteria
#>
#>                                ANOVA
#> ---------------------------------------------------------------------
#>                 Sum of
#>                Squares        DF    Mean Square      F        Sig.
#> ---------------------------------------------------------------------
#> Regression     486.778         2        243.389    6.827    0.0067
#> Residual       606.022        17         35.648
#> Total         1092.800        19
#> ---------------------------------------------------------------------
#>
#>                                  Parameter Estimates
#> ----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
#>       model      Beta    Std. Error    Std. Beta      t        Sig      lower     upper
#> ----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
#> (Intercept)    33.130        12.572                2.635    0.017     6.607    59.654
#>     protein     1.824         0.623        0.534    2.927    0.009     0.509     3.139
#>      weight    -0.222         0.083       -0.486   -2.662    0.016    -0.397    -0.046
#> ----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
```

4.14 Lasso

Lasso is a penalized regression method that shrinks coefficient estimates toward zero. It adds an L_1 penalty term to the objective function, creating a trade-off between model fit and parsimony. The intercept is not penalized.

As the tuning parameter λ increases, more coefficients are shrunken strongly, and some become exactly zero. So lasso both regularizes the model and performs variable selection. In practice, λ is usually chosen by cross-validation to minimize prediction error.

For Gaussian linear models, the penalized least-squares forms are:

$$\hat{\beta}^{\text{lasso}} = \arg\min_{\beta_0,\ldots,\beta_p} \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left\{ y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{ij} \right\}^2 + \lambda \sum_{j=1}^{p} |\beta_j| \right\}$$

$$\hat{\beta}^{\text{ridge}} = \arg\min_{\beta_0,\ldots,\beta_p} \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left\{ y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{ij} \right\}^2 + \lambda \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j^2 \right\}$$

$$\hat{\beta}^{\text{elastic-net}} = \arg\min_{\beta_0,\ldots,\beta_p} \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left\{ y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{ij} \right\}^2 + \lambda \left\{ \alpha \sum_{j=1}^{p} |\beta_j| + \frac{1-\alpha}{2} \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j^2 \right\} \right\}$$

```
library(glmnet)
y <- carbohydrate$carbohydrate
x <- carbohydrate |>
  select(age, weight, protein) |>
  as.matrix()
fit <- glmnet(x, y)
```

```
autoplot(fit, xvar = "lambda")
```

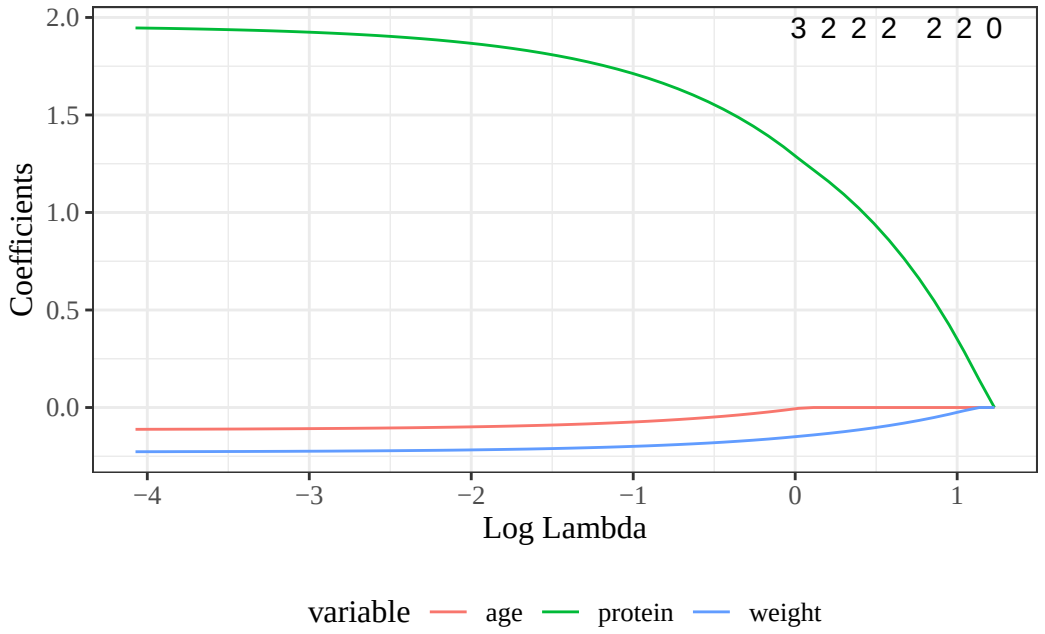
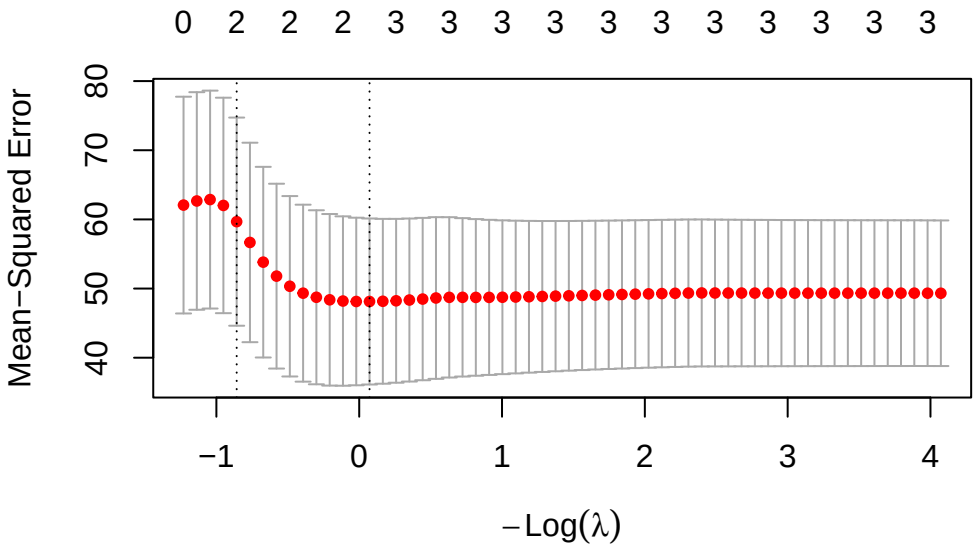


Figure 44: Lasso selection

```
cvfit <- cv.glmnet(x, y)
plot(cvfit)
```




```
coef(cvfit, s = "lambda.1se")
#> 4 x 1 sparse Matrix of class "dgCMatrix"
#>             lambda.1se
#> (Intercept) 34.5502388
#> age          .
#> weight      -0.0510494
#> protein      0.5472281
```

4.14.1 Likelihood ratio test for nested models

For a general MLE-focused discussion of likelihood-ratio tests, see Likelihood ratio tests for MLEs[16].

A **likelihood ratio test (LRT)** compares two nested models by computing twice the difference in their log-likelihoods:

$$2(\ell_1 - \ell_0) \dot{\sim} \chi^2_q \quad \text{(asymptotically under } H_0\text{)}$$

where $q = p_2 - p_1$ is the number of extra parameters in the full model.

```
logLik(bw_lm2)
#> 'log Lik.' -156.579 (df=5)
logLik(bw_lm1)
#> 'log Lik.' -156.695 (df=4)

log_LR <- (logLik(bw_lm2) - logLik(bw_lm1)) |> as.numeric()
delta_df <- (bw_lm1$df.residual - df.residual(bw_lm2))


x_max <- 1
```

[16] https://morrison-lab.github.io/sds/intro-MLEs.html#sec-lrt-mles

```r
d_log_LR <- function(x, df = delta_df) dchisq(x, df = df)

chisq_plot <-
  ggplot() +
  geom_function(fun = d_log_LR) +
  stat_function(
    fun = d_log_LR,
    xlim = c(2 * log_LR, x_max),
    geom = "area",
    fill = "gray"
  ) +
  geom_segment(
    aes(
      x = 2 * log_LR,
      xend = 2 * log_LR,
      y = 0,
      yend = d_log_LR(2 * log_LR)
    ),
    col = "red"
  ) +
  xlim(0.0001, x_max) +
  ylim(0, 4) +
  ylab("p(X=x)") +
  xlab("Likelihood-ratio test statistic [x] = 2 * log(likelihood ratio)") +
  theme_classic()
chisq_plot |> print()
```

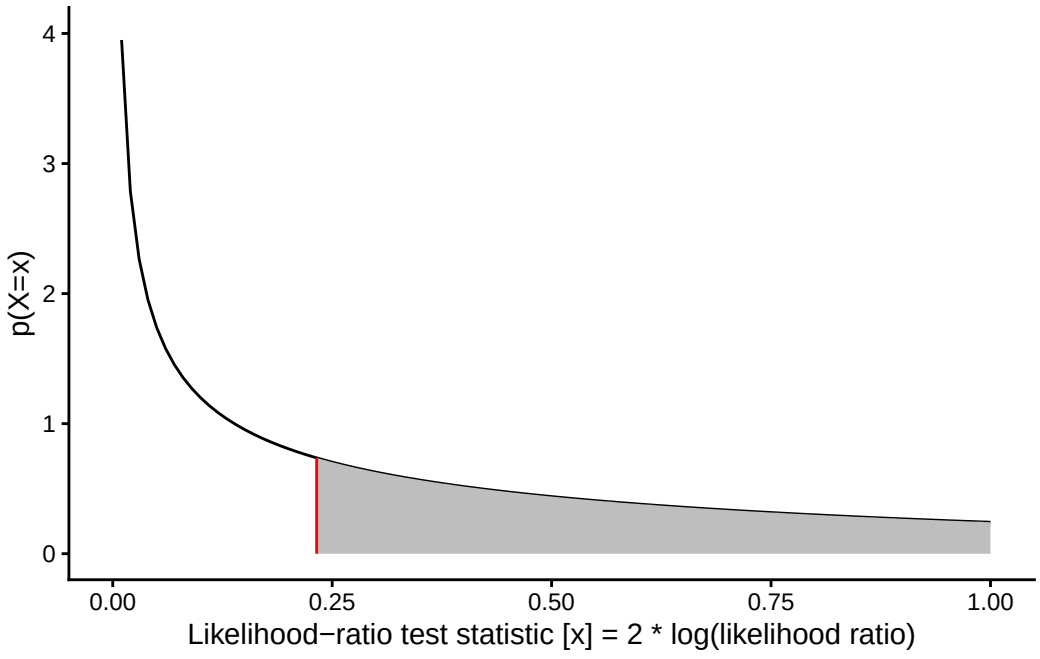


Figure 45: Chi-square distribution

Now we can get the p-value:

```r
pchisq(
  q = 2 * log_LR,
  df = delta_df,
```

```
  lower = FALSE
) |>
  print()
#> [1] 0.629806
```

In practice you don't have to do this by hand; there are functions to do it for you:

```
# built in
lmtest::lrtest(bw_lm2, bw_lm1)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 5
#>   `#Df` LogLik    Df  Chisq `Pr(>Chisq)`
#>   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl>        <dbl>
#> 1     5  -157.    NA NA           NA
#> 2     4  -157.    -1  0.232        0.630
```

4.14.2 Partial F-test for nested linear models

See Vittinghoff et al. (2012, sec. 4.3) and Dobson and Barnett (2018, sec. 6.3) for further discussion.

Setup

Suppose we have two **nested** linear regression models:

Definition 4.14 (Nested linear models)**.**

$$\mathrm{E}[Y \mid \tilde{x}] = \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{\beta} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_1 + \cdots + \beta_{p_1-1} x_{p_1-1} \tag{23}$$

$$\mathrm{E}[Y \mid \tilde{x}, \tilde{z}] = \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{\beta} + \tilde{z}^\top \tilde{\gamma} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_1 + \cdots + \beta_{p_1-1} x_{p_1-1} + \gamma_1 z_1 + \cdots + \gamma_q z_q \tag{24}$$

The **reduced model** (Equation 23) has p_1 parameters. The **full model** (Equation 24) adds q extra predictors and has $p_2 = p_1 + q$ parameters. The reduced model is a special case of the full model with the constraint $\tilde{\gamma} = \tilde{0}$.

The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$H_0 : \tilde{\gamma} = \tilde{0} \qquad \text{(reduced model)}$$
$$H_A : \tilde{\gamma} \neq \tilde{0} \qquad \text{(full model)}$$

Exm

Example 4.10 (Nested models: `birthweight` data)**.** In the `birthweight` example, the **reduced model** has $p_1 = 3$ parameters:

$$\mathrm{E}[\text{weight} \mid \text{sex}, \text{age}] = \beta_0 + \beta_{\text{sex}} \cdot \text{sex} + \beta_A \cdot \text{age}$$

The **full model** adds an interaction term ($q = 1$ extra parameter, $p_2 = 4$):

$$\mathrm{E}[\text{weight} \mid \text{sex}, \text{age}] = \beta_0 + \beta_{\text{sex}} \cdot \text{sex} + \beta_A \cdot \text{age} + \beta_{AM} \cdot \text{sex} \cdot \text{age}$$

$H_0 : \beta_{AM} = 0$ vs. $H_A : \beta_{AM} \neq 0$.

F-statistic

Definition 4.15 (Partial F-statistic)**.** Let RSS_0 and RSS_1 denote the residual sums of squares from the reduced and full models, respectively. The **partial F-statistic** is:

$$F = \frac{(\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1) \,/\, q}{\text{RSS}_1 \,/\, (n - p_2)} \tag{25}$$

where:

- $\text{RSS}_0 = \sum_{i=1}^{n} (y_i - \hat{y}_i^{(0)})^2$ is the residual SS under H_0
- $\text{RSS}_1 = \sum_{i=1}^{n} (y_i - \hat{y}_i^{(1)})^2$ is the residual SS under H_A
- $q = p_2 - p_1$ is the number of constraints (extra parameters in the full model)
- $n - p_2$ is the residual degrees of freedom of the full model

---

Theorem 4.5 (Null distribution of the partial F-statistic)**.** *Under H_0 and the Gaussian linear regression assumptions,*

$$F \;\sim\; F_{q,\, n-p_2} \tag{26}$$

This exact distribution is non-asymptotic: it holds for any sample size n when the errors $\epsilon_i \;\sim_{\text{iid}}\; N(0, \sigma^2)$.

Proof

Proof. Under H_0, the extra predictors $\tilde{z}$ contribute nothing, so the numerator $\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1 \;\sim\; \sigma^2 \chi^2_q$ and the denominator $\text{RSS}_1 \;\sim\; \sigma^2 \chi^2_{n-p_2}$ are independent chi-squared random variables (this independence property follows from the Gauss-Markov theorem and the properties of projections in the column spaces of the design matrices). Therefore,

$$F = \frac{(\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1)/q}{\text{RSS}_1/(n-p_2)} = \frac{\chi^2_q / q}{\chi^2_{n-p_2}/(n-p_2)} \;\sim\; F_{q,\, n-p_2}.$$

□

Connection to deviance

From Section 4.1.8, the Gaussian deviance of model k is $D_k = \text{RSS}_k / \hat{\sigma}^2$, where $\hat{\sigma}^2$ is an estimate of σ^2. Because $\hat{\sigma}^2$ appears in both the numerator and denominator of Equation 25, it cancels:

$$F = \frac{(D_0 - D_1) \,/\, q}{D_1 \,/\, (n - p_2)} = \frac{(\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1) \,/\, q}{\text{RSS}_1 \,/\, (n - p_2)} \tag{27}$$

The denominator $s^2 \overset{\text{def}}{=} \text{RSS}_1/(n-p_2)$ is an unbiased estimator of σ^2 under both H_0 and H_A.

Connection to the likelihood ratio test

The **approximate likelihood ratio test** (LRT) for MLEs (see the table of Gaussian vs. MLE-based tests[17] and Section 4.1.8) uses the statistic:

[17] https://morrison-lab.github.io/sds/intro-MLEs.html#tbl-gaussian-vs-mle-tests

$$\lambda = 2(\ell_1 - \ell_0) \dot{\sim} \chi^2_q \quad \text{under } H_0 \text{ (asymptotically)} \tag{28}$$

For Gaussian linear regression, the MLE of σ^2 under model k is $\hat{\sigma}^2_k = \text{RSS}_k/n$, so the log-likelihood at the MLE is:

$$\begin{aligned} \ell_k &= -\frac{n}{2}\log(2\pi\hat{\sigma}^2_k) - \frac{n}{2} \\ &= -\frac{n}{2}\log\left(\frac{2\pi\,\text{RSS}_k}{n}\right) - \frac{n}{2} \end{aligned} \tag{29}$$

Substituting into Equation 28:

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda &= 2(\ell_1 - \ell_0) \\ &= 2\left[-\frac{n}{2}\log\left(\frac{\text{RSS}_1}{n}\right) + \frac{n}{2}\log\left(\frac{\text{RSS}_0}{n}\right)\right] \\ &= n\log\left(\frac{\text{RSS}_0}{\text{RSS}_1}\right) \end{aligned} \tag{30}$$

Asymptotic equivalence of F-test and LRT

For large n, F and λ are approximately related by:

$$\lambda \approx q \cdot F \tag{31}$$

This approximation follows because when H_0 is true and n is large, $(\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1)/\text{RSS}_1$ is small, and:

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda &= n\log\left(\frac{\text{RSS}_0}{\text{RSS}_1}\right) \\ &= n\log\left(1 + \frac{\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1}{\text{RSS}_1}\right) \\ &\approx n \cdot \frac{\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1}{\text{RSS}_1} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} q \cdot F &= q \cdot \frac{(\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1)/q}{\text{RSS}_1/(n-p_2)} \\ &= (n-p_2) \cdot \frac{\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1}{\text{RSS}_1} \\ &\approx n \cdot \frac{\text{RSS}_0 - \text{RSS}_1}{\text{RSS}_1} \end{aligned}$$

So $\lambda \approx q \cdot F$ for large n, and both statistics have the same asymptotic null distribution χ^2_q (since $q \cdot F_{q,n-p_2} \dot{\sim} \chi^2_q$ as $n \to \infty$).

---

i Why use the F-test instead of the LRT?

For Gaussian linear regression:

- The **F-test** is **exact** — it has the correct $F_{q,n-p_2}$ null distribution for any sample size n, provided the errors are Gaussian. It accounts for the estimation of σ^2 via the residual degrees of freedom.
- The **LRT** is **approximate** — it relies on the asymptotic χ^2_q distribution, which requires

Table 31

```
anova(bw_lm1, bw_lm2)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 6
#>   Res.Df     RSS    Df `Sum of Sq`      F `Pr(>F)`
#>    <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl>       <dbl>  <dbl>    <dbl>
#> 1     21 658771.    NA          NA   NA       NA
#> 2     20 652425.     1       6346.  0.195    0.664
```

Table 32

```
lmtest::lrtest(bw_lm1, bw_lm2)
#> # A tibble: 2 x 5
#>   `#Df` LogLik    Df  Chisq `Pr(>Chisq)`
#>   <dbl>  <dbl> <dbl>  <dbl>        <dbl>
#> 1     4  -157.    NA NA           NA
#> 2     5  -157.     1  0.232        0.630
```

large n and treats σ^2 as known (fixed at its MLE).
Both tests give similar p-values for large n. For small to moderate n, the F-test is preferred because it is exact.
For non-Gaussian GLMs (Poisson, Binomial), the F-test is not applicable; the LRT (or Wald test) is the standard approach.

In R

In R, the partial F-test for two nested `lm` models is performed with `anova()`:

`anova(bw_lm1, bw_lm2)` performs the partial F-test comparing the reduced model `bw_lm1` (parallel slopes, no interaction) against the full model `bw_lm2` (with sex-age interaction). The output shows the RSS for each model, the difference, the F-statistic, and the p-value.

For comparison, the approximate likelihood ratio test using the `lmtest` package:

Compare the p-values from `anova()` (exact F-test) and `lmtest::lrtest()` (approximate LRT). They are similar but not identical: the F-test uses the $F_{1,n-4}$ distribution, while the LRT uses the asymptotic χ^2_1 distribution. For large n, these p-values converge.

Extracting F-test components by hand

To understand the computation, we can replicate the F-statistic manually:

The LRT statistic $\lambda = n \log(\text{RSS}_0/\text{RSS}_1) \approx q \cdot F$ for large n.

The LRT statistic λ and $q \cdot F$ are close in value, illustrating the asymptotic equivalence Equation 31.

5 Inference about Gaussian Linear Regression Models

5.1 Motivating example: `birthweight` data

Research question: is there really an interaction between sex and age?

$H_0 : \beta_{AM} = 0$

$H_A : \beta_{AM} \neq 0$

Table 33

```
rss0 <- deviance(bw_lm1)   # RSS of reduced model
rss1 <- deviance(bw_lm2)   # RSS of full model
n    <- nobs(bw_lm2)
p2   <- length(coef(bw_lm2))
q    <- length(coef(bw_lm2)) - length(coef(bw_lm1))
s2   <- rss1 / (n - p2)    # residual variance estimate from full model

F_stat <- ((rss0 - rss1) / q) / s2
p_val  <- pf(F_stat, df1 = q, df2 = n - p2, lower.tail = FALSE)

cat("RSS_0 =", rss0, "\n")
#> RSS_0 = 658771
cat("RSS_1 =", rss1, "\n")
#> RSS_1 = 652425
cat("q     =", q,    "\n")
#> q     = 1
cat("s^2   =", s2,   "\n")
#> s^2   = 32621.2
cat("F     =", F_stat, "\n")
#> F     = 0.194543
cat("p-val =", p_val,  "\n")
#> p-val = 0.663893
```

Table 34

```
lambda <- n * log(rss0 / rss1)
cat("LRT statistic lambda =", lambda, "\n")
#> LRT statistic lambda = 0.232323
cat("q * F               =", q * F_stat, "\n")
#> q * F               = 0.194543
cat("LRT p-val (chi^2)   =", pchisq(lambda, df = q, lower.tail = FALSE), "\n")
#> LRT p-val (chi^2)   = 0.629806
```

$P(|\hat{\beta}_{AM}| > |-18.417241| \mid H_0) = ?$

5.2 Inference for individual predictor coefficients

5.2.1 Sampling distribution of $\hat{\beta}$

The Fisher information[18] for β is:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{I}_\beta &= \mathrm{E}\big[-\ell''_{\beta,\beta'}(Y|X,\beta,\sigma^2)\big] \\ &= \frac{1}{\sigma^2}\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X}\end{aligned}$$

Therefore:

$$\mathrm{Var}\big(\hat{\beta}\big) \approx (\mathcal{I}_\beta)^{-1} = \sigma^2(\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1}$$

and

$$\hat{\beta} \dot{\sim} N(\beta, \mathcal{I}_\beta^{-1})$$

These distribution properties are all results you have hopefully seen before.

In the Gaussian linear regression case, we also have exact results. To test $H_0 : \beta_j = \beta_{j,0}$ (typically $\beta_{j,0} = 0$):

$$\frac{\hat{\beta}_j - \beta_{j,0}}{\widehat{\mathrm{se}}\big(\hat{\beta}_j\big)} \sim t_{n-p}$$

5.2.2 Estimated covariance matrix and standard errors

Interpreting the layout of the covariance matrix

The covariance matrix $\widehat{\mathrm{Cov}}(\hat{\vec{\beta}})$ is a $p \times p$ symmetric matrix, where p is the number of regression coefficients (including the intercept, if present). Its rows and columns correspond to those p coefficient estimates. When an intercept is included, the coefficients are typically written $\hat{\beta}_0, \hat{\beta}_1, ...$, with $\hat{\beta}_0$ denoting the intercept. The matrix entries themselves are still indexed by position, so matrix row/column index 1 corresponds to the intercept term when one is included.

The general layout is:

$$\widehat{\mathrm{Cov}}(\hat{\vec{\beta}}) = \begin{array}{c|cccc} & \hat{\beta}_0 & \hat{\beta}_1 & \cdots & \hat{\beta}_{p-1} \\ \hline \hat{\beta}_0 & \mathrm{Var}\big(\hat{\beta}_0\big) & \mathrm{Cov}\big(\hat{\beta}_0, \hat{\beta}_1\big) & \cdots & \mathrm{Cov}\big(\hat{\beta}_0, \hat{\beta}_{p-1}\big) \\ \hat{\beta}_1 & \mathrm{Cov}\big(\hat{\beta}_1, \hat{\beta}_0\big) & \mathrm{Var}\big(\hat{\beta}_1\big) & \cdots & \mathrm{Cov}\big(\hat{\beta}_1, \hat{\beta}_{p-1}\big) \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \hat{\beta}_{p-1} & \mathrm{Cov}\big(\hat{\beta}_{p-1}, \hat{\beta}_0\big) & \mathrm{Cov}\big(\hat{\beta}_{p-1}, \hat{\beta}_1\big) & \cdots & \mathrm{Var}\big(\hat{\beta}_{p-1}\big) \end{array}$$

Specifically, the matrix entries represent:

- The **diagonal** entries are the **variances** of the individual coefficient estimates: the entry in matrix position $(j+1, j+1)$ is $\mathrm{Var}\big(\hat{\beta}_j\big)$, for $j = 0, 1, \ldots, p-1$.
- The **off-diagonal** entries are the **covariances** between pairs of coefficient estimates: the entry in matrix position $(i+1, j+1)$ is $\mathrm{Cov}\big(\hat{\beta}_i, \hat{\beta}_j\big)$, for $i \neq j$.

[18] https://morrison-lab.github.io/sds/intro-MLEs.html#def-einf

- The matrix is **symmetric**: $\text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_i, \hat{\beta}_j\right) = \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_j, \hat{\beta}_i\right)$.

Exm

Example 5.1. For model 2, which has four coefficients $(\hat{\beta}_0, \hat{\beta}_M, \hat{\beta}_A, \hat{\beta}_{AM})$, the covariance matrix has the following layout:

$$\text{Cov}(\hat{\tilde{\beta}}) = \begin{array}{c|cccc} & \hat{\beta}_0 & \hat{\beta}_M & \hat{\beta}_A & \hat{\beta}_{AM} \\ \hline \hat{\beta}_0 & \text{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}_0\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_0, \hat{\beta}_M\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_0, \hat{\beta}_A\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_0, \hat{\beta}_{AM}\right) \\ \hat{\beta}_M & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_M, \hat{\beta}_0\right) & \text{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}_M\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_M, \hat{\beta}_A\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_M, \hat{\beta}_{AM}\right) \\ \hat{\beta}_A & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_A, \hat{\beta}_0\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_A, \hat{\beta}_M\right) & \text{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}_A\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_A, \hat{\beta}_{AM}\right) \\ \hat{\beta}_{AM} & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_{AM}, \hat{\beta}_0\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_{AM}, \hat{\beta}_M\right) & \text{Cov}\left(\hat{\beta}_{AM}, \hat{\beta}_A\right) & \text{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}_{AM}\right) \end{array}$$

The estimate of that matrix, $\widehat{\text{Cov}}\left(\hat{\beta}\right)$ is in Table 35.

Table 35: Covariance matrix of $\hat{\tilde{\beta}}$ for `birthweight` model 2 (with interaction term)

```
bw_lm2 |> vcov()
#>             (Intercept)  sexmale        age sexmale:age
#> (Intercept)     1353968 -1353968 -34870.966   34870.966
#> sexmale        -1353968  2596387  34870.966  -67210.974
#> age              -34871    34871    899.896    -899.896
#> sexmale:age       34871   -67211   -899.896    1743.548
```

The square roots of the diagonal entries give the standard errors of the coefficient estimates:

```
bw_lm2 |>
  vcov() |>
  diag() |>
  sqrt()
#> (Intercept)     sexmale         age sexmale:age
#>   1163.6015   1611.3309     29.9983     41.7558
```

```
bw_lm2 |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md()
```

Table 36: Estimated model for `birthweight` data with interaction term

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(20)	p
(Intercept)	-2141.67	1163.60	(-4568.90, 285.56)	-1.84	0.081
sex (male)	872.99	1611.33	(-2488.18, 4234.17)	0.54	0.594
age	130.40	30.00	(67.82, 192.98)	4.35	< .001
sex (male) × age	-18.42	41.76	(-105.52, 68.68)	-0.44	0.664

So we can do confidence intervals, hypothesis tests, and p-values exactly as in the one-variable case we looked at previously.

5.2.3 Wald tests and confidence intervals

For Gaussian linear regression, the ordinary least squares (OLS) estimates $\hat{\beta}_k$ are exactly Gaussian when the error terms ϵ_i are Gaussian, for any sample size. See also the table of Gaussian vs. MLE-based tests[19].

[19] https://morrison-lab.github.io/sds/intro-MLEs.html#tbl-gaussian-vs-mle-tests

Wald test statistic

To test $H_0 : \beta_k = \beta_{k,0}$ (typically $\beta_{k,0} = 0$):

$$t_k = \frac{\hat{\beta}_k - \beta_{k,0}}{\widehat{SE}(\hat{\beta}_k)}$$

Under H_0, $t_k \sim t_{n-p}$ exactly when errors are Gaussian.

Confidence intervals for regression coefficients

A 95% confidence interval for β_k is:

$$\hat{\beta}_k \pm t_{n-p}(0.975) \cdot \widehat{SE}(\hat{\beta}_k)$$

In R

In R, `parameters()` from the `parameters` package automatically computes Wald tests and confidence intervals for linear regression model coefficients:

```
bw_lm2 |>
  parameters() |>
  print_md(
    include_reference = TRUE
  )
```

Table 37: Wald tests and 95% CIs for `birthweight` linear regression

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(20)	p
(Intercept)	-2141.67	1163.60	(-4568.90, 285.56)	-1.84	0.081
sex (female)	0.00				
sex (male)	872.99	1611.33	(-2488.18, 4234.17)	0.54	0.594
age	130.40	30.00	(67.82, 192.98)	4.35	< .001
sex (male) × age	-18.42	41.76	(-105.52, 68.68)	-0.44	0.664

To understand what's happening, let's replicate these results by hand for the interaction term.

P-values

```
bw_lm2 |>
  parameters(keep = "sexmale:age") |>
  print_md(
    include_reference = TRUE
  )
```

Parameter	Coefficient	SE	95% CI	t(20)	p
sex (male) × age	-18.42	41.76	(-105.52, 68.68)	-0.44	0.664

```
beta_hat <- coef(summary(bw_lm2))["sexmale:age", "Estimate"]
se_hat <- coef(summary(bw_lm2))["sexmale:age", "Std. Error"]
dfresid <- bw_lm2$df.residual
t_stat <- abs(beta_hat) / se_hat
pval_t <-
  pt(-t_stat, df = dfresid, lower.tail = TRUE) +
  pt(t_stat, df = dfresid, lower.tail = FALSE)
```

$$
\begin{aligned}
&P\left(|\hat{\beta}_{AM}| > |-18.417241| \middle| H_0\right) \\
&= \Pr\left(\left|\frac{\hat{\beta}_{AM}}{\widehat{SE}(\hat{\beta}_{AM})}\right| > \left|\frac{-18.417241}{41.755817}\right| \middle| H_0\right) \\
&= \Pr(|T_{20}| > 0.44107 | H_0) \\
&= 0.663893
\end{aligned}
$$

This manual calculation matches the result in Table 37.

Confidence intervals

```
q_t_upper <- qt(
  p = 0.975,
  df = dfresid,
  lower.tail = TRUE
)

q_t_lower <- qt(
  p = 0.025,
  df = dfresid,
  lower.tail = TRUE
)

confint_radius_t <-
  se_hat * q_t_upper

confint_t <- beta_hat + c(-1, 1) * confint_radius_t

print(confint_t)
#> [1] -105.5184   68.6839
```

This calculated confidence interval also matches.

Gaussian approximations

For large samples, the t-distribution is well-approximated by the standard Gaussian:

```
pval_z <- pnorm(abs(t_stat), lower.tail = FALSE) * 2

print(pval_z)
#> [1] 0.659162
```

```
confint_radius_z <- se_hat * qnorm(0.975, lower.tail = TRUE)
confint_z <-
  beta_hat + c(-1, 1) * confint_radius_z
print(confint_z)
#> [1] -100.2571   63.4227
```

5.2.4 Statistical significance versus practical importance

A small p-value says that an estimated slope is distinguishable from zero. It does not say that the slope is large enough to matter. With enough data, the standard error of $\hat{\beta}_1$ shrinks toward zero, so even a tiny true slope becomes statistically significant.

Exm

Example 5.2 (A statistically significant but negligible slope)**.** We simulate $n = 10^6$ observations with

$$X_i \sim \mathrm{N}(0, 1)$$
$$Y_i \mid X_i \sim \mathrm{N}(0.01\, X_i,\ 1),$$

so the true slope is $\beta_1 = 0.01$: a one-unit increase in X, which is one standard deviation of X, changes the mean of Y by 0.01 standard deviations of Y's noise.

```
set.seed(571)
n_sim <- 1e6
beta1_true <- 0.01
x_sim <- rnorm(n_sim)
y_sim <- rnorm(n_sim, mean = beta1_true * x_sim, sd = 1)
lm_tiny <- lm(y_sim ~ x_sim)
tiny_coef <- summary(lm_tiny)$coefficients["x_sim", ]
tiny_ci <- confint(lm_tiny)["x_sim", ]
tiny_r2 <- summary(lm_tiny)$r.squared
```

The estimated slope is 0.011 (standard error 0.001), with a 95% confidence interval of (0.00906, 0.013) and $p =$ <2e-16. The test of $H_0 : \beta_1 = 0$ is rejected, yet the model explains 0.012% of the variance of Y. The confidence interval tells the same story: it excludes zero, and every value in it is tiny.

Remark 5.1 (Significance is not importance). Statistical significance depends on the sample size as well as on the size of the effect. When we report a slope, we should report the estimate and its confidence interval, and judge whether the values in the interval are large enough to matter in the scientific setting, not only whether the interval excludes zero. With $n = 10^4$ in place of $n = 10^6$, the standard error of the same slope would be about 0.01, so the same true slope would usually not be significant at all.

5.3 Inference for predicted means

Exercise 5.1. Given a maximum likelihood estimate $\hat{\tilde{\beta}}$ and a corresponding estimated covariance matrix $\hat{\Sigma} \overset{\text{def}}{=} \widehat{\mathrm{Cov}}(\hat{\tilde{\beta}})$, calculate a 95% confidence interval for the predicted mean $\mu(\tilde{x}) = \mathrm{E}\left[Y | \tilde{X} = \tilde{x}\right]$.

Solution

Solution 5.1.
By the Gauss-Markov theorem[a], the OLS estimate $\hat{\tilde{\beta}}$ is the best linear unbiased estimator of $\tilde{\beta}$. A 95% confidence interval for $\mu(\tilde{x})$ can be constructed directly on the original scale:

$$\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}) \pm t_{n-p}(0.975) \cdot \widehat{\mathrm{SE}}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}))$$

where $\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}) = \tilde{x}' \hat{\tilde{\beta}}$.
Unlike in logistic regression, no transformation is needed; the confidence interval is constructed directly on the mean scale.

$$\mu(\tilde{x}) \in \left(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}) \pm t_{n-p}(0.975) \cdot \widehat{\mathrm{SE}}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}))\right)$$

[a] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gauss%E2%80%93Markov_theorem

---

Exercise 5.2.
How can we estimate the standard error of $\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x})$?

$$\widehat{\text{SE}}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x})) = ?$$

Solution

Solution 5.2.

$$\text{SE}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x})) = \sqrt{\text{Var}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}))} \tag{32}$$

By the definition $\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}) = \tilde{x}'\hat{\tilde{\beta}}$ and the variance of a linear combination[a]:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Var}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x})) &= \text{Var}\left(\tilde{x}'\hat{\tilde{\beta}}\right) \\ &= \tilde{x}' \,\text{Cov}\left(\hat{\tilde{\beta}}\right)\tilde{x} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \Sigma \tilde{x} \end{aligned} \tag{33}$$

where $\Sigma \overset{\text{def}}{=} \text{Cov}(\hat{\tilde{\beta}})$.

Expanding Equation 33 out of matrix-vector notation, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x}^\top \Sigma \tilde{x} &= \sum_{i=1}^{p}\sum_{j=1}^{p} x_i \Sigma_{ij} x_j \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{p}\sum_{j=1}^{p} x_i \,\text{Cov}(\hat{\tilde{\beta}}_i, \hat{\tilde{\beta}}_j) x_j \end{aligned}$$

Combining Equation 33 and the Gauss-Markov theorem:

Lem

Theorem 5.1 (Estimated variance and standard error of predicted mean).

$$\widehat{\text{Var}}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x})) = \tilde{x}^\top \hat{\Sigma} \tilde{x} \tag{34}$$

$$\widehat{\text{SE}}(\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x})) = \sqrt{\tilde{x}^\top \hat{\Sigma} \tilde{x}} \tag{35}$$

Note: on the RHS, we have plugged in $\hat{\Sigma}$, our estimate of Σ.

[a] https://morrison-lab.github.io/pds/variance-covariance.html#thm-var-lincom

---

In R

In R, `predict()` with `se.fit = TRUE` computes the estimated mean $\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}) = \tilde{x}'\hat{\tilde{\beta}}$ and its estimated standard error for each covariate pattern:

```
library(dplyr)
new_data <- tibble(
  age = c(36, 38, 40),
  sex = "male"
)

pred_mean <-
  bw_lm2 |>
  predict(
```

```
    newdata = new_data,
    se.fit = TRUE
  )

new_data |>
  mutate(
    mu_hat = pred_mean$fit,
    se = pred_mean$se.fit,
    ci_lower = mu_hat - qt(0.975, df = bw_lm2$df.residual) * se,
    ci_upper = mu_hat + qt(0.975, df = bw_lm2$df.residual) * se
  ) |>
  knitr::kable(digits = 3)
```

Table 38: Predicted means and 95% CI for `birthweight` linear regression

age	sex	mu_hat	se	ci_lower	ci_upper
36	male	2762.71	85.508	2584.34	2941.07
38	male	2986.67	53.030	2876.05	3097.29
40	male	3210.64	71.147	3062.23	3359.05

Alternatively, `predict()` with `interval = "confidence"` gives the same result:

```
bw_lm2 |>
  predict(
    newdata = new_data,
    interval = "confidence"
  ) |>
  cbind(new_data) |>
  knitr::kable(digits = 3)
```

Table 39: Predicted means and 95% CI using `interval = 'confidence'`

fit	lwr	upr	age	sex
2762.71	2584.34	2941.07	36	male
2986.67	2876.05	3097.29	38	male
3210.64	3062.23	3359.05	40	male

```r
library(sjPlot)
bw_lm2 |>
  plot_model(type = "pred", terms = c("age", "sex"), show.data = TRUE) +
  theme_sjplot() +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom")
```



Figure 46: Predicted values and confidence bands for the `birthweight` model with interaction term

5.3.1 Why are confidence bands narrower near the center of the data?

The confidence bands in Figure 46 are visibly narrower near the center of the gestational age range. To understand why, consider a simple linear regression with one predictor a (gestational age) and an intercept. The covariate vector for a new observation at age a is $\tilde{x} = (1, a)^\top$, and the general variance formula for the predicted mean specializes to:

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{Var}(\hat{\mu}(a)) &= \sigma^2 \, \tilde{x}^\top (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \tilde{x} \\ &= \sigma^2 \left(\frac{1}{n} + \frac{(a - \bar{a})^2}{S_{AA}} \right) \end{aligned} \tag{36}$$

where $\bar{a} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i$ is the mean gestational age and $S_{AA} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} (a_i - \bar{a})^2$ is the total variation in gestational age.

To derive Equation 36, first note that for n observations with design matrix rows $(1, a_i)$:

$$\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} = \begin{pmatrix} n & n\bar{a} \\ n\bar{a} & \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

The determinant of $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is:

$$\begin{aligned} \det(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}) &= n \cdot \sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i^2 - (n\bar{a})^2 \\ &= n \left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} a_i^2 - n\bar{a}^2 \right) \\ &= n \, S_{AA} \end{aligned}$$

so its inverse is:

$$(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} = \frac{1}{n\, S_{AA}} \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{i=1}^n a_i^2 & -n\bar{a} \\ -n\bar{a} & n \end{pmatrix}$$

Substituting $\tilde{x} = (1, a)^\top$ into the quadratic form:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x}^\top (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \tilde{x} &= \frac{1}{n\, S_{AA}} (1,\ a) \begin{pmatrix} \sum_{i=1}^n a_i^2 & -n\bar{a} \\ -n\bar{a} & n \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ a \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n a_i^2 - 2n\bar{a}\, a + n\, a^2}{n\, S_{AA}} \\ &= \frac{\left(\sum_{i=1}^n a_i^2 - n\bar{a}^2\right) + n(a - \bar{a})^2}{n\, S_{AA}} \\ &= \frac{S_{AA} + n(a - \bar{a})^2}{n\, S_{AA}} \\ &= \frac{1}{n} + \frac{(a - \bar{a})^2}{S_{AA}} \end{aligned}$$

Therefore the estimated standard error of the predicted mean at age a is:

$$\widehat{\mathrm{SE}}(\hat{\mu}(a)) = \hat{\sigma} \sqrt{\frac{1}{n} + \frac{(a - \bar{a})^2}{S_{AA}}} \tag{37}$$

Since $(a - \bar{a})^2 \geq 0$ and equals zero when $a = \bar{a}$, the standard error is minimized at the mean gestational age $\bar{a}$ and increases as a moves away from $\bar{a}$ in either direction. Consequently, confidence intervals are narrowest at $\bar{a}$ and widen toward the extremes of the gestational age range.

Intuitively, the fitted line is "anchored" at the center of the data: in simple linear regression with an intercept, the OLS fitted line passes exactly through the sample mean point $(\bar{a}, \bar{y})$, so the estimated mean at $\bar{a}$ is relatively stable across different samples. Moving away from $\bar{a}$, small changes in the estimated slope cause the fitted line to "pivot" around that anchor, producing larger changes in the predicted mean the further a is from $\bar{a}$.

Additionally, there is typically more nearby data near the center of the covariate range, so we have more information about the true mean response there. Near the edges of the covariate range, there is less nearby data, leaving us less confident in our estimate of the mean response at those values.

5.4 Inference for differences in means

Exercise 5.3. Given a maximum likelihood estimate $\hat{\tilde{\beta}}$ and a corresponding estimated covariance matrix $\hat{\Sigma} \overset{\text{def}}{=} \widehat{\mathrm{Cov}}(\hat{\tilde{\beta}})$, calculate a 95% confidence interval for the difference in means comparing covariate patterns $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{x}^*$:

$$\Delta\mu \overset{\text{def}}{=} \mu(\tilde{x}) - \mu(\tilde{x}^*)$$

Solution

Solution 5.3.
We can construct the confidence interval directly:

$$\Delta\mu \in \widehat{\Delta\mu} \pm t_{n-p}(0.975) \cdot \widehat{\mathrm{SE}}\left(\widehat{\Delta\mu}\right)$$

Exercise 5.4. Express the difference in means $\Delta\mu \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \mu(\tilde{x}) - \mu(\tilde{x}^*)$ as a linear function of $\tilde{\beta}$.

Solution

Solution 5.4.

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta\mu &= \mu(\tilde{x}) - \mu(\tilde{x}^*) \\ &= \tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{\beta} - (\tilde{x}^*) \cdot \tilde{\beta} \\ &= (\tilde{x} - \tilde{x}^*) \cdot \tilde{\beta} \\ &= \Delta\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{\beta} \end{aligned} \tag{38}$$

where $\Delta\tilde{x} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \tilde{x} - \tilde{x}^*$.

Exercise 5.5.
How can we estimate the standard error of $\widehat{\Delta\mu}$?

$$\widehat{\mathrm{SE}}\left(\widehat{\Delta\mu}\right) = ?$$

Solution

Solution 5.5.

$$\mathrm{SE}\left(\widehat{\Delta\mu}\right) = \sqrt{\mathrm{Var}\left(\widehat{\Delta\mu}\right)} \tag{39}$$

By Solution 5.4 and the variance of a linear combination[a]:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Var}\left(\widehat{\Delta\mu}\right) &= \mathrm{Var}\left(\Delta\tilde{x} \cdot \hat{\tilde{\beta}}\right) \\ &= (\Delta\tilde{x})^\top \mathrm{Cov}\left(\hat{\tilde{\beta}}\right)(\Delta\tilde{x}) \\ &= (\Delta\tilde{x})^\top \Sigma (\Delta\tilde{x}) \end{aligned} \tag{40}$$

where $\Sigma \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \mathrm{Cov}(\hat{\tilde{\beta}})$.

Expanding Equation 40 out of matrix-vector notation, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} (\Delta\tilde{x})^\top \Sigma (\Delta\tilde{x}) &= \sum_{i=1}^{p}\sum_{j=1}^{p} (\Delta\tilde{x})_i \Sigma_{ij} (\Delta\tilde{x})_j \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{p}\sum_{j=1}^{p} (\Delta x_i) \Sigma_{ij} (\Delta x_j) \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{p}\sum_{j=1}^{p} (x_i - x_i^*)\, \mathrm{Cov}(\hat{\tilde{\beta}}_i, \hat{\tilde{\beta}}_j)(x_j - x_j^*) \end{aligned}$$

Combining Equation 40 and the Gauss-Markov theorem:

Lem

Theorem 5.2 (Estimated variance and standard error of difference in means).

$$\widehat{\mathrm{Var}}\left(\widehat{\Delta\mu}\right) = \Delta\tilde{x}^\top \hat{\Sigma} (\Delta\tilde{x}) \tag{41}$$

$$\widehat{\mathrm{SE}}\left(\widehat{\Delta\mu}\right) = \sqrt{\Delta\tilde{x}^\top \hat{\Sigma}(\Delta\tilde{x})} \tag{42}$$

Note: on the RHS, we have plugged in $\hat{\Sigma}$, our estimate of Σ.
Compare this result with the formula for inference for predicted means: the only change is to replace $\tilde{x}$ with $\Delta\tilde{x} = \tilde{x} - \tilde{x}^*$.

[a] https://morrison-lab.github.io/pds/variance-covariance.html#thm-var-lincom

---

In R, we can compute the CI for the difference in means by computing the predicted means for both covariate patterns and applying the variance formula directly:

```
library(dplyr)
new_data_pair <- tibble(
  sex = factor(c("female", "male"), levels = levels(bw$sex)),
  age = c(40, 40)
)

pred_pair <-
  bw_lm2 |>
  predict(
    newdata = new_data_pair,
    se.fit = TRUE
  )

design_mat <- model.matrix(delete.response(terms(bw_lm2)), new_data_pair)
delta_x <- design_mat[2, ] - design_mat[1, ]

sigma_hat <- vcov(bw_lm2)

diff_mean_hat <- diff(pred_pair$fit)
se_diff <- sqrt(t(delta_x) %*% sigma_hat %*% delta_x)
t_crit <- qt(0.975, df = bw_lm2$df.residual)

tibble(
  diff_mean = diff_mean_hat,
  se = as.numeric(se_diff),
  ci_lower = diff_mean_hat - t_crit * se,
  ci_upper = diff_mean_hat + t_crit * se
) |>
  knitr::kable(digits = 3)
```

Table 40: 95% CI for difference in birthweight means (male vs. female)

diff_mean	se	ci_lower	ci_upper
136.305	95.846	-63.626	336.236

5.5 Prediction

We can also construct **prediction intervals** for the value of a new observation Y^*, given a covariate pattern $\tilde{x}^*$.

A new observation Y^* at $\tilde{x}^*$ follows the same linear model as the training data:

$$Y^* = (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \tilde{\beta} + \varepsilon^*$$

where $\varepsilon^* \sim \mathrm{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ is independent of the training data (and therefore independent of $\hat{\beta}$).

The predicted value of Y^* is:

$$\hat{Y}^* \overset{\text{def}}{=} \hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}^*) = (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \hat{\beta}$$

We base the prediction interval on the **prediction error** $Y^* - \hat{Y}^*$:

$$\begin{aligned} Y^* - \hat{Y}^* &= (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \tilde{\beta} + \varepsilon^* - (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \hat{\beta} \\ &= \varepsilon^* - (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\hat{\beta} - \tilde{\beta}) \end{aligned}$$

Assuming the model is correctly specified, the predictions will be unbiased:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{E}\left[Y^* - \hat{Y}^*\right] &= \mathrm{E}[\varepsilon^*] - (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \mathrm{E}\left[\hat{\beta} - \tilde{\beta}\right] \\ &= 0 - (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \cdot 0 \\ &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

The variance of the prediction error is:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Var}\left(Y^* - \hat{Y}^*\right) &= \mathrm{Var}\left(\varepsilon^* - (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\hat{\beta} - \tilde{\beta})\right) \\ &= \mathrm{Var}(\varepsilon^*) + \mathrm{Var}\left((\tilde{x}^*)^\top \hat{\beta}\right) \quad (\text{since } \varepsilon^* \perp\!\!\!\perp \hat{\beta}) \\ &= \sigma^2 + (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \mathrm{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}\right) \tilde{x}^* \\ &= \sigma^2 + (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\sigma^2 (\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1}) \tilde{x}^* \\ &= \sigma^2 + \sigma^2 (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1} \tilde{x}^* \\ &= \sigma^2 \left(1 + (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1} \tilde{x}^*\right) \end{aligned} \tag{43}$$

See Hogg et al. (2015) §7.6 (p. 340).

The variance (Equation 43) has two components:

- $\mathrm{Var}(\varepsilon^*) = \sigma^2$: the variance of the future observation's own noise, which is irreducible.
- $\mathrm{Var}\left(\tilde{x}^* \cdot \hat{\beta}\right) = (\tilde{x}^*)^\top \mathrm{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}\right) \tilde{x}^*$: the variance due to estimating the mean $\tilde{x}^* \cdot \tilde{\beta}$ from the data.

The first component is not present in the confidence interval for $\hat{\mu}(\tilde{x}^*)$, which only accounts for estimation uncertainty. This extra variance component is why prediction intervals are always wider than the corresponding confidence intervals: a prediction interval must additionally account for the irreducible noise ε^* in a new observation.

The **standard error** of the prediction error is the square root of its variance:

$$\mathrm{SE}\left(Y^* - \hat{Y}^*\right) = \sqrt{\mathrm{Var}\left(Y^* - \hat{Y}^*\right)} = \sigma \sqrt{1 + (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1} \tilde{x}^*}$$

Replacing σ with the residual standard error $\hat{\sigma}$ gives the estimated standard error:

$$\widehat{\mathrm{SE}}\left(Y^* - \hat{Y}^*\right) = \hat{\sigma} \sqrt{1 + (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1} \tilde{x}^*} \tag{44}$$

Since $\varepsilon^* \sim \mathrm{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ and $\hat{\beta} \sim \mathrm{N}\left(\tilde{\beta}, \sigma^2 (\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1}\right)$ are both normally distributed, and since $\varepsilon^* \perp\!\!\!\perp \hat{\beta}$ (by independence of the new error term and parameter estimates), their difference $Y^* - \hat{Y}^* = \varepsilon^* - (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\hat{\beta} - \tilde{\beta})$ is also normally distributed, with mean 0 and variance given by Equation 43. Standardizing by dividing by $\sigma \sqrt{1 + (\tilde{x}^*)^\top (\mathbf{X}'\mathbf{X})^{-1} \tilde{x}^*}$ yields a standard normal random variable.

Replacing σ with $\hat{\sigma}$, which is estimated with $n-p$ degrees of freedom and is independent of $Y^* - \hat{Y}^*$, the standardized prediction error follows a t distribution:

$$\frac{Y^* - \hat{Y}^*}{\widehat{\text{SE}}\left(Y^* - \hat{Y}^*\right)} \sim t_{n-p}$$

Therefore, a $(1-\alpha)$ **prediction interval** for Y^* is:

$$Y^* \in \left(\hat{Y}^* \pm t_{n-p}\left(1 - \frac{\alpha}{2}\right) \cdot \widehat{\text{SE}}\left(Y^* - \hat{Y}^*\right)\right) \tag{45}$$

```
x <- tibble(age = 40, sex = "male")
bw_lm2 |>
  predict(newdata = x, interval = "predict")
#>       fit     lwr     upr
#> 1 3210.64 2805.71 3615.57
```

If you don't specify `newdata`, you get a warning:

```
bw_lm2 |>
  predict(interval = "predict") |>
  head()
#> Warning in predict.lm(bw_lm2, interval = "predict"): predictions on current data refer to _future
#>       fit     lwr     upr
#> 1 2552.73 2124.50 2980.97
#> 2 2552.73 2124.50 2980.97
#> 3 2683.13 2275.99 3090.27
#> 4 2813.53 2418.60 3208.47
#> 5 2813.53 2418.60 3208.47
#> 6 2943.93 2551.48 3336.38
```

The warning from the last command is: "predictions on current data refer to *future* responses" (since you already know what happened to the current data, and thus don't need to predict it).

See `?predict.lm` for more.

```
plot_PIs_and_CIs(bw, bw_lm2)
```

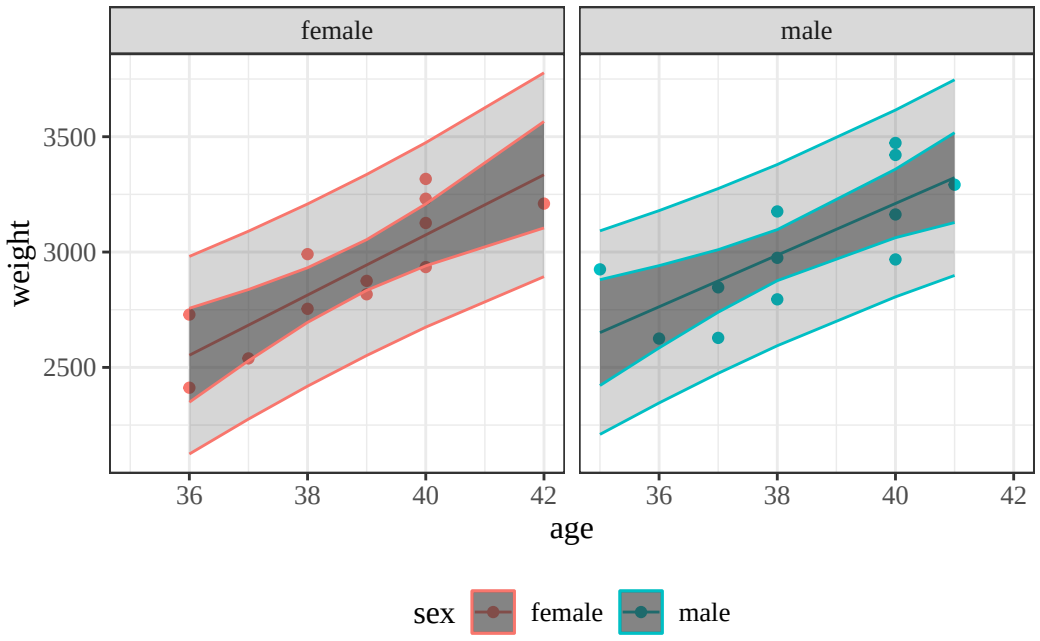


Figure 47: Confidence and prediction intervals for `birthweight` model 2

---

6 Multiple linear regression: the HERS study

The `birthweight` example carried a single continuous predictor (gestational age) alongside a binary group (sex), so every fitted model was a line — or a pair of lines — in a plane.

To see how the same ideas extend to **several continuous predictors at once**, we now work through a larger example: data from the Heart and Estrogen/Progestin Replacement Study (HERS).

We reuse the sequence of ideas developed on `birthweight` — parallel slopes, interactions, and stratification — but now with two continuous predictors (age and BMI), so the fitted models are surfaces in three dimensions rather than lines in a plane; the figures in the following subsections are interactive plots you can rotate. We then assess and compare these models with the goodness-of-fit, diagnostic, and model-selection tools from Section 4.

6.1 The `hers` data

> **Note**
>
> This section is based on (Vittinghoff et al. 2012, chap. 4).

The "heart and estrogen/progestin study" (HERS) was a clinical trial of hormone therapy for prevention of recurrent heart attacks and death among 2,763 post-menopausal women with existing coronary heart disease (CHD) (Hulley et al. 1998).

The trial was conducted at 20 US clinical centers. Participants were randomized to receive either conjugated equine estrogens (0.625 mg/day) plus medroxyprogesterone acetate (2.5 mg/day) or a matching placebo (Hulley et al. 1998). Women were followed for an average of 4.1 years (Hulley et al. 1998).

The primary outcome was nonfatal myocardial infarction or CHD death (Hulley et al. 1998).

Table 41: `hers` data

```
hers |> head()
#> # A tibble: 6 x 37
#>   HT              age raceth  nonwhite smoking drinkany exercise physact globrat
#>   <fct>         <dbl> <dbl+l> <dbl+lb> <dbl+l> <dbl+lb> <dbl+lb> <dbl+l> <dbl+l>
#> 1 placebo          70 2 [Afr~ 1 [yes]  0 [no]  0 [no]   0 [no]   5 [muc~ 3 [goo~
#> 2 placebo          62 2 [Afr~ 1 [yes]  0 [no]  0 [no]   0 [no]   1 [muc~ 3 [goo~
#> 3 hormone ther~    69 1 [Whi~ 0 [no]   0 [no]  0 [no]   0 [no]   3 [abo~ 3 [goo~
#> 4 placebo          64 1 [Whi~ 0 [no]   1 [yes] 1 [yes]  0 [no]   1 [muc~ 3 [goo~
#> 5 placebo          65 1 [Whi~ 0 [no]   0 [no]  0 [no]   0 [no]   2 [som~ 3 [goo~
#> 6 hormone ther~    68 2 [Afr~ 1 [yes]  0 [no]  1 [yes]  0 [no]   3 [abo~ 3 [goo~
#> # i 28 more variables: poorfair <dbl+lbl>, medcond <dbl>, htnmeds <dbl+lbl>,
#> #   statins <fct>, diabetes <dbl+lbl>, dmpills <dbl+lbl>, insulin <dbl+lbl>,
#> #   weight <dbl>, BMI <dbl>, waist <dbl>, WHR <dbl>, glucose <dbl>,
#> #   weight1 <dbl>, BMI1 <dbl>, waist1 <dbl>, WHR1 <dbl>, glucose1 <dbl>,
#> #   tchol <dbl>, LDL <dbl>, HDL <dbl>, TG <dbl>, tchol1 <dbl>, LDL1 <dbl>,
#> #   HDL1 <dbl>, TG1 <dbl>, SBP <dbl>, DBP <dbl>, age10 <dbl>
```

```
library(haven)
hers <- haven::read_dta(
  paste0(
    "https://regression.ucsf.edu/sites/g/files",
    "/tkssra6706/f/wysiwyg/home/data/hersdata.dta"
  )
)
```

6.1.1 Data as table

6.1.2 Data as graph

```
hers_scatter_data <- hers |>
  dplyr::filter(!is.na(age), !is.na(BMI), !is.na(LDL), !is.na(statins))
hers_scatter_no <- hers_scatter_data |> dplyr::filter(statins == "no")
hers_scatter_yes <- hers_scatter_data |> dplyr::filter(statins == "yes")

hers_scatter_axes <- list(
  xaxis = list(title = "Age (yr)"),
  yaxis = list(title = "BMI (kg/m²)"),
  zaxis = list(title = "LDL (mg/dL)")
)

plotly::plot_ly() |>
  plotly::add_trace(
    data = hers_scatter_no,
    x = ~age, y = ~BMI, z = ~LDL,
    type = "scatter3d", mode = "markers",
    name = "No statins", scene = "scene",
    marker = list(size = 3, opacity = 0.5, color = "steelblue")
  ) |>
  plotly::add_trace(
    data = hers_scatter_yes,
    x = ~age, y = ~BMI, z = ~LDL,
    type = "scatter3d", mode = "markers",
    name = "Yes statins", scene = "scene2",
    marker = list(size = 3, opacity = 0.5, color = "darkorange")
  ) |>
  plotly::layout(
    annotations = list(
      list(
        text = "No statins", x = 0.22, y = 0.95,
        xref = "paper", yref = "paper", showarrow = FALSE
      ),
      list(
        text = "Yes statins", x = 0.78, y = 0.95,
        xref = "paper", yref = "paper", showarrow = FALSE
      )
    ),
    scene = c(
      hers_scatter_axes,
      list(domain = list(x = c(0, 0.48), y = c(0, 1)))
    ),
    scene2 = c(
      hers_scatter_axes,
      list(domain = list(x = c(0.52, 1), y = c(0, 1)))
    )
  )
```

6.1.3 Key variables

```
library(GGally)
hers |>
  dplyr::select(LDL, HT, BMI, statins, age) |>
  ggpairs(
    mapping = aes(col = statins),
    lower = list(continuous = GGally::wrap("points", alpha = 0.3)),
    columnLabels = c(
      "LDL (mg/dL)",
      "HT",
      "BMI (kg/m²)",
      "Statins",
      "Age (yr)"
    )
  ) +
  theme_bw() +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom")
```

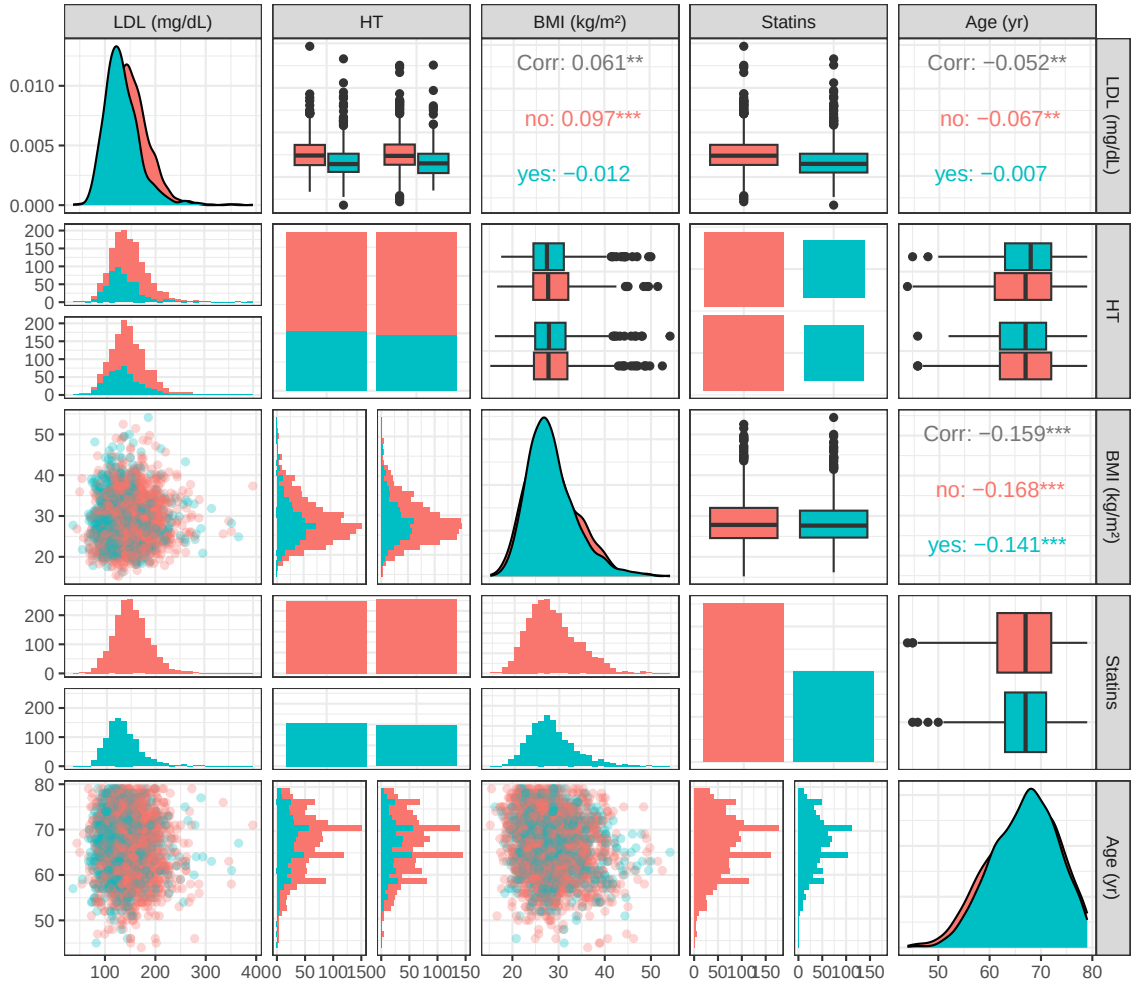


Figure 49: Key variables in `hers` data: outcome (LDL), treatment (HT), and covariates (BMI, statins, age)

6.1.4 Data notation

Let's define some notation to represent this data:

- Y: LDL cholesterol (mg/dL)

- A: age (years)
- B: BMI (kg/m^2)
- T: hormone therapy treatment assignment ("placebo" or "hormone therapy")
- H: indicator variable for T = "hormone therapy"
  - $H = 0$ if T = "placebo"
  - $H = 1$ if T = "hormone therapy"
- U: statin use ("no" or "yes")
- V: indicator variable for U = "yes"
  - $V = 0$ if U = "no"
  - $V = 1$ if U = "yes"

"Placebo" is the **reference level** for the categorical variable T, and "no" is the **reference level** for statin use U. The choice of reference level is arbitrary; it only affects the interpretation of the intercept and corresponding indicator coefficients.

Since LDL is measured at **baseline** (before the hormone therapy was administered), H is not included as a predictor in our regression models for LDL. We instead focus on statin use U (and its indicator V) as the key grouping variable.

6.2 Parallel-planes model

Just as the birthweight parallel-lines model assumes that sex shifts the intercept but not the age slope (parallel lines in 2D), the parallel-planes model for the HERS data assumes a flat regression surface over the age-BMI space: the slope of mean LDL with respect to BMI is the same at every age, and the slope with respect to age is the same at every BMI.

We use age (A) and BMI (B) as predictors—not hormone therapy (H)—because LDL is measured at **baseline**, before treatment was administered.

$$\begin{aligned} Y|A,B &\sim_{\text{ciid}} N(\mu(A,B),\sigma^2) \\ \mu(a,b) &= \beta_0 + \beta_A a + \beta_B b \end{aligned} \tag{46}$$

```
hers_lm1 <- lm(
  formula = LDL ~ age + BMI,
  data = hers,
  na.action = na.exclude
)
hers_plot_data <- hers |>
  dplyr::filter(!is.na(age), !is.na(BMI), !is.na(LDL))

hers_lm1 |>
  parameters::parameters() |>
  parameters::print_md(
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 42: Regression parameter estimates for Model 46

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	151.44
age	-0.25
BMI	0.37

6.2.1 Statins: No

```
hers_no <- hers_plot_data |> dplyr::filter(statins == "no")

plotly::plot_ly(
  x = hers_no[["age"]],
  y = hers_no[["BMI"]],
  z = hers_no[["LDL"]],
  type = "scatter3d",
  mode = "markers",
  name = "No statins",
  marker = list(size = 3, opacity = 0.3, color = "steelblue")
) |>
  regress3d::add_3d_surface(
    model = hers_lm1,
    data = hers_plot_data,
    showlegend = TRUE
  ) |>
  plotly::layout(
    scene = list(
      xaxis = list(title = "Age (yr)"),
      yaxis = list(title = "BMI (kg/m\u00b2)"),
      zaxis = list(title = "LDL (mg/dL)")
    )
  )
```

6.2.2 Statins: Yes

```
hers_yes <- hers_plot_data |> dplyr::filter(statins == "yes")

plotly::plot_ly(
  x = hers_yes[["age"]],
  y = hers_yes[["BMI"]],
  z = hers_yes[["LDL"]],
  type = "scatter3d",
  mode = "markers",
  name = "Yes statins",
  marker = list(size = 3, opacity = 0.3, color = "darkorange")
) |>
  regress3d::add_3d_surface(
    model = hers_lm1,
    data = hers_plot_data,
    showlegend = TRUE
  ) |>
  plotly::layout(
    scene = list(
      xaxis = list(title = "Age (yr)"),
      yaxis = list(title = "BMI (kg/m\u00b2)"),
      zaxis = list(title = "LDL (mg/dL)")
    )
  )
```

The coefficient estimates in Table 42 quantify the shape of these surfaces. Both tabs display the same fitted flat plane: the parallel-planes model constrains the age and BMI slopes to be the same regardless of statin use. The statins-yes tab reveals that patients taking statins tend to have lower LDL values on average — a shift the parallel-planes model cannot capture, because it does not include statin use as a predictor.

6.3 Interaction model

In the parallel-planes model, the BMI slope is the same regardless of age. Just as we added a sex-age interaction to the birthweight model to allow the age slope to differ between males and females, we now add an age-BMI interaction to allow the BMI slope to vary with age.

$$\begin{aligned} Y|A,B &\sim_{\text{ciid}} N(\mu(A,B),\sigma^2) \\ \mu(a,b) &= \beta_0 + \beta_A a + \beta_B b + \beta_{AB}(a \cdot b) \end{aligned} \tag{47}$$

The slope of mean LDL with respect to BMI now depends on age:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial b}\mu(A=0,B=b) &= \beta_B + \beta_{AB}\cdot 0 = \beta_B \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial b}\mu(A=a,B=b) &= \beta_B + \beta_{AB}a \end{aligned}$$

So the slope of LDL with respect to BMI changes by β_{AB} for each one-year increase in age.

```
hers_lm2 <- lm(
  LDL ~ age + BMI + age:BMI,
  data = hers,
  na.action = na.exclude
)

hers_lm2 |>
  parameters::parameters() |>
  parameters::print_md(
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 43: Regression parameter estimates for Model 47

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	194.29
age	-0.90
BMI	-1.13
age × BMI	0.02

6.3.1 Statins: No

```
plotly::plot_ly(
  x = hers_no[["age"]],
  y = hers_no[["BMI"]],
  z = hers_no[["LDL"]],
  type = "scatter3d",
  mode = "markers",
  name = "No statins",
  marker = list(size = 3, opacity = 0.3, color = "steelblue")
) |>
  regress3d::add_3d_surface(
    model = hers_lm2,
    data = hers_plot_data,
    showlegend = TRUE
  ) |>
  plotly::layout(
    scene = list(
      xaxis = list(title = "Age (yr)"),
      yaxis = list(title = "BMI (kg/m\u00b2)"),
      zaxis = list(title = "LDL (mg/dL)")
    )
  )
```

6.3.2 Statins: Yes

```
plotly::plot_ly(
  x = hers_yes[["age"]],
  y = hers_yes[["BMI"]],
  z = hers_yes[["LDL"]],
  type = "scatter3d",
  mode = "markers",
  name = "Yes statins",
  marker = list(size = 3, opacity = 0.3, color = "darkorange")
) |>
  regress3d::add_3d_surface(
    model = hers_lm2,
    data = hers_plot_data,
    showlegend = TRUE
  ) |>
  plotly::layout(
    scene = list(
      xaxis = list(title = "Age (yr)"),
      yaxis = list(title = "BMI (kg/m\u00b2)"),
      zaxis = list(title = "LDL (mg/dL)")
    )
  )
```

Unlike the flat parallel-planes surface, the interaction model produces a twisted regression surface. The BMI slope changes with age: at any given age, the BMI slope equals the base BMI coefficient plus the interaction coefficient times that age. Both tabs plot the same interaction-model surface; statin use is used only to partition the observed data points for visual clarity.

6.4 Stratified model

Until now, statin use (U) has appeared only as the color grouping in our HERS plots; here it finally enters the model, as the stratifying variable.

As an alternative to the age–BMI models fit previously, we can model LDL as a function of BMI, stratifying by statin use (i.e., fitting a separate intercept and BMI slope for each statin group). We omit age from this stratified specification to keep it simple and focus on how the BMI–LDL relationship differs by statin use; age could be added back as an additional covariate if desired.

$$\mathrm{E}[LDL|B = b, V = v] = \beta_{no}(1 - v) + \beta_{no,B}\, b(1 - v) + \beta_{yes} v + \beta_{yes,B}\, bv \tag{48}$$

Equivalently, we can fit the same model using reference (indicator) coding, with an overall intercept, a main effect for statin use, a BMI slope, and a statin–BMI interaction:

$$\mathrm{E}[LDL|B = b, V = v] = \beta_0 + \beta_V\, v + \beta_B\, b + \beta_{VB}\, (v \cdot b) \tag{49}$$

```
hers_lm_strat <-
  hers |>
  lm(
    formula = LDL ~ statins + statins:BMI - 1,
    data = _,
    na.action = na.exclude
  )

hers_lm_strat |>
  parameters::parameters() |>
  parameters::print_md(
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 44: Stratified regression estimates for `hers` data (Model 48)

Parameter	Coefficient
statins (no)	132.81
statins (yes)	136.69
statins (no) × BMI	0.64
statins (yes) × BMI	-0.08

```
hers_lm_statins_interact <- lm(
  LDL ~ statins + BMI + statins:BMI,
  data = hers,
  na.action = na.exclude
)

hers_lm_statins_interact |>
  parameters::parameters() |>
  parameters::print_md(
    select = "{estimate}"
  )
```

Table 45: Regression parameter estimates for Model 49

Parameter	Coefficient
(Intercept)	132.81
statins (yes)	3.87
BMI	0.64
statins (yes) × BMI	-0.72

6.5 Goodness of fit

We compare the parallel-planes model (`hers_lm1`: `LDL ~ age + BMI`) and the interaction model (`hers_lm2`: `LDL ~ age + BMI + age:BMI`) using AIC, BIC, and deviance. Lower AIC and BIC values indicate a better trade-off between fit and complexity; lower deviance indicates a better-fitting model (at the cost of more parameters).

6.5.1 AIC and BIC for `hers` models

```
aic <- AIC(hers_lm1, hers_lm2)
bic <- BIC(hers_lm1, hers_lm2)
data.frame(
  df  = aic$df,
  AIC = aic$AIC,
  BIC = bic$BIC,
  row.names = rownames(aic)
) |>
  knitr::kable()
```

Table 46: AIC and BIC for the `hers` parallel-planes (`hers_lm1`) and interaction (`hers_lm2`) models

	df	AIC	BIC
hers_lm1	4	27744.4	27768.0
hers_lm2	5	27745.0	27774.6

Both AIC and BIC are slightly lower for the parallel-planes model (Table 46): adding the age-BMI interaction does not improve either criterion, so both favor the simpler parallel-planes specification — BIC, which penalizes extra parameters more heavily, by the wider margin.

6.5.2 Deviance for `hers` models

```
data.frame(
  deviance = c(deviance(hers_lm1), deviance(hers_lm2)),
  row.names = c("hers_lm1", "hers_lm2")
) |>
  knitr::kable()
```

Table 47: Deviance for the `hers` parallel-planes (`hers_lm1`) and interaction (`hers_lm2`) models

	deviance
hers_lm1	3903361
hers_lm2	3901412

The interaction model has marginally lower deviance (Table 47) — as it must, since adding a parameter can only reduce the residual sum of squares — but the reduction is tiny relative to the total. The likelihood ratio test in Table 48 formally tests whether that improvement is larger than we would expect by chance from one extra parameter.

6.6 Diagnostics

6.6.1 Parallel-planes model

We check whether the assumptions of the parallel-planes model (`hers_lm1`, Equation 46, fitted in Table 42) hold by examining residuals vs. fitted values (to assess linearity and constant variance) and a QQ plot (to assess normality of residuals). Plots are faceted by statin use to check for group-level residual patterns.

Residuals vs fitted for `hers_lm1`

```
hers_diag <- hers_lm_data |>
  dplyr::mutate(
    .fitted = fitted(hers_lm1),
    .resid = residuals(hers_lm1)
  )

ggplot(hers_diag, aes(x = .fitted, y = .resid)) +
  geom_point(alpha = 0.3) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, linetype = "dashed") +
  facet_wrap(~statins, labeller = label_both) +
  xlab("Fitted values") +
  ylab("Residuals") +
  theme_bw()
```

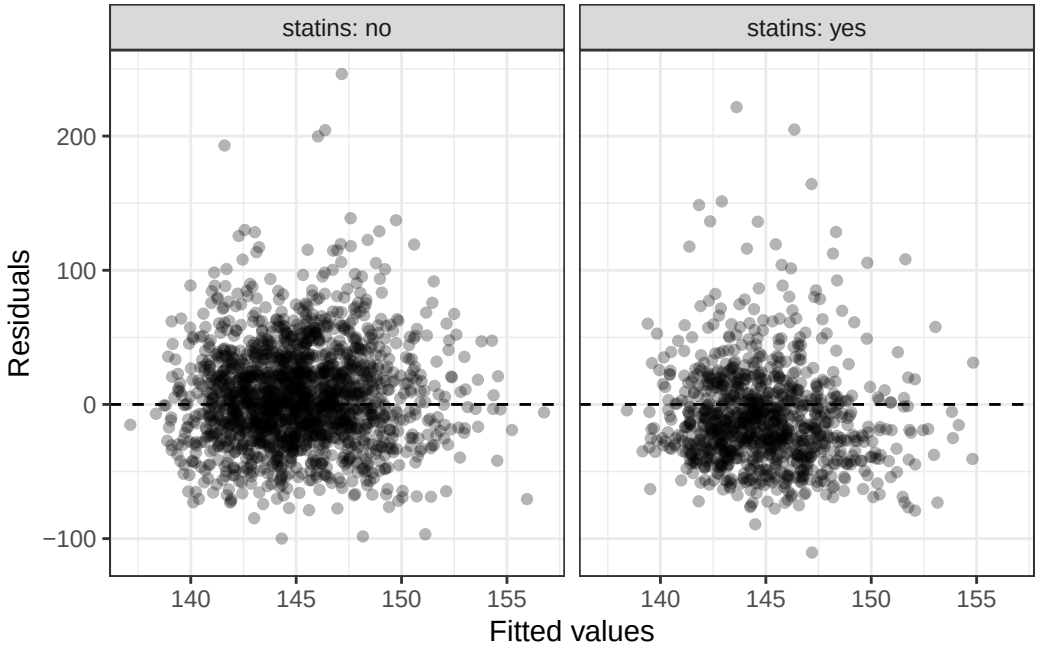


Figure 54: Residuals vs fitted values for `hers_lm1` (parallel planes model)

QQ plot for `hers_lm1`

```
ggplot(hers_diag, aes(sample = .resid)) +
  stat_qq() +
  stat_qq_line() +
  facet_wrap(~statins, labeller = label_both) +
  theme_bw()
```

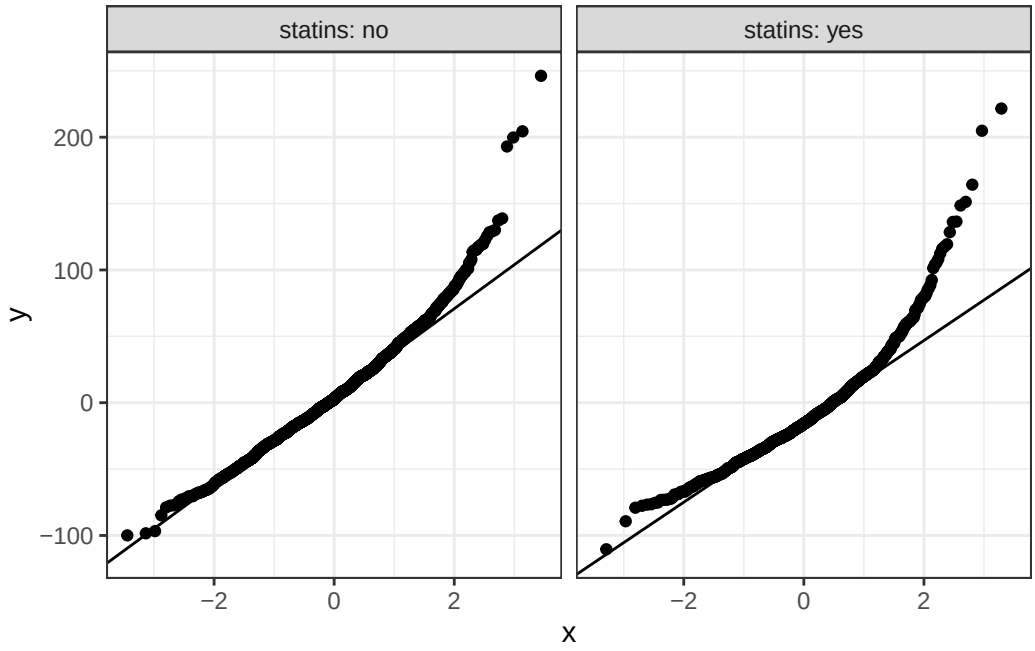


Figure 55: QQ plot of residuals for `hers_lm1` (parallel planes model)

The residuals scatter around zero with no clear curve (Figure 54), so the linearity assumption looks reasonable; their spread grows only slightly at higher fitted values, indicating at most mild non-constant variance. The QQ plot (Figure 55) bends above the reference line in the upper tail, reflecting the right skew of LDL — a mild departure from normality. With several thousand observations, the central limit theorem makes inference about the model coefficients robust to this mild non-normality. Both statin groups show the same pattern.

6.6.2 Interaction model

We repeat the same checks for the interaction model (`hers_lm2`, Equation 47, fitted in Table 43).

Residuals vs fitted for `hers_lm2`

```r
hers_diag2 <- hers_lm_data |>
  dplyr::mutate(
    .fitted = fitted(hers_lm2),
    .resid = residuals(hers_lm2)
  )

ggplot(hers_diag2, aes(x = .fitted, y = .resid)) +
  geom_point(alpha = 0.3) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = 0, linetype = "dashed") +
  facet_wrap(~statins, labeller = label_both) +
  xlab("Fitted values") +
  ylab("Residuals") +
  theme_bw()
```

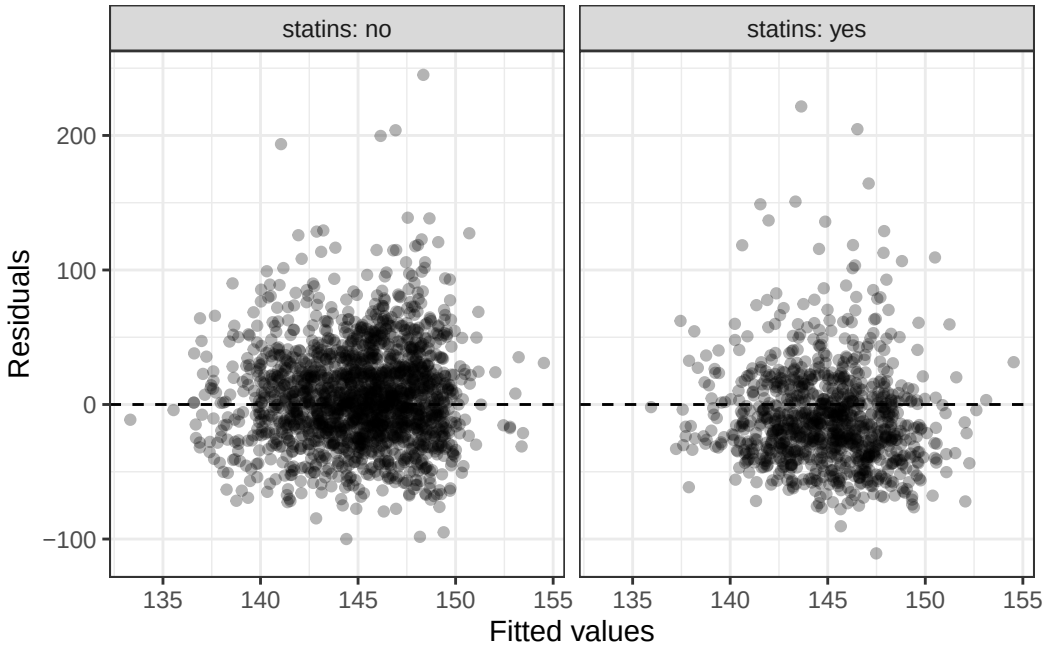


Figure 56: Residuals vs fitted values for `hers_lm2` (interaction model)

QQ plot for `hers_lm2`

Table 48: Likelihood ratio test comparing the `hers` parallel-planes (`hers_lm1`) and interaction (`hers_lm2`) models

```
hers_lrt <- lmtest::lrtest(hers_lm1, hers_lm2)
hers_lrt
#> # A tibble: 2 x 5
#>   `#Df`  LogLik    Df Chisq `Pr(>Chisq)`
#>   <dbl>   <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>        <dbl>
#> 1     4 -13868.    NA NA          NA
#> 2     5 -13867.     1  1.37        0.241
```

```
ggplot(hers_diag2, aes(sample = .resid)) +
  stat_qq() +
  stat_qq_line() +
  facet_wrap(~statins, labeller = label_both) +
  theme_bw()
```

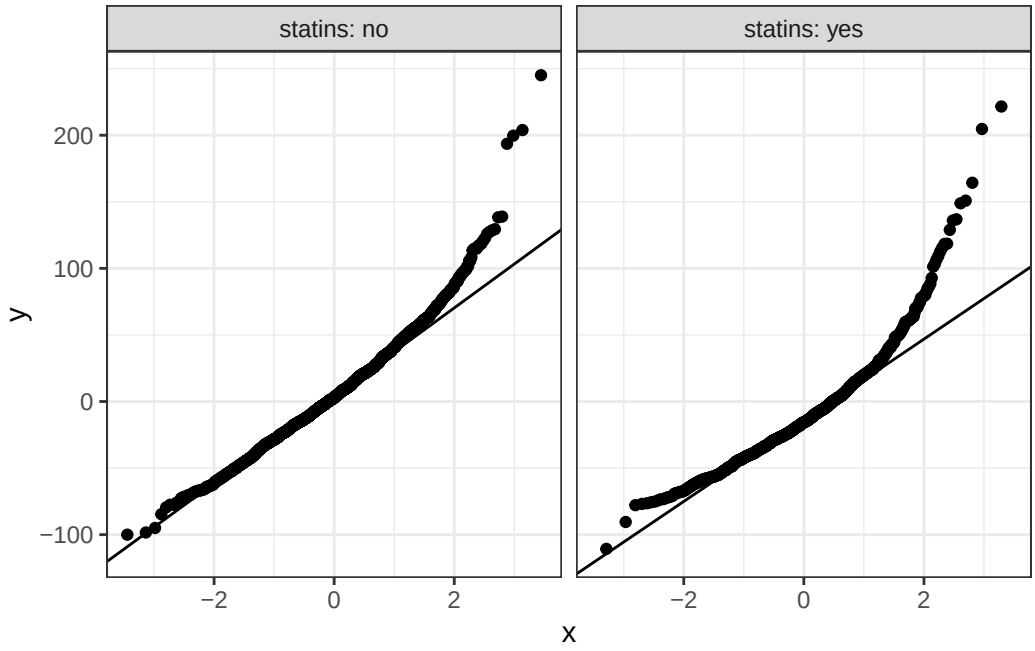


Figure 57: QQ plot of residuals for `hers_lm2` (interaction model)

The residual and QQ plots for the interaction model (Figure 56, Figure 57) look essentially identical to those for the parallel-planes model: adding the age-BMI interaction barely changes the residual structure. This similarity previews the model-selection result — the likelihood ratio test (Table 48) shows the interaction does not improve the fit enough to justify the extra parameter.

6.7 Model selection

We compare the parallel-planes model (`hers_lm1`: `LDL ~ age + BMI`) and the interaction model (`hers_lm2`: `LDL ~ age + BMI + age:BMI`) using a likelihood ratio test (LRT). A small p-value indicates that the interaction term significantly improves model fit.

6.7.1 Comparing HERS models using LRT

Here, the likelihood ratio test is not statistically significant (Table 48: $\chi^2_1 \approx 1.4$, $p \approx 0.24$): the age-BMI interaction does not fit the data meaningfully better than we would expect from adding one parameter by chance. So we prefer the simpler parallel-planes model (`hers_lm1`, Equation 46) on parsimony grounds, consistent with the AIC and BIC comparison in Table 46.

7 End-of-chapter exercises

These paper-and-pencil exercises use actual datasets. No numerical computation is required.

Exercise 7.1. Main-effects model interpretation.
Adapted from the main-effects interpretation exercise in (Vittinghoff et al. 2012, chap. 4).
Dataset summary: The `ToothGrowth` dataset contains one row per guinea pig. Variable definitions:

- Y: tooth length (`len`)
- X: dose (`dose`)
- Z: supplement indicator (`supp`) with $Z = 1$ for `VC` and $Z = 0$ for `OJ`

Consider the additive model

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|X = x, Z = z] = \beta_0 + \beta_X x + \beta_Z z.$$

State the interpretation of β_0, β_X, and β_Z. Which interpretations depend on the reference level `OJ`?

```
eoc_tg <-
  ToothGrowth |>
  as_tibble() |>
  mutate(supp = relevel(supp, ref = "OJ"))

eoc_tg
#> # A tibble: 60 x 3
#>      len supp   dose
#>    <dbl> <fct> <dbl>
#>  1   4.2 VC      0.5
#>  2  11.5 VC      0.5
#>  3   7.3 VC      0.5
#>  4   5.8 VC      0.5
#>  5   6.4 VC      0.5
#>  6  10   VC      0.5
#>  7  11.2 VC      0.5
#>  8  11.2 VC      0.5
#>  9   5.2 VC      0.5
#> 10   7   VC      0.5
#> # i 50 more rows
glimpse(eoc_tg)
#> Rows: 60
#> Columns: 3
#> $ len  <dbl> 4.2, 11.5, 7.3, 5.8, 6.4, 10.0, 11.2, 11.2, 5.2, 7.0, 16.5, 16.5,~
#> $ supp <fct> VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, VC, V~
#> $ dose <dbl> 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 0.5, 1.0, 1.0, 1.0, ~
```

```
eoc_tg_add <-
  lm(len ~ dose + supp, data = eoc_tg)

eoc_tg_grid <-
  expand_grid(
    dose = seq(min(eoc_tg$dose), max(eoc_tg$dose), length.out = 100),
    supp = levels(eoc_tg$supp)
  )

eoc_tg_grid <-
  eoc_tg_grid |>
  mutate(len_hat = predict(eoc_tg_add, newdata = eoc_tg_grid))

ggplot(eoc_tg, aes(x = dose, y = len, color = supp)) +
```

```
  geom_point(alpha = 0.7) +
  geom_line(
    data = eoc_tg_grid,
    aes(y = len_hat)
  ) +
  labs(color = "supplement")
```

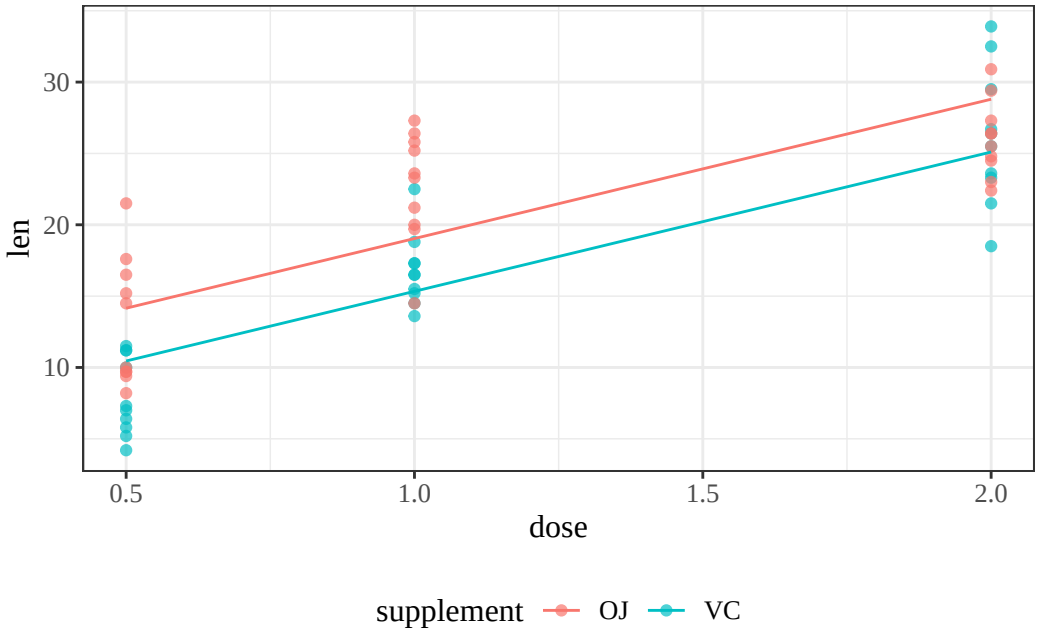


Figure 58: ToothGrowth data with additive (parallel-lines) fit

Solution

Solution.
β_0 is the mean tooth length for guinea pigs given `OJ` at dose 0.
β_X is the change in mean tooth length for each one-unit increase in dose. In this additive model, that dose effect is the same for `OJ` and `VC`.
β_Z is the mean tooth-length difference between `VC` and `OJ` at the same dose. The interpretations that depend on `OJ` as the reference level are β_0 and β_Z.

Exercise 7.2. Interaction interpretation.
Adapted from the interaction-slope interpretation example in (Dobson and Barnett 2018, sec. 6.7.1).
Use `ToothGrowth` as introduced in Exercise 7.1. Variable definitions:

- Y: tooth length (`len`)
- X: dose (`dose`)
- Z: supplement indicator (`supp`) with $Z = 1$ for `VC` and $Z = 0$ for `OJ`

Consider the interaction model

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|X = x, Z = z] = \beta_0 + \beta_X x + \beta_Z z + \beta_{XZ}(x \cdot z).$$

Using the plot, write the slope with respect to X for `OJ` and for `VC`. Then interpret β_{XZ}.

```
eoc_tg_int <-
  lm(len ~ dose * supp, data = eoc_tg)
```

```r
eoc_tg_grid2 <-
  expand_grid(
    dose = seq(min(eoc_tg$dose), max(eoc_tg$dose), length.out = 100),
    supp = levels(eoc_tg$supp)
  )

eoc_tg_grid2 <-
  eoc_tg_grid2 |>
  mutate(len_hat = predict(eoc_tg_int, newdata = eoc_tg_grid2))

ggplot(eoc_tg, aes(x = dose, y = len, color = supp)) +
  geom_point(alpha = 0.7) +
  geom_line(
    data = eoc_tg_grid2,
    aes(y = len_hat)
  ) +
  labs(color = "supplement")
```

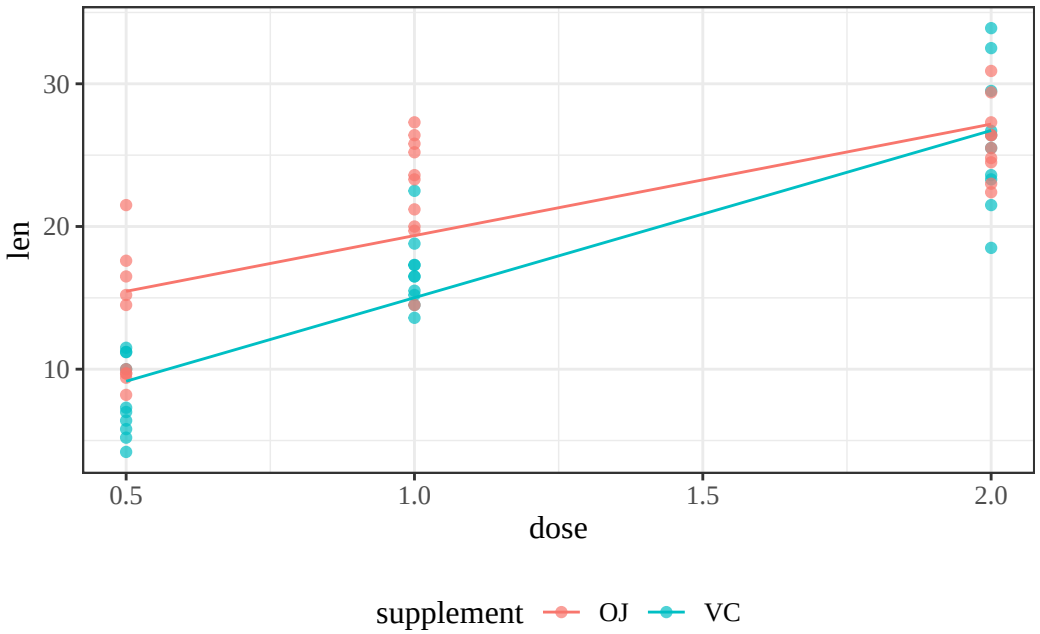


Figure 59: ToothGrowth data with interaction (non-parallel-lines) fit

Solution

Solution.
For `OJ`, the dose slope is β_X.
For `VC`, the dose slope is $\beta_X + \beta_{XZ}$.
Therefore, β_{XZ} is the difference in dose slopes between `VC` and `OJ`.

Exercise 7.3. Centering and coefficient changes.
Adapted from the centering/reparameterization exercise in (Kleinbaum et al. 2014, chap. 14).
Dataset summary: The `PLOS` dataset contains one row per paper. Variable definitions:

- Y: title length (`nchar`)

- X: number of authors (`authors`)
- X^*: centered author count (`authors_centered`), constructed from `authors`, defined as $X^* = X - 10$

Start from

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|X = x] = \beta_0 + \beta_X x.$$

Rewrite the model in terms of X^*. Express γ_0 and γ_X in terms of β_0 and β_X.

```
data(PLOS, package = "dobson")

eoc_plos <-
  PLOS |>
  as_tibble() |>
  mutate(authors_centered = authors - 10)

eoc_plos
#> # A tibble: 878 x 3
#>    nchar authors authors_centered
#>    <int>   <dbl>            <dbl>
#>  1   150       6               -4
#>  2    88      17                7
#>  3    64       3               -7
#>  4   126      30               20
#>  5    87       9               -1
#>  6   115       3               -7
#>  7   186      10                0
#>  8    58       1               -9
#>  9    75       1               -9
#> 10    80       3               -7
#> # i 868 more rows
glimpse(eoc_plos)
#> Rows: 878
#> Columns: 3
#> $ nchar            <int> 150, 88, 64, 126, 87, 115, 186, 58, 75, 80, 81, 74, 7~
#> $ authors          <dbl> 6, 17, 3, 30, 9, 3, 10, 1, 1, 3, 3, 3, 1, 30, 6, 11, ~
#> $ authors_centered <dbl> -4, 7, -7, 20, -1, -7, 0, -9, -9, -7, -7, -7, -9, 20,~
```

```
eoc_plos_orig <-
  lm(nchar ~ authors, data = eoc_plos)

eoc_plos_cent <-
  lm(nchar ~ authors_centered, data = eoc_plos)

eoc_plos_grid <-
  tibble(
    authors = seq(
      min(eoc_plos$authors),
      max(eoc_plos$authors),
      length.out = 100
    )
  ) |>
  mutate(authors_centered = authors - 10)

eoc_plos_grid <-
  eoc_plos_grid |>
  mutate(
    fit_original = predict(eoc_plos_orig, newdata = eoc_plos_grid),
```

```
    fit_centered = predict(eoc_plos_cent, newdata = eoc_plos_grid)
  )

ggplot(eoc_plos, aes(x = authors, y = nchar)) +
  geom_point(alpha = 0.7) +
  geom_line(
    data = eoc_plos_grid,
    aes(y = fit_original, color = "original parameterization")
  ) +
  geom_line(
    data = eoc_plos_grid,
    aes(y = fit_centered, color = "centered parameterization"),
    linetype = 2
  ) +
  labs(color = "")
```

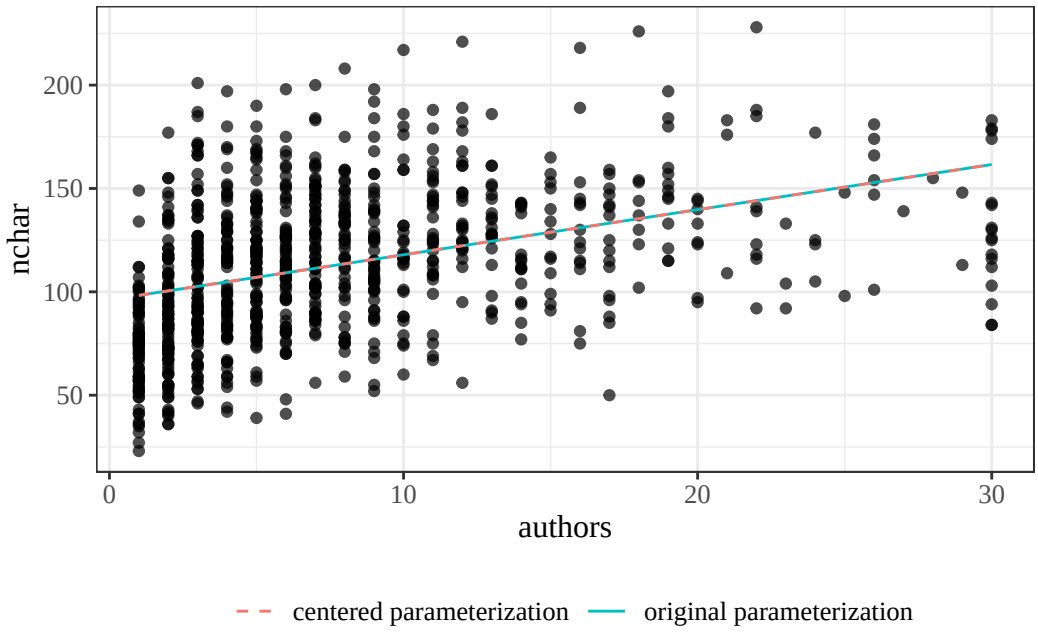


Figure 60: PLOS data with original and centered parameterizations

Solution

Solution.
Since $x = x^* + 10$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{E}[Y|X^* = x^*] &= \beta_0 + \beta_X(x^* + 10) \\ &= (\beta_0 + 10\beta_X) + \beta_X x^*. \end{aligned}$$

So

$$\gamma_0 = \beta_0 + 10\beta_X, \quad \gamma_X = \beta_X.$$

Centering shifts the intercept, but does not change the slope.

Exercise 7.4. Diagnostics from observed residual patterns.
Adapted from the residual-diagnostics example in (Dunn and Smyth 2018, chap. 3).
Dataset summary: The `mtcars` dataset contains one row per car model. Variable definitions:

- Y: fuel economy (`mpg`)
- X: vehicle weight (`wt`)
- H: horsepower (`hp`)

Consider the model

$$\mathrm{E}[Y|X = x, H = h] = \beta_0 + \beta_X x + \beta_H h.$$

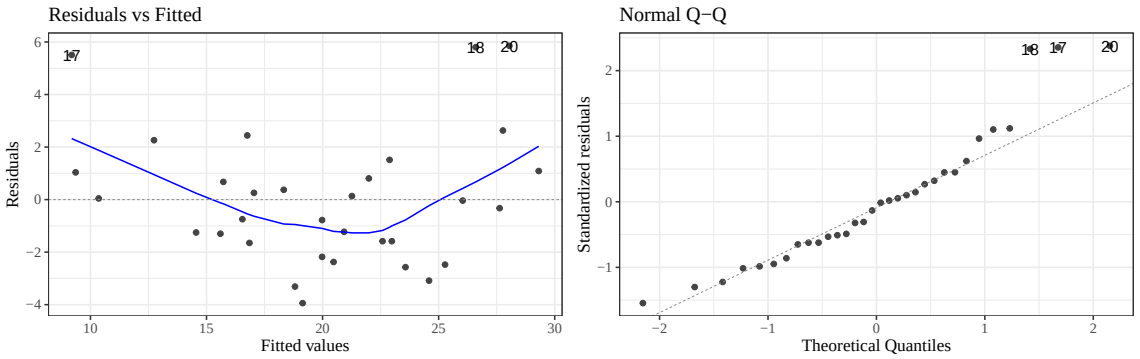
Based on the residual-vs-fitted and Q-Q plots, which assumptions look most questionable? State one practical follow-up step.

```
eoc_mtcars <-
  mtcars |>
  as_tibble()

eoc_mtcars
#> # A tibble: 32 x 11
#>      mpg   cyl  disp    hp  drat    wt  qsec    vs    am  gear  carb
#>    <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl> <dbl>
#>  1  21       6  160    110  3.9   2.62  16.5     0     1     4     4
#>  2  21       6  160    110  3.9   2.88  17.0     0     1     4     4
#>  3  22.8     4  108     93  3.85  2.32  18.6     1     1     4     1
#>  4  21.4     6  258    110  3.08  3.22  19.4     1     0     3     1
#>  5  18.7     8  360    175  3.15  3.44  17.0     0     0     3     2
#>  6  18.1     6  225    105  2.76  3.46  20.2     1     0     3     1
#>  7  14.3     8  360    245  3.21  3.57  15.8     0     0     3     4
#>  8  24.4     4  147.    62  3.69  3.19  20       1     0     4     2
#>  9  22.8     4  141.    95  3.92  3.15  22.9     1     0     4     2
#> 10  19.2     6  168.   123  3.92  3.44  18.3     1     0     4     4
#> # i 22 more rows
glimpse(eoc_mtcars)
#> Rows: 32
#> Columns: 11
#> $ mpg  <dbl> 21.0, 21.0, 22.8, 21.4, 18.7, 18.1, 14.3, 24.4, 22.8, 19.2, 17.8,~
#> $ cyl  <dbl> 6, 6, 4, 6, 8, 6, 8, 4, 4, 6, 6, 8, 8, 8, 8, 8, 8, 4, 4, 4, 4, 8,~
#> $ disp <dbl> 160.0, 160.0, 108.0, 258.0, 360.0, 225.0, 360.0, 146.7, 140.8, 16~
#> $ hp   <dbl> 110, 110, 93, 110, 175, 105, 245, 62, 95, 123, 123, 180, 180, 180~
#> $ drat <dbl> 3.90, 3.90, 3.85, 3.08, 3.15, 2.76, 3.21, 3.69, 3.92, 3.92, 3.92,~
#> $ wt   <dbl> 2.620, 2.875, 2.320, 3.215, 3.440, 3.460, 3.570, 3.190, 3.150, 3.~
#> $ qsec <dbl> 16.46, 17.02, 18.61, 19.44, 17.02, 20.22, 15.84, 20.00, 22.90, 18~
#> $ vs   <dbl> 0, 0, 1, 1, 0, 1, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0,~
#> $ am   <dbl> 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0,~
#> $ gear <dbl> 4, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 3, 3,~
#> $ carb <dbl> 4, 4, 1, 1, 2, 1, 4, 2, 2, 4, 4, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 1, 2, 1, 1, 2,~
```

```
eoc_mtcars_fit <-
  lm(mpg ~ wt + hp, data = eoc_mtcars)

autoplot(eoc_mtcars_fit, which = 1, ncol = 1)
autoplot(eoc_mtcars_fit, which = 2, ncol = 1)
```



(a) Residuals versus fitted

(b) Normal Q-Q

Figure 61: Diagnostic plots for linear model fit to mtcars data

Solution

Solution.
The residual-vs-fitted plot shows nonlinearity and non-constant spread. The Q-Q plot shows mild tail departures from normality.
The correct conclusion is that linearity and constant-variance assumptions are the most questionable here. A practical next step is to fit a model with a nonlinear weight term (for example, a spline or polynomial in `wt`) and then re-check diagnostics.

Exercises

Exercise 7.5 (Likelihood for simple linear regression)**.** (adapted from Kleinbaum et al. (2014), Chapter 6, and Dobson and Barnett (2018), Chapter 6)
Suppose $Y_i \mid x_i \ \sim_{\perp\!\!\!\perp} \ \mathrm{N}(\mu_i, \sigma^2)$, where $\mu_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i$.
(a) Write the likelihood $\mathcal{L}(\beta_0, \beta_1, \sigma^2; \tilde{y}, \tilde{x})$ for observed data (y_i, x_i), $i = 1, \ldots, n$.
(b) Write the log-likelihood $\ell(\beta_0, \beta_1, \sigma^2; \tilde{y}, \tilde{x})$ and show it simplifies to

$$\ell = -\frac{n}{2}\log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\mathrm{RSS},$$

where $\mathrm{RSS} = \sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \mu_i)^2$.
(c) Explain why maximizing ℓ over (β_0, β_1) is equivalent to minimizing RSS.

Solution

Solution. **(a)**

$$\mathcal{L}(\beta_0, \beta_1, \sigma^2; \tilde{y}, \tilde{x}) = \prod_{i=1}^{n}(2\pi\sigma^2)^{-1/2}\exp\left\{-\frac{(y_i - \mu_i)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right\}$$

where $\mu_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i$.
(b)

$$\begin{aligned}\ell &= \sum_{i=1}^{n}\log\left\{(2\pi\sigma^2)^{-1/2}\exp\left\{-\frac{(y_i - \mu_i)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right\}\right\} \\ &= -\frac{n}{2}\log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \mu_i)^2 \\ &= -\frac{n}{2}\log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{\mathrm{RSS}}{2\sigma^2}\end{aligned}$$

(c)
Since $-\frac{n}{2}\log\{2\pi\sigma^2\}$ does not depend on β_0 or β_1, and $\sigma^2 > 0$, maximizing ℓ over (β_0, β_1) is equivalent to maximizing $-\frac{\text{RSS}}{2\sigma^2}$, which is equivalent to minimizing RSS.
This equivalence shows that for Gaussian errors, the **maximum likelihood estimator** equals the **ordinary least squares estimator**.

Exercise 7.6 (Score equations for simple linear regression)**.** (adapted from Dobson and Barnett (2018), Chapter 6)
Using the log-likelihood from Exercise 7.5, derive the score equations for β_0 and β_1. Specifically, compute $\frac{\partial \ell}{\partial \beta_0} = 0$ and $\frac{\partial \ell}{\partial \beta_1} = 0$, and show they are equivalent to the normal equations:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} y_i = n\hat{\beta}_0 + \hat{\beta}_1 \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i$$
$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i y_i = \hat{\beta}_0 \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i + \hat{\beta}_1 \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2$$

Solution

Solution. From Exercise 7.5:

$$\ell = -\frac{n}{2}\log\{2\pi\sigma^2\} - \frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \beta_0 - \beta_1 x_i)^2$$

Score with respect to β_0:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_0}\ell &= -\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_0}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \beta_0 - \beta_1 x_i)^2 \\ &= -\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\sum_{i=1}^{n} 2(y_i - \beta_0 - \beta_1 x_i)(-1) \\ &= \frac{1}{\sigma^2}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \beta_0 - \beta_1 x_i)\end{aligned}$$

Setting equal to zero:

$$0 = \sum_{i=1}^{n}(y_i - \beta_0 - \beta_1 x_i)$$
$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} y_i = n\beta_0 + \beta_1 \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i$$

Score with respect to β_1:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \beta_1}\ell = \frac{1}{\sigma^2}\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i(y_i - \beta_0 - \beta_1 x_i)$$

Setting equal to zero:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i y_i = \beta_0 \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i + \beta_1 \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2$$

These score equations are the **normal equations**, whose solution gives the OLS/MLE estimators $\hat{\beta}_0$ and $\hat{\beta}_1$.

Exercise 7.7 (Closed-form OLS estimators (adapted from Vittinghoff et al. (2012), Chapter 4))**.** Using the normal equations from Exercise 7.6, show that the closed-form solutions are:

$$\hat{\beta}_1 = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n}(x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})}{\sum_{i=1}^{n}(x_i - \bar{x})^2}$$
$$\hat{\beta}_0 = \bar{y} - \hat{\beta}_1 \bar{x}$$

Solution

Solution. From the first normal equation, dividing both sides by n:

$$\bar{y} = \hat{\beta}_0 + \hat{\beta}_1 \bar{x} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \hat{\beta}_0 = \bar{y} - \hat{\beta}_1 \bar{x}$$

Substituting into the second normal equation:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i y_i = (\bar{y} - \hat{\beta}_1 \bar{x}) \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i + \hat{\beta}_1 \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2$$
$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i y_i - \bar{y} \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i = \hat{\beta}_1 \left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2 - \bar{x} \sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i \right)$$
$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i y_i - n\bar{x}\bar{y} = \hat{\beta}_1 \left(\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i^2 - n\bar{x}^2 \right)$$

Using the identities $\sum_i x_i y_i - n\bar{x}\bar{y} = \sum_i (x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})$ and $\sum_i x_i^2 - n\bar{x}^2 = \sum_i (x_i - \bar{x})^2$:

$$\hat{\beta}_1 = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n}(x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})}{\sum_{i=1}^{n}(x_i - \bar{x})^2}$$

Exercise 7.8 (Interpreting regression coefficients)**.** (adapted from Kleinbaum et al. (2014), Chapters 5–6, and Vittinghoff et al. (2012), Chapter 4)
Consider the linear regression model

$$\mathrm{E}[Y \mid X_1, X_2] = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_1 + \beta_2 X_2,$$

where Y is diastolic blood pressure (mmHg), X_1 is age (years), and X_2 is an indicator for current smoking ($X_2 = 1$ for smoker, $X_2 = 0$ for non-smoker). Suppose the estimates are $\hat{\beta}_0 = 55$, $\hat{\beta}_1 = 0.4$, $\hat{\beta}_2 = 6$.
(a) Interpret $\hat{\beta}_0$.
(b) Interpret $\hat{\beta}_1$.
(c) Interpret $\hat{\beta}_2$.
(d) Predict mean blood pressure for a 50-year-old smoker.
(e) What assumption does this model make about the relationship between age and blood pressure for smokers versus non-smokers?

Solution

Solution. **(a)**
$\hat{\beta}_0 = 55$ mmHg is the estimated mean diastolic blood pressure among non-smokers ($X_2 = 0$) aged zero ($X_1 = 0$). This prediction is an extrapolation beyond the observed range of ages and may not be a meaningful quantity on its own.
(b)
$\hat{\beta}_1 = 0.4$ mmHg/year is the estimated mean increase in diastolic blood pressure per one-year

increase in age, holding smoking status constant. Or equivalently: among people of the same smoking status, those who are one year older have, on average, 0.4 mmHg higher diastolic blood pressure.

(c)

$\hat{\beta}_2 = 6$ mmHg is the estimated mean difference in diastolic blood pressure between current smokers and non-smokers of the same age. Smokers have, on average, 6 mmHg higher diastolic blood pressure than non-smokers of the same age.

(d)

$$\hat{\mu} = 55 + 0.4 \times 50 + 6 \times 1 = 55 + 20 + 6 = 81 \text{ mmHg}$$

(e)

The model assumes that the slope of mean blood pressure with respect to age is the same ($\hat{\beta}_1 = 0.4$ mmHg/year) for both smokers and non-smokers (*parallel slopes* or *no interaction*). An interaction term $\beta_3 X_1 X_2$ would be needed to allow different slopes.

Exercise 7.9 (Coefficient of determination)**.** (adapted from Kleinbaum et al. (2014), Chapter 7)

In the simple linear regression of Y on X, define:

$$\text{TSS} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} (y_i - \bar{y})^2, \qquad \text{RSS} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2, \qquad R^2 = 1 - \frac{\text{RSS}}{\text{TSS}}.$$

(a) Explain in words what TSS, RSS, and R^2 measure.
(b) If $n = 20$, TSS $= 400$, and $R^2 = 0.75$, compute RSS.
(c) Is a large R^2 sufficient to conclude the model is correct? Briefly explain.

Solution

Solution. **(a)**

- TSS (total sum of squares): the total variability in Y around its mean $\bar{y}$, ignoring the predictor X.
- RSS (residual sum of squares): the residual variability in Y remaining after accounting for the linear regression on X. Smaller values indicate a better-fitting model.
- R^2: the proportion of the total variability in Y explained by the linear regression on X. $R^2 = 0$ means X explains none of the variation; $R^2 = 1$ means X perfectly predicts Y.

(b)

$$\text{RSS} = \text{TSS} \times (1 - R^2) = 400 \times (1 - 0.75) = 400 \times 0.25 = 100$$

(c)

No. A high R^2 indicates good fit in terms of variance explained, but does not guarantee the model is correctly specified. For example:

- The true relationship may be nonlinear, and a high R^2 can still be achieved with a linear model over a limited range.
- Important confounders or interaction terms may be omitted.
- The residuals may violate the model assumptions (non-normality, heteroscedasticity, dependence), which would invalidate inference even with high R^2.

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